

SOLICITATION/CONTRACT/ORDER FOR COMMERCIAL PRODUCTS AND COMMERCIAL SERVICES				1. REQUISITION NO.		PAGE 1 OF 153	
OFFEROR TO COMPLETE BLOCKS 12, 17, 23, 24, & 30							
2. CONTRACT NO.		3. AWARD/EFFECTIVE DATE		4. ORDER NO.		5. SOLICITATION NUMBER 36C10B26R0048	
						6. SOLICITATION ISSUE DATE 08/18/2026	
7. FOR SOLICITATION INFORMATION CALL:		a. NAME Michelle Prinston, Contract Specialist				b. TELEPHONE NO. (No Collect Calls) 848-377-5343	
						8. OFFER DUE DATE/LOCAL TIME 09/01/2026 2:00PM EST	
9. ISSUED BY Department of Veterans Affairs Technology Acquisition Center 23 Christopher Way Eatontown NJ 07724				10. THIS ACQUISITION IS ☒ UNRESTRICTED OR ☐ SET ASIDE: _____ % FOR: ☐ SMALL BUSINESS ☐ WOMEN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS (WOSB) ELIGIBLE UNDER THE WOMEN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS PROGRAM ☐ HUBZONE SMALL BUSINESS ☐ EDWOSB NAICS: 541512 ☐ SERVICE-DISABLED VETERAN-OWNED SMALL BUSINESS ☐ 8(A) SIZE STANDARD: \$34 Million			
11. DELIVERY FOR FOB DESTINATION UNLESS BLOCK IS MARKED ☐ SEE SCHEDULE		12. DISCOUNT TERMS		13a. THIS CONTRACT IS A RATED ORDER UNDER DPAS (15 CFR 700) ☐		13b. RATING N/A	
						14. METHOD OF SOLICITATION ☐ RFQ ☐ IFB ☒ RFP	
15. DELIVER TO See Delivery Schedule				16. ADMINISTERED BY Department of Veterans Affairs Technology Acquisition Center 23 Christopher Way Eatontown NJ 07724			
17a. CONTRACTOR/OFFEROR		CODE		18a. PAYMENT WILL BE MADE BY		CODE	
				Department of Veterans Affairs Technology Acquisition Center Financial Services Center PO Box 149971 Austin TX 78714-8971			
TELEPHONE NO.		UEI:		EFT:		PHONE: FAX:	
☐ 17b. CHECK IF REMITTANCE IS DIFFERENT AND PUT SUCH ADDRESS IN OFFER				18b. SUBMIT INVOICES TO ADDRESS SHOWN IN BLOCK 18a UNLESS BLOCK BELOW IS CHECKED ☐ SEE ADDENDUM			
19. ITEM NO.		20. SCHEDULE OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES				21. QUANTITY	
		Title: Supply Chain Management Development Security Operations (SCMDSO) Integration POC: Contract Specialist - Michelle Prinston, michelle.prinston@va.gov Contracting Officer - Jason King, Jason.king6@va.gov See section B4. For list of required services (Use Reverse and/or Attach Additional Sheets as Necessary)				22. UNIT	
						23. UNIT PRICE	
						24. AMOUNT	
25. ACCOUNTING AND APPROPRIATION DATA						26. TOTAL AWARD AMOUNT (For Govt. Use Only)	
☐ 27a. SOLICITATION INCORPORATES BY REFERENCE FAR 52.212-1, 52.212-4. FAR 52.212-3 AND 52.212-5 ARE ATTACHED. ADDENDA						☒ ARE ☐ ARE NOT ATTACHED.	
☐ 27b. CONTRACT/PURCHASE ORDER INCORPORATES BY REFERENCE FAR 52.212-4. FAR 52.212-5 IS ATTACHED. ADDENDA						☐ ARE ☐ ARE NOT ATTACHED	
☐ 28. CONTRACTOR IS REQUIRED TO SIGN THIS DOCUMENT AND RETURN _____ COPIES TO ISSUING OFFICE. CONTRACTOR AGREES TO FURNISH AND DELIVER ALL ITEMS SET FORTH OR OTHERWISE IDENTIFIED ABOVE AND ON ANY ADDITIONAL SHEETS SUBJECT TO THE TERMS AND CONDITIONS SPECIFIED						☐ 29. AWARD OF CONTRACT: REF. _____ OFFER DATED _____, YOUR OFFER ON SOLICITATION (BLOCK 5), INCLUDING ANY ADDITIONS OR CHANGES WHICH ARE SET FORTH HEREIN IS ACCEPTED AS TO ITEMS:	
30a. SIGNATURE OF OFFEROR/CONTRACTOR				31a. UNITED STATES OF AMERICA (SIGNATURE OF CONTRACTING OFFICER)			
30b. NAME AND TITLE OF SIGNER (TYPE OR PRINT)		30c. DATE SIGNED		31b. NAME OF CONTRACTING OFFICER (TYPE OR PRINT) Jason King Contracting Officer		31c. DATE SIGNED	

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SECTION B - CONTINUATION OF SF 1449 BLOCKS

B.1 GOVERNING LAW

Federal law and regulations, including the Federal Acquisition Regulations (FAR), shall govern this Contract/Order. Commercial license agreements may be made a part of this Contract/Order but only if both parties expressly make them an addendum hereto. If the commercial license agreement is not made an addendum, it shall not apply, govern, be a part of or have any effect whatsoever on the Contract/Order; this includes, but is not limited to, any agreement embedded in the computer software (clickwrap), any agreement that is otherwise delivered with or provided to the Government with the commercial computer software or documentation (shrinkwrap), or any other license agreement otherwise referred to in any document. If a commercial license agreement is made an addendum, only those provisions addressing data rights regarding the Government's use, duplication and disclosure of data (*e.g.*, restricted computer software) are included and made a part of this Contract/Order, and only to the extent that those provisions are not duplicative or inconsistent with Federal law, Federal regulation, the incorporated FAR clauses and the provisions of this Contract/Order; those provisions in the commercial license agreement that do not address data rights regarding the Government's use, duplication and disclosure of data shall not be included or made a part of the Contract/Order. Federal law and regulation including, without limitation, the Contract Disputes Act (41 U.S.C. § 7101 *et seq.*), the Anti-Deficiency Act (31 U.S.C. § 1341 *et seq.*), the Competition in Contracting Act (41 U.S.C. § 3301 *et seq.*), the Prompt Payment Act (31 U.S.C. § 3901 *et seq.*), Contracts for Data Processing or Maintenance (38 USC § 5725), Source Code Harmonization and Reuse in Information Technology Act "SHARE IT Act" (P.L. 118-187), and FAR clauses 52.212-4, 52.227-14 shall supersede, control, and render ineffective any inconsistent, conflicting, or duplicative provision in any commercial license agreement. In the event of conflict between this clause and any provision in the Contract/Order or the commercial license agreement or elsewhere, the terms of this clause shall prevail. The Contractor shall deliver to the Government all data first produced under this Contract/Order with unlimited rights as defined by FAR 52.227-14, this includes any custom code developed for the purpose of performing under this contract. Claims of patent or copyright infringement brought against the Government as a party shall be defended by the U.S. Department of Justice (DOJ) in accordance with 28 U.S.C. § 516; at the discretion of DOJ, the Contractor may be allowed reasonable participation in the defense of the litigation. Any additional changes to the Contract/Order must be made by modification (Standard Form 30) and shall only be made by a warranted Contracting Officer. Nothing in this Contract/Order or any commercial license agreement shall be construed as a waiver of sovereign immunity.

B.2 SOFTWARE LICENSE, MAINTENANCE AND TECHNICAL SUPPORT

(1). Definitions.

- a) Licensee. The term “licensee” shall mean the U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs (“VA”) and is synonymous with “Government.”
- b) Licensor. The term “licensor” shall mean the Contractor having the necessary license or ownership rights to deliver license, software maintenance and support of the computer software being acquired. The term “Contractor” is the party identified in Block 17a on the SF1449. If the Contractor is a reseller and not the Licensor, the Contractor remains responsible for performance under this Contract/Order.
- c) Software. The term “software” shall mean the licensed computer software product(s) cited in the Schedule of Supplies/Services.
- d) Maintenance. The term “maintenance” is the process of enhancing and optimizing software, as well as remedying defects. It shall include all new fixes, patches, releases, updates, versions and upgrades, as further defined below.
- e) Technical Support. The term “technical support” refers to the range of services providing assistance for the software via the telephone, email, a website or otherwise.
- f) Release or Update. The term “release” or “update” are terms that refer to a revision of software that contains defect corrections, minor enhancements or improvements of the software’s functionality. This is usually designated by a change in the number to the right of the decimal point (e.g., from Version 5.3 to 5.4). An example of an update is the addition of new hardware.
- g) Version or Upgrade. The term “version” or “upgrade” are terms that refer to a revision of software that contains new or improved functionality. This is usually designated by a change in the number to the left of the decimal point (e.g., from Version 5.4 to 6).

(2). Software License.

- a) Unless otherwise stated in the Schedule of Supplies/Services, the Performance Work Statement or Product Description, the software license provided to the Government is a perpetual, nonexclusive license to use the software.
- b) The Government may use the software in a networked environment.
- c) Any dispute regarding the license grant or usage limitations shall be resolved in accordance with the Disputes Clause incorporated in FAR 52.212-4(d).
- d) All limitations of software usage are expressly stated in the Schedule of Supplies/Services and the Performance Work Statement/Product Description.

(3). Software Maintenance and Technical Support.

- a) If the Government desires to continue software maintenance and support beyond the period of performance identified in this Contract/Order, the Government will issue a separate contract or order for maintenance and support. Conversely, if a contract or order for continuing software maintenance and technical support is not received, the Contractor is neither authorized nor permitted to renew any of the previously furnished services.
- b) The Contractor shall provide software support services, which includes periodic updates, enhancements and corrections to the software, and reasonable technical support, all of which are customarily provided by the Contractor to its commercial customers so as to cause the software to perform according to its specifications, documentation or demonstrated claims.
- c) Any telephone support provided by Contractor shall be at no additional cost.

d) The Contractor shall provide all maintenance services in a timely manner in accordance with the Contractor's customary practice or as defined in the Performance Work Statement or Product Description. However, prolonged delay (exceeding 2 business days) in resolving software problems will be noted in the Government's various past performance records on the Contractor (e.g., www.ppirs.gov).

e) If the Government allows the maintenance and support to lapse and subsequently wishes to reinstate it, any reinstatement fee charged shall not exceed the amounts that would have been charged if the Government had not allowed the subscription to lapse.

(4). Disabling Software Code. The Government requires delivery of computer software that does not contain any code that will, upon the occurrence or the nonoccurrence of any event, disable the software. Such code includes but is not limited to a computer virus, restrictive key, node lock, time-out or other function, whether implemented by electronic, mechanical, or other means, which limits or hinders the use or access to any computer software based on residency on a specific hardware configuration, frequency of duration of use, or other limiting criteria. If any such disabling code is present, the Contractor agrees to indemnify the Government for all damages suffered as a result of a disabling caused by such code, and the contractor agrees to remove such code upon the Government's request at no extra cost to the Government. Inability of the Contractor to remove the disabling software code will be considered an inexcusable delay and a material breach of contract, and the Government may exercise its right to terminate for cause. In addition, the Government is permitted to remove the code as it deems appropriate and charge the Contractor for consideration for the time and effort expended in removing the code.

(5). Manuals and Publications. Upon Government request, the Contractor shall furnish the most current version of the user manual and publications for all products/services provided under this Contract/Order at no cost.

(6). Data Rights.

a. Notwithstanding any contrary provisions contained in the Contractor's standard commercial license, the Contractor agrees that the Government will have the rights that are set forth in paragraph (b) below to use, duplicate or disclose any commercial computer software delivered under this Contract/Order.

b. The commercial computer software delivered under this Contract/Order may not be used, reproduced, or disclosed by the Government except as provided below or as expressly stated otherwise in this Contract/Order. The commercial computer software may be-

- Used or copied for use with the computer(s) for which it was acquired, including use at any Government installation to which the computer(s) may be transferred;
- Used or copied for use with a backup computer if any computer for which it was acquired is inoperative;
- Reproduced for safekeeping (archives) or backup purposes;
- Modified, adapted, or combined with other computer software, provided that the modified, adapted, or combined portions of the derivative software incorporating any of the delivered, commercial computer software shall be subject to same restrictions set forth in this Contract/Order;

- Disclosed to and reproduced for use by support service Contractors or their subcontractors, subject to the same restrictions set forth in this Contract/Order; and
 - Used or copied for use with a replacement computer.
 - If the commercial computer software is otherwise available without disclosure restrictions, the Contractor licenses it to the Government without disclosure restrictions. The terms and provisions of this Contract/Order shall comply with Federal laws and the Federal Acquisition Regulation.
- c. The Contractor shall affix a notice substantially as follows to any commercial computer software delivered under this Contract/Order: “Notice-Notwithstanding any other license agreement that may pertain to, or accompany the delivery of, this computer software, the rights of the Government regarding its use, reproduction and disclosure are as set forth in Government Contract No. _____.”

B.3 CONTRACT ADMINISTRATION DATA

1. Contract Administration: All contract administration matters will be handled by the following individuals:

a. CONTRACTOR: TBD

b. GOVERNMENT: Jason King
Contracting Officer 36C10B,
Department of Veterans Affairs
Technology Acquisition Center
23 Christopher Way
Eatontown NJ 07724

2. CONTRACTOR REMITTANCE ADDRESS: All payments by the Government to the contractor will be made in accordance with:

- ☒ 52.232-33, Payment by Electronic Funds Transfer—System For Award Management, or
☐ 52.232-36, Payment by Third Party

3. INVOICES: Invoices shall be submitted in arrears:

- a. Quarterly ☐
b. Semi-Annually ☐
c. Other ☒ Upon acceptance of deliverables in accordance with B.4, Price Schedule and B.5 Performance Work Statement

4. GOVERNMENT INVOICE ADDRESS: All Invoices from the contractor shall be submitted electronically in accordance with VAAR Clause 852.232-72 Electronic Submission of Payment Requests.

5. ACKNOWLEDGMENT OF AMENDMENTS: The offeror acknowledges receipt of amendments to the Solicitation numbered and dated as follows:

AMENDMENT NO	DATE

B.4 PRICE SCHEDULE

Deliverables shall be provided electronic submission to the VA Program Manager (PM) and the Contracting Officer Representative (CORS).

The resulting contract will be awarded on a firm-fixed-price basis as defined by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 16.202. Accordingly, the Contractor shall ensure that any and all costs associated with the Contractor's proposed application(s), software products, software solution, and/or system, shall be included in the Contractor's proposed firm-fixed price, and shall serve as the Contractor's firm-fixed price for the life of any resulting contract. No additional costs or fees relative to the Contractor's proposed application(s), software products, software solution, and/or system including, but not limited to, licensing costs and any associated licensing maintenance required for the development, delivery, integration, operation, and/or maintenance of the Contractor's proposed solution will be allowed, accepted, and/or paid by the Government.

Days used below refer to calendar days unless otherwise stated. Deliverables with due dates falling on a weekend or holiday shall be submitted the following Government workday after the weekend or holiday.

Electronic submission to: VA Program Manager, Contracting Officer's Representatives and Contracting Officer

NOTE: Quoters are instructed to see solicitation Section E for proposal submission instructions inclusive of the price proposal. All questions shall be directed to the Contract Specialist, Michelle Prinston, michelle.prinston@va.gov and Contracting Officer, Jason King, Jason.king6@va.gov prior to the closing date and time specified.

Inspection: Destination
Acceptance: Destination

*Product Service Code for all line items shall be DA01.

Base Period					
Period of Performance (PoP) shall be three months.					
CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
0001	PROJECT MANAGEMENT AND HELM PRODUCT LINE MANAGEMENT SUPPORT in accordance with (IAW) Performance Works Statement (PWS) paragraph 5.1.3 through 5.1.5, 5.2.1, 5.2.2 and 5.2.2.1 This Contract Line-Item Number (CLIN) includes all labor and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in	3	MO	\$	\$

	PWS sections 5.1.3 through 5.1.5, 5.2.1, 5.2.2 and 5.2.2.1. The Period of Performance shall be 3 months from date of award.				
Total Base Period					\$

Option Period One					
POP shall be 12 months					
This 12-month option period may be exercised IAW FAR 52.217-9, Option to Extend the Term of the Contract (MAR 2000). Work shall not commence until, and unless, a formal modification is issued by the Contracting Officer. If exercised, this option shall commence immediately after expiration of the Base Period.					
CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
1001	PROJECT MANAGEMENT AND HELM PRODUCT LINE MANAGEMENT SUPPORT IAW PWS paragraph 5.1 and 5.2 inclusive of all its sub paragraphs. This CLIN includes all labor and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS sections 5.1 and 5.2. The PoP shall be 12 months.	12	MO	\$	\$
1002	TRAVEL IAW PWS paragraph 4.3. Travel shall be in accordance with the Federal Travel Regulations (FTR). Travel requires advanced concurrence and shall be approved by the VA PM/COR in writing. Task order travel within the local commuting area will not be reimbursed. The Contractor's fixed handling rate as set forth herein may be applied to the billable travel cost and shall not exceed that set forth in the order. Profit shall not be applied. Government Not to Exceed Travel Ceiling:	1	LO	NTE \$	NTE \$

	\$170,329.20 + Fixed Handling Rate % = Travel NTE Ceiling.				
Total Option Period One					\$

Option Period Two					
POP shall be 09/15/2027 – 09/14/2028					
This 12-month option period may be exercised IAW FAR 52.217-9, Option to Extend the Term of the Contract (MAR 2000). Work shall not commence until, and unless, a formal modification is issued by the Contracting Officer. If exercised, this option shall commence immediately after expiration of Option Period One.					
CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
2001	PROJECT MANAGEMENT AND HELM PRODUCT LINE MANAGEMENT SUPPORT IAW PWS paragraph 5.1 and 5.2 of the inclusive of all its sub paragraphs. This Contract Line-Item Number (CLIN) includes all labor and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS sections 5.1 and 5.2. The PoP shall be 12 months.	12	MO	\$	\$
2002	TRAVEL IAW PWS paragraph 4.3. Travel shall be in accordance with the Federal Travel Regulations (FTR). Travel requires advanced concurrence and shall be approved by the VA PM/COR in writing. Task order travel within the local commuting area will not be reimbursed. The Contractor's fixed handling rate as set forth herein may be applied to the billable travel cost and shall not exceed that set forth in the order. Profit shall not be applied. Government Not to Exceed Travel Ceiling: \$175,439.08 + Fixed Handling Rate ____ % = Travel NTE Ceiling.	1	LO	NTE \$	NTE \$
Total Option Period Two					\$

Option Period Three					
POP shall be 12 months					
This 12-month option period may be exercised IAW FAR 52.217-9, Option to Extend the Term of the Contract (MAR 2000). Work shall not commence until, and unless, a formal modification is issued by the Contracting Officer. If exercised, this option shall commence immediately after expiration of Option Period Two.					
CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
3001	PROJECT MANAGEMENT AND HELM PRODUCT LINE MANAGEMENT SUPPORT IAW PWS paragraph 5.1 and 5.2 of the inclusive of all its sub paragraphs. This Contract Line-Item Number (CLIN) includes all labor and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS sections 5.1 and 5.2. The PoP shall be 12 months.	12	MO	\$	\$
3002	TRAVEL IAW PWS paragraph 4.3. Travel shall be in accordance with the Federal Travel Regulations (FTR). Travel requires advanced concurrence and shall be approved by the VA PM/COR in writing. Task order travel within the local commuting area will not be reimbursed. The Contractor's fixed handling rate as set forth herein may be applied to the billable travel cost and shall not exceed that set forth in the order. Profit shall not be applied. Government Not to Exceed Travel Ceiling: \$175,439.08 + Fixed Handling Rate ___% = Travel NTE Ceiling.	1	LO	\$	\$
Total Option Period Three					\$

Option Period Four					
POP shall be 12 months					
This 12-month option period may be exercised IAW FAR 52.217-9, Option to Extend the Term of the Contract (MAR 2000). Work shall not commence until, and unless, a formal modification is issued by the Contracting Officer. If exercised, this option shall commence immediately after expiration of Option Period Three.					
CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
4001	PROJECT MANAGEMENT AND HELM PRODUCT LINE MANAGEMENT SUPPORT in accordance with (IAW) section 5.1 and 5.2 of the Performance Work Statement (PWS) inclusive of all its sub tasks. This Contract Line-Item Number (CLIN) includes all labor and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS sections 5.1 and 5.2. The PoP shall be 12 months.	12	MO	\$	\$
4002	TRAVEL IAW PWS paragraph 4.3. Travel shall be in accordance with the Federal Travel Regulations (FTR). Travel requires advanced concurrence and shall be approved by the VA PM/COR in writing. Task order travel within the local commuting area will not be reimbursed. The Contractor's fixed handling rate as set forth herein may be applied to the billable travel cost and shall not exceed that set forth in the order. Profit shall not be applied. Government Not to Exceed Travel Ceiling: \$175,439.08 + Fixed Handling Rate ___% = Travel NTE Ceiling.	1	LO	NTE\$	NTE\$
Total Option Period Four					\$

Option Period Five					
POP shall be nine months					
This nine-month option period may be exercised IAW FAR 52.217-9, Option to Extend the Term of the Contract (MAR 2000). Work shall not commence until, and unless, a formal modification is issued by the Contracting Officer. If exercised, this option shall commence immediately after expiration of Option Period Four.					
CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
5001	PROJECT MANAGEMENT AND HELM PRODUCT LINE MANAGEMENT SUPPORT in accordance with (IAW) section 5.1 and 5.2 of the Performance Work Statement (PWS) inclusive of all its sub tasks. This Contract Line-Item Number (CLIN) includes all labor and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS sections 5.1 and 5.2. The PoP shall be nine months.	9	MO	\$	\$
5002	TRAVEL IAW PWS paragraph 4.3. Travel shall be in accordance with the Federal Travel Regulations (FTR). Travel requires advanced concurrence and shall be approved by the VA PM/COR in writing. Task order travel within the local commuting area will not be reimbursed. The Contractor's fixed handling rate as set forth herein may be applied to the billable travel cost and shall not exceed that set forth in the order. Profit shall not be applied. Government Not to Exceed Travel Ceiling: $\\$175,439.08 + \text{Fixed Handling Rate} \times \text{---} \% = \text{Travel NTE Ceiling.}$	1	LO	NTE\$	NTE\$
Total Option Period Five					\$

OPTIONAL TASK 1

This optional task may be exercised at any time, and from time to time, up to the Not to Exceed (NTE) value throughout the life of the task order IAW FAR 52.217-7 Option for Increased Quantity – Separately Priced Line Item. The PoP shall not exceed the period in which it is exercised.

CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price												
6001	SCRUM TEAM SUPPORT IAW section 5.3 of the PWS. This CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, travel and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS Paragraph 5.3. Each optional task exercised shall coincide in the period in which it is exercised. Teams shall be priced for a monthly increment with PoPs ranging from one to twelve months. Each Team exercised shall not exceed 12 months or the period in which it is exercised.	1	LO	NSP	NSP												
6002	Micro Scrum Team IAW PWS paragraph 5.3.1. This FFP CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS paragraphs 5.3 and 5.3.1. This Optional Task may be exercised up to the NTE amount over the life of the task order, for a period of up to 12 months each. Each exercise is for one additional scrum team. <table><tr><th>Period</th><th>Unit Price</th></tr><tr><td>Option Period One</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Two</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Three</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Four</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Five</td><td>\$</td></tr></table> *Average (for evaluation purposes only) \$	Period	Unit Price	Option Period One	\$	Option Period Two	\$	Option Period Three	\$	Option Period Four	\$	Option Period Five	\$	Not to Exceed (NTE) 798	MO	* See Monthly Pricing	**NTE \$
Period	Unit Price																
Option Period One	\$																
Option Period Two	\$																
Option Period Three	\$																
Option Period Four	\$																
Option Period Five	\$																

	**The amount in the total price column shall be calculated as follows: Multiply the average unit price by the total quantity. The average unit price = the sum of option periods one through five unit prices divided by five. **Equals the average unit price total multiplied by 798 months.																
6003	Small Scrum Team IAW PWS paragraph 5.3.2. This FFP CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS paragraphs 5.3 and 5.3.2. This Optional Task may be exercised up to the NTE amount over the life of the task order, for a period of up to 12 months each. Each exercise is for one additional scrum team. <table><tr><th>Period</th><th>Unit Price</th></tr><tr><td>Option Period One</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Two</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Three</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Four</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Five</td><td>\$</td></tr></table> *Average (for evaluation purposes only) \$_____ **The amount in the total price column shall be calculated as follows: Multiply the average unit price by the total quantity. The average unit price = the sum of option periods one through five unit prices divided by five. **Equals the average unit price total multiplied by 798 months.	Period	Unit Price	Option Period One	\$	Option Period Two	\$	Option Period Three	\$	Option Period Four	\$	Option Period Five	\$	NTE 798	MO	*\$ See Monthly Pricing	**NTE \$
Period	Unit Price																
Option Period One	\$																
Option Period Two	\$																
Option Period Three	\$																
Option Period Four	\$																
Option Period Five	\$																
6004	Medium Scrum Team IAW PWS paragraph 5.3.3. This FFP CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, and	NTE 912	MO	*See monthly Pricing	**NTE \$												

	deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS paragraphs 5.3 and 5.3.3. This Optional Task may be exercised up to the NTE amount over the life of the task order, for a period of up to 12 months each. Each exercise is for one additional scrum team. <table><tr><th>Period</th><th>Unit Price</th></tr><tr><td>Option Period One</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Two</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Three</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Four</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Five</td><td>\$</td></tr></table> *Average (for evaluation purposes only) \$ _____ **The amount in the total price column shall be calculated as follows: Multiply the average unit price by the total quantity. The average unit price = the sum of option periods one through five unit prices divided by five. **Equals the average unit price total multiplied by 912 months.	Period	Unit Price	Option Period One	\$	Option Period Two	\$	Option Period Three	\$	Option Period Four	\$	Option Period Five	\$				
Period	Unit Price																
Option Period One	\$																
Option Period Two	\$																
Option Period Three	\$																
Option Period Four	\$																
Option Period Five	\$																
6005	Large Scrum Team IAW PWS paragraph 5.3.4. This FFP CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS paragraphs 5.3 and 5.3.4. This Optional Task may be exercised up to the NTE amount over the life of the task order, for a period of up to 12 months each. Each exercise is for one additional scrum team. <table><tr><th>Period</th><th>Unit Price</th></tr><tr><td>Option Period One</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Two</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Three</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Four</td><td>\$</td></tr></table>	Period	Unit Price	Option Period One	\$	Option Period Two	\$	Option Period Three	\$	Option Period Four	\$	NTE 684	MO	*See Monthly Pricing	**NTE \$		
Period	Unit Price																
Option Period One	\$																
Option Period Two	\$																
Option Period Three	\$																
Option Period Four	\$																

	Option Period Five \$ *Average (for evaluation purposes only) \$_____ **The amount in the total price column shall be calculated as follows: Multiply the average unit price by the total quantity. The average unit price = the sum of option periods one through five unit prices divided by five. **Equals the average unit price total multiplied by 684 months.				
Total Optional Task 1					NTE \$

OPTIONAL TASK 2 This optional task may be exercised at any time, and from time to time, up to the Not to Exceed (NTE) value throughout the life of the task order IAW FAR 52.217-7 Option for Increased Quantity – Separately Priced Line Item. The PoP shall not exceed the period in which it is exercised.					
CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
7001	HIGHLY TECHNICAL SCRUM TEAM SUPPORT - IAW section 5.4 of the PWS. This CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, travel and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS Paragraph 5.4. Each optional task exercised shall coincide in the period in which it is exercised. Teams shall be priced for a monthly increment with PoPs ranging from one to twelve months. Each Team exercised shall not exceed 12 months or the period in which it is exercised.	1	LO	NSP	NSP
7002	Micro Highly Technical Scrum Team IAW PWS paragraph 5.4.1. This FFP CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, and	NTE 684	MO	*See Monthly Pricing	**NTE \$

	deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS paragraphs 5.4 and 5.4.1. This Optional Task may be exercised up to the NTE amount over the life of the task order, for a period of up to 12 months each. Each exercise is for one additional scrum team. <table><tr><th>Period</th><th>Unit Price</th></tr><tr><td>Option Period One</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Two</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Three</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Four</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Five</td><td>\$</td></tr></table> *Average (for evaluation purposes only) \$ _____ **The amount in the total price column shall be calculated as follows: Multiply the average unit price by the total quantity. The average unit price = the sum of option periods one through five unit prices divided by five. **Equals the average unit price total multiplied by 684 months.	Period	Unit Price	Option Period One	\$	Option Period Two	\$	Option Period Three	\$	Option Period Four	\$	Option Period Five	\$				
Period	Unit Price																
Option Period One	\$																
Option Period Two	\$																
Option Period Three	\$																
Option Period Four	\$																
Option Period Five	\$																
7003	Small Highly Technical Scrum Team IAW section 5.4.2 of the PWS. This FFP CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS paragraphs 5.4 and 5.4.2. This Optional Task may be exercised up to the NTE amount over the life of the task order, for a period of up to 12 months each. Each exercise is for one additional scrum team. <table><tr><th>Period</th><th>Unit Price</th></tr><tr><td>Option Period One</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Two</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Three</td><td>\$</td></tr></table>	Period	Unit Price	Option Period One	\$	Option Period Two	\$	Option Period Three	\$	NTE 570	MO	*See Monthly Pricing	**NTE \$				
Period	Unit Price																
Option Period One	\$																
Option Period Two	\$																
Option Period Three	\$																

	<table><tr><td>Option Period Four</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Five</td><td>\$</td></tr></table> *Average (for evaluation purposes only) \$ _____ **The amount in the total price column shall be calculated as follows: Multiply the average unit price by the total quantity. The average unit price = the sum of option periods one through five unit prices divided by five. **Equals the average unit price total multiplied by 570 months.	Option Period Four	\$	Option Period Five	\$												
Option Period Four	\$																
Option Period Five	\$																
7004	Medium Highly Technical Scrum Team IAW section 5.4.3 of the PWS. This FFP CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS paragraphs 5.4 and 5.4.3. This Optional Task may be exercised up to the NTE amount over the life of the task order, for a period of up to 12 months each. Each exercise is for one additional scrum team. <table><tr><td>Period</td><td>Unit Price</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period One</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Two</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Three</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Four</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Five</td><td>\$</td></tr></table> *Average (for evaluation purposes only) \$ _____ **The amount in the total price column shall be calculated as follows: Multiply the average unit price by the total quantity. The average unit price = the sum of option periods one through five unit prices divided by five.	Period	Unit Price	Option Period One	\$	Option Period Two	\$	Option Period Three	\$	Option Period Four	\$	Option Period Five	\$	NTE 342	MO	*See Monthly Pricing	**NTE \$
Period	Unit Price																
Option Period One	\$																
Option Period Two	\$																
Option Period Three	\$																
Option Period Four	\$																
Option Period Five	\$																

	**Equals the average unit price total multiplied by 342 months.																
7005	Large Highly Technical Scrum Team IAW section 5.4.4 of the PWS. This FFP CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS paragraphs 5.4 and 5.4.4. This Optional Task may be exercised up to the NTE amount over the life of the task order, for a period of up to 12 months each. Each exercise is for one additional scrum team. <table><tr><th>Period</th><th>Unit Price</th></tr><tr><td>Option Period One</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Two</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Three</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Four</td><td>\$</td></tr><tr><td>Option Period Five</td><td>\$</td></tr></table> *Average (for evaluation purposes only) \$ _____ **The amount in the total price column shall be calculated as follows: Multiply the average unit price by the total quantity. The average unit price = the sum of option periods one through five unit prices divided by five. **Equals the average unit price total multiplied by 171 months.	Period	Unit Price	Option Period One	\$	Option Period Two	\$	Option Period Three	\$	Option Period Four	\$	Option Period Five	\$	NTE 171	MO	*See Monthly Pricing	**NTE \$
Period	Unit Price																
Option Period One	\$																
Option Period Two	\$																
Option Period Three	\$																
Option Period Four	\$																
Option Period Five	\$																
Total Optional Task 2					\$												

OPTIONAL TASK 3

This optional task may be exercised at any time during the life of the task order IAW FAR 52.217-7 Option for Increased Quantity – Separately Priced Line Item. The Period of Performance shall not exceed 60 days from date of exercise.

CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
8001	TRANSITION SUPPORT - IAW section 5.13 of the PWS.	2	MO	\$	\$

	This CLIN includes all labor, materials, project management, travel and deliverables required for the successful completion of the services detailed in PWS Paragraph 5.13. The PoP shall coincide within the period in which it is exercised.				
8001AA	Transition Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.13. Due three days from date of optional task exercise.	1	LO	NSP	NSP
8001AB	Certification of Transition Completion IAW PWS paragraph 5.13. Due upon successful completion of transition.	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Total Optional Task 3					\$

Total Base and Option Periods	\$
Total Optional Task One	NTE \$
Total Optional Task Two	NTE \$
Total Optional Task Three	\$
Total Task Order Price	\$

Base and Option Period Deliverables					
CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
X001	Contractor Project Management Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.1.1 Due: Within 30 days After Receipt of Order (ARO)	1	LO	NSP	NSP
X002	Consolidated Performance Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.1.2. Due: Due on the fifth day of each month throughout the PoP	1	LO	NSP	NSP
X003	Monthly Progress Reports IAW PWS paragraph 5.1.3. Due: Due on the fifth day of each month throughout the PoP	1	LO	NSP	NSP

X004	Kickoff Agenda, Minutes and Final Presentation IAW PWS paragraph 5.1.4. Due: 3 Calendar Days after the meeting	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X005	Master Onboarding Tracking Document IAW PWS paragraph 5.1.5.4 Due: one week ARO and updated weekly thereafter	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X006	Intake Analysis and SOP IAW PWS paragraph 5.2.2.1. Due: 20 days ARO	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X007	Requirements Analysis Proposal (RAP) tool IAW PWS paragraph 5.2.2.1. Due: 20 days ARO	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X008	RAP IAW PWS paragraph 5.2.2.1. Due: Within five days of Intake request or mutually agreed upon date.	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X009	HELM Product Team Request Intake Tool/Workspace IAW PWS paragraph 5.2.2.1. Due: 20 days ARO	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X010	PI Planning Agenda and Pre-Read Materials IAW PWS paragraph 5.2.3 Due: Quarterly and updated quarterly thereafter.	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X011	PI Planning Summary Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.2.3. Due: Quarterly and updated quarterly thereafter.	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X012	HELM PL Program Backlog and HELM Strategic Roadmap IAW PWS paragraph 5.2.3. Due: Quarterly and updated quarterly thereafter.	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X013	Quarterly PI Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.2.3.	1	EA	NSP	NSP

	Due: 90 days ARO and updated quarterly thereafter.				
X014	Statement of Attestations IAW PWS paragraph 6.1.11. Due: 30 day ARO, as applicable	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X015	AI System/LLM Development and Operation Documentation Package IAW PWS paragraph 6.1.11.1 Due: 30 days ARO as applicable	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X016	Compliance Monitoring and Reporting Plan IAW PWS paragraph 6.1.11.2 Due: 30 days ARO, as applicable	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X017	Corrective action Plan IAW PWS paragraph 6.1.11.2 Due: 30 days after material deviation, as applicable	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X018	AI Model/LLM Change Disclosure IAW PWS paragraph 6.1.11.3 Due: In advance of any material changes to AI models.	1	EA	NSP	NSP
X0019	Contractor Staff Roster IAW PWS paragraph 6.2.2. Due: 3 days after award	1	EA	NSP	NSP

Optional Task Deliverables

Deliverables described herein shall coincide with the exercised optional tasks under PWS paragraphs 5.3 and 5.4 and its intended support. Those deliverables which do not have due dates or timeframes shall be mutually agreed upon between the contractor, VA PM and VA COR at time of optional task execution and as part of the RAP process described in PWS paragraph 5.2.2.

CLIN	Description	Qty	Unit	Unit Price	Total Price
Y001	Sprint/Iteration Planning Artifacts IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y002	Build and Deployment Packages IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP

Y003	Compliance Documentation IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y004	Updated Technical Design IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y005	Product Schedule / Roadmap IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.1 Due Monthly	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y006	Product Plan / Modernization Roadmap with KPIs/OKRs IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y007	Product Configuration Management Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y008	Version Description Document IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y009	Individual Product(s) Roadmap IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.4 Due monthly	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y010	HELM PL Strategic RoadMap IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.4 Due monthly	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y011	User Experience Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.5.	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y012	Refined Backlog Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.6.	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y013	Product Line SAFe Architectural Runway IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y014	AS IS Architecture Model IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y015	TO BE Architecture Model IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y016	Architecture Diagrams IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP

Y017	Solution-Level Roadmap (product-specific) IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y018	Solution Architecture (product-specific) IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y019	Product-Specific Data Models IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y020	User Research Artifacts IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y021	Solution (Product) Roadmap IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y022	Test Plans IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.9 and applicable subparagraph	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y023	Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM) IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.9.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y024	Defect Management Reports IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.9.3	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y025	Test Cases IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.9.3	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y026	Test Scripts (including automated test scripts where applicable) IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.9.4	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y027	Test Execution & Summary Reports IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.9.4. Due per sprint and/or release as required	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y028	Data Tools Development and Testing Project Management Plans IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.10.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y029	Updates to the Data Tools Development and Testing Project Management Plans IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.10.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP

Y030	Data Extraction Scripts IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.10.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y031	Data Migration Plan and Schedule IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.10.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y032	Data Mapping Document IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.10.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y033	Data Mapping Analysis and Validation Results IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.10.3	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y034	Data Migration Support Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.10.4	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y035	Data Migration Test Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.10.4	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y036	Data Migration Test Summary Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.10.4	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y037	Training Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.11	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y038	Virtual Training Schedule IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.11	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y039	Training Materials and User Guides IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.11	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y040	Training Attendance and Metrics Reports IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.11	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y041	Updated Training Content per Release IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.11	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y042	Recorded Training Webinar IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.11	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y043	AI/ML Model Validation Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.12	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y044	Predictive Forecasting Analysis IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.12	1	LO	NSP	NSP

Y045	Product Substitution Automation Guide IAW PWS paragraph 5.5.12	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y046	Build Release Package IAW PWS paragraph 5.6.1.	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y047	Vulnerability Scanning Reports and Risk Assessments IAW PWS paragraph 5.6.2 Due monthly for each product supported	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y048	A&A Artifacts Required by the A&A Review Process IAW PWS paragraph 5.6.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y049	Defect/Fix Status Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.6.3	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y050	IOC Defect Resolution Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.6.3	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y051	Updated Software Source Code, Compiled Code, and Supporting Documentation IAW PWS paragraph 5.6.3	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y052	IOC Entry Request and IOC Exit Summary IAW PWS paragraph 5.6.3	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y053	Release and Deployment Support Package including the Solution Deployment Package (SDP) IAW PWS paragraph 5.6.4	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y054	Release and Deployment Support Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.6.4.3	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y055	Post Deployment Defect Resolution Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.7	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y056	After Action Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.7.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y057	VALIP Solution Architecture Package IAW PWS paragraph 5.8.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP

Y058	VALIP Interface Control Document IAW PWS paragraph 5.8.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y059	Cloud Capacity and Scalability Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.8.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y060	VALIP Data Mapping and Validation Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.8.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y061	External Partner Connectivity Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.8.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y062	VALIP Integration Test Plans and Results IAW PWS paragraph 5.8.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y063	Solution Architecture Package IAW PWS paragraph 5.9.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y064	ICR Issues IAW PWS paragraph 5.9.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y065	ICD IAW PWS paragraph 5.9.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y066	Build Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.9.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y067	ISA/MOUs and SLAs IAW PWS paragraph 5.9.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y068	Build Test Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.9.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y069	Build Release Planning Package IAW PWS paragraph 5.9.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y070	Sprint Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.9.3	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y071	Sprint Retrospective Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.9.4	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y072	Performance Trend Analysis Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.10.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y073	Performance Baseline and Threshold Documentation IAW PWS paragraph 5.10.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP

Y074	Incident and Root Cause Analysis Reports IAW PWS paragraph 5.10.1 Initial due within six business hours and final due no later than five business days after incident	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y075	Monthly APM Performance Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.10.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y076	Application Monitoring Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.10.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y077	Postmortem Reports IAW PWS paragraph 5.10.2 Due within 5 business days of incident	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y078	Analysis of Alternatives for an Enterprise Decommissioning Approach IAW PWS paragraph 5.10.3.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y079	Legacy Decommissioning Analysis Document 5.10.3.1.	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y080	Legacy System Decommissioning Plan 5.10.3.2	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y081	Cloud Migration Strategy & Architecture Blueprint IAW PWS paragraph 5.11.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y082	Cloud Migration Support Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.11.1	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y083	Cloud Migration Test Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.11.4	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y084	Updated ATO/A&A Artifacts	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y085	Post Migration Validation Report Due within five business days	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y086	DR/COOP Plan and Test Result IAW PWS paragraph 5.11.6	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y087	VAEC Migration Support Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.11.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP

Y088	VAEC Migration Test Plan IAW PWS paragraph 5.11.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y089	VAEC Migration Test Summary Report IAW PWS paragraph 5.11.8	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y090	As-Is and To-Be DoDAF Architecture Models IAW PWS paragraph 5.12	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y091	DoDAF compliant Architecture Diagrams IAW PWS paragraph 5.12	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y092	Solution Architecture Package IAW PWS paragraph 5.12	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y093	Vulnerability Scanning Reports and Assessments IAW PWS paragraph 5.12	1	LO	NSP	NSP
Y094	Assessment & Authorization (A&A) Artifacts IAW PWS paragraph 5.12	1	LO	NSP	NSP

B.5 PERFORMANCE WORK STATEMENT



PERFORMANCE WORK STATEMENT (PWS) DEPARTMENT OF VETERANS AFFAIRS

Office of Information & Technology (OIT)
Product Delivery Service (PDS) Health Services Portfolio (HSP)
Healthcare Environment and Logistics Management (HELM)

Supply Chain Management Development Security Operations (SCMDSO) Integration

**Date: June 30, 2026
VA-26-00021946**

PWS Version Number: 1.0

1.0 BACKGROUND

The Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) Office of Information and Technology (OIT) Product Delivery Services (PDS) delivers integrated digital capabilities that support Veteran care nationwide. Within PDS, the Health Services Portfolio's (HSP) Healthcare Environment and Logistics Management (HELM) Product Line (PL) implements, modernizes, sustains, standardizes, and streamlines software solutions for supply chain, logistics, expendables, assets, inventory, facilities, prosthetics, and environmental compliance. HELM provides the enterprise capabilities needed to support a unified, efficient, and data driven supply chain and logistics environment across VA.

VA does not currently operate with standardized, enterprise-wide supply chain business processes or technical systems. Numerous functional and capability gaps have been identified through Government Accountability Office (GAO) and Office of Inspector General (OIG) audits and internal assessments. VA requires accurate, reliable, and accessible supply chain data to improve ordering, fulfillment, and operational performance. These needs align with VA's Strategic Supply Chain (SC) Prioritization and Digital Modernization Strategy, which emphasize modernizing legacy systems, strengthening cybersecurity and resilience, improving data quality, enhancing user experience for logisticians, and establishing consistent, interoperable processes across Veterans Health Administration (VHA), VA Central Office (VACO), Veterans Benefit Administration (VBA), and National Cemetery Administration (NCA).

VA currently relies on approximately 63 disparate legacy systems across 174 sites, resulting in fragmented operations, limited enterprise visibility, and inefficiencies. Standardization and modernization are required to transform SC systems into integrated, enterprise-wide system of systems that supports responsive, efficient clinical and nonclinical supply operations.

To meet mission needs, VA requires a full service, standardized, scalable healthcare logistics software solutions with modern supply chain management capabilities. A unified digital environment shall enable lifecycle management efficiencies, data driven decision making, and seamless integration with major initiatives such as the Electronic Health Record Modernization (EHRM) and Financial Management Business Transformation (FMBT) programs. HELM's mission and modernization efforts directly support these enterprise requirements by advancing cloud-based logistics capabilities, modernizing legacy applications, and enabling consistent processes across VA's supply chain functions. In addition to modernization activities, several HELM products require ongoing sustainment support, enhancements, development, operation stability, security and Lifecycle support.

HELM is organized into five Sub Product Lines (SPL): Environmental and Healthcare Management, Healthcare Technology and Asset Management, Expendable Inventory Management, Prosthetics, and Technical Services. Additional products such as Enterprise Asset Management-Computerized Maintenance Management System (EAM-CMMS) and Enterprise Expendable Inventory Management (EEIM) are scheduled to be incorporated into the PL over the course of this task order Period of Performance (PoP), see Attachment 1, HELM Products. Attachment 1 represents both products that HELM provides full Software Development Life Cycle (SDLC) support and ownership, and VHA owned products where HELM provides varying levels of support.

To ensure continuity of critical HELM Product Line services throughout modernization and mandatory sustainment activities Optional Tasks may be exercised to maintain mandatory

service levels and prevent disruption to ongoing development, integration, and Operations and Maintenance (O&M) activities. Additionally, the Contractor shall maintain all required artifacts in a complete and current state to support seamless transition between contract teams, ensuring VA retains full operational continuity and institutional knowledge throughout the PoP.

VA employs a DevSecOps methodology integrated with Agile practices, emphasizing continuous delivery, iterative improvement, and security as a foundational element of the development lifecycle, not an afterthought. This approach reflects VA's commitment to delivering value rapidly and responsibly: getting new capabilities into the hands of Veterans and care teams quickly, while maintaining the highest standards of security and integrity for sensitive health information protected under Federal law.

The requirements set forth in this PWS provide comprehensive development, testing, deployment, operations, maintenance, and security support across legacy, current, and future HELM PL products and services throughout the full DevSecOps lifecycle.

2.0 APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

In the performance of the tasks associated with this PWS, the Contractor shall comply with the following:

1. "Federal Information Security Modernization Act of 2014"
2. Federal Information Processing Standards (FIPS) Publication 140-3, "Security Requirements for Cryptographic Modules", March 22, 2019
3. FIPS Pub 199, "Standards for Security Categorization of Federal Information and Information Systems," February 2004
4. FIPS Pub 200, "Minimum Security Requirements for Federal Information and Information Systems," March 2006
5. FIPS Pub 201-3, "Personal Identity Verification of Federal Employees and Contractors," January 2022
6. 10 U.S.C. § 2224, "Defense Information Assurance Program", as amended
7. 5 U.S.C. § 552a, as amended, "The Privacy Act of 1974"
8. Public Law 109-461 (P.L. 109-461), Veterans Benefits, Health Care, and Information Technology Act of 2006, as amended, Title IX, Information Security Matters
9. 42 U.S.C. § 2000d "Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964", as amended
10. VA Directive 0710, "Personnel Vetting Program," September 8, 2025, <https://www.va.gov/vapubs/index.cfm>
11. VA Handbook 0710, "Personnel Vetting Program," September 8, 2025, <https://www.va.gov/vapubs/index.cfm>
12. VA Directive 6102, "Internet/Intranet Services," August 5, 2019
13. 36 C.F.R. Part 1194 "Information and Communication Technology Standards and Guidelines," as amended
14. Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Circular A-130, "Managing Federal Information as a Strategic Resource," July 28, 2016
15. 32 C.F.R. Part 199, "Civilian Health and Medical Program of the Uniformed Services (CHAMPUS)", as amended
16. NIST SP 800-66 Rev. 2, "Implementing the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA) Security Rule: A Cybersecurity Resource Guide," February 2024

17. 45 C.F.R. Parts 160 and 164, Subparts A and E, the Standards for Privacy of Individually Identifiable Health Information (“Privacy Rule”); and 45 C.F.R. Parts 160 and 164, Subparts A and C, the Security Standard (“Security Rule”); as amended
18. Sections 504 and 508 of the Rehabilitation Act (29 U.S.C. § 794d), as amended
19. Homeland Security Presidential Directive (12) (HSPD-12), August 27, 2004
20. VA Directive 6500, “VA Cybersecurity Program,” February 24, 2021 (see VA NOTICE 24-18, dated September 27, 2024, “Update to VA Directive 6500 Cybersecurity Program”, and VA Notice 25-07, dated 3/18/25, “Amending VA Directive 6500 to incorporate M-24-15”)
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29. VA Directive 6508, “Implementation of Privacy Threshold Analysis and Privacy Impact Assessment,” October 15, 2014
30. VA Directive 6510, “VA Identity, Credential and Access Management,” September 3, 2024
31. VA Handbook 6510, “VA Identity, Credential and Access Management,” September 27, 2024
32. VA Directive and Handbook 6513, “Secure External Connections,” October 12, 2017
33. VA Directive 6300, “Records and Information Management,” September 21, 2018
34. VA Handbook, 6300.1, “Records Management Procedures,” March 24, 2010
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36. NIST SP 800-53 Rev. 5, “Security and Privacy Controls for Federal Information Systems and Organizations,” September 23, 2020 (includes updates as of 12/10/2020)
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41. OMB Memorandum, “Guidance for Homeland Security Presidential Directive (HSPD) 12 Implementation,” May 23, 2008
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43. NIST SP 800-116 Rev 1, “Guidelines for the Use of Personal Identity Verification (PIV) Credentials in Facility Access,” June 2018
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45. NIST SP 800-157, “Guidelines for Derived PIV Credentials,” December 2014
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56. Executive Order 14148, “Initial Rescissions of Harmful Executive Orders and Actions,” dated January 20, 2025
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75. CISA BOD 23-01: Improving Asset Visibility and Vulnerability Detection on Federal Networks." Cybersecurity & Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA), [BOD 23-01: Improving Asset Visibility and Vulnerability Detection on Federal Networks | CISA](#)
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79. E.O. 14319, "Preventing Woke AI in the Federal Government," July 23, 2025
80. OMB Memorandum M-25-21, "Accelerating Federal Use of AI through Innovation, Governance, and Public Trust," April 3, 2025
81. OMB Memorandum M-25-22, "Driving Efficient Acquisition of Artificial Intelligence in Government," April 3, 2025
82. OMB Memorandum M-26-04, "Increasing Public Trust in Artificial Intelligence (AI) Through Unbiased AI Principles," December 11, 2025
83. VA Enterprise Cloud Technical Reference Guide, Version 2.0, November 10, 2022
84. Agile Lifecycle Management Library [alm-library.aspx](#)
85. Attachment 1: HELM Products
86. Attachment 2: _HELM_Backlog

87. Attachment 3: HS Agile _Epics Operating Guide

3.0 SCOPE OF WORK

The Contractor shall provide comprehensive technical, functional, and lifecycle support for existing legacy and future HELM PL products, and new systems incorporated into the product line, in alignment with VA's enterprise digital modernization, cybersecurity, and supply chain transformation strategies. This support shall enable VA's strategic objectives to modernize platforms, standardize, enhance interoperability, strengthen cybersecurity posture, improve supply chain visibility, and deliver resilient and pleasant user experience in all modern systems. Products may be modernized through replacement or incremental modernization. When they are modernized, the corresponding legacy systems will be decommissioned. The Government will provide necessary requirements, system access, and stakeholder coordination. The Contractor shall support all HELM products, including—but not limited to—Inventory Management, Financial Management, Asset Management, other Supply Chain systems, Prosthetics, VistA modules such as MUMPS-based components, and Nuvolo/ServiceNow.

The Contractor shall provide full SDLC services; sustainment, modernization, enhancements, and development; configuration; cybersecurity and regulatory compliance; enterprise deployment; incremental enhancements; training; software download & installation, implementation and integration support; database administration; interface development; application user account management, platform management; testing, Cloud Migration and Hosting services consistent with internal VA Enterprise Cloud (VAEC) standards or external Platform as a Service (PaaS) and/or external Infrastructure as a Service (IaaS) Federal standards; and modernization activities supporting HELM PL managed solutions. The Contractor shall employ lean scaled agile frameworks, such as the Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe) and other emerging innovative frameworks, to deliver a broad range of solutions across the PL.

The Contractor shall apply advanced DevSecOps and engineering capabilities aligned with VA's Zero Trust Architecture (ZTA) Strategy, VA Digital Modernization Strategy, and SC modernization objectives, and future quantum computing considerations. Required activities include secure software development. Continuous Integration and Continuous Delivery (CI/CD) automation, pipeline optimization, continuous monitoring, security assessment and authorization support, configuration and release management, architecture and interoperability analysis, training, data validation and analytics, supply chain risk assessment, and development of technical roadmaps and recommendations that advance VA's enterprise modernization goals.

The Contractor shall also provide program management, technical governance, intake and prioritization support, business process analysis, Risk Management Framework activities, Agile delivery management, and required documentation to ensure secure, efficient, and compliant delivery of PL capabilities. All services shall adhere to VA cybersecurity, privacy, Section 508, and quality standards and shall integrate with VA enterprise platforms and shared services. All work shall comply with applicable VA security, privacy, and quality standards and shall align with OIT HELM PL's mission to modernize, secure, streamline, and sustain VA SC and logistics capabilities.

3.1 ORDER TYPE

This effort shall be a hybrid Firm-Fixed Price (FFP) Task Order with a Time and Materials (T&M) line for Travel.

4.0 PERFORMANCE DETAILS

4.1 PERFORMANCE PERIOD

The PoP shall be 3-month base period with four 12-month option periods, one nine-month option period, and three optional tasks, if exercised. The overall PoP shall not exceed 66 months.

Base period shall be one three – month period and shall consist of activities described in PWS paragraphs: 5.1.3; 5.1.4; 5.1.5; 5.2.1; 5.2.2; 5.2.2.1.

Any work at the Government site shall not take place on Federal holidays or weekends unless directed by the Contracting Officer (CO). If required, the CO or Contracting Officer's Representatives (CORs) or may direct the Contractor to work during holidays and weekends.

There are 11 Federal holidays set by law (USC Title 5 Section 6103) that VA follows:

Under current definitions, five are set by date:

New Year's Day	January 1
Juneteenth	June 19
Independence Day	July 4
Veterans Day	November 11
Christmas Day	December 25

If any of the above falls on a Saturday, then Friday shall be observed as a holiday. Similarly, if one falls on a Sunday, then Monday shall be observed as a holiday.

The other six are set by a day of the week and month:

Martin Luther King's Birthday	Third Monday in January
Washington's Birthday	Third Monday in February
Memorial Day	Last Monday in May
Labor Day	First Monday in September
Columbus Day	Second Monday in October
Thanksgiving	Fourth Thursday in November

4.2 PLACE OF PERFORMANCE

Tasks under this PWS shall be performed at Contractor facilities. The Contractor shall identify the Contractor's place of performance in their proposal submission. Work may be performed at remote locations with prior concurrence from the CORs

When travel is required, work at the Government site may be required to take place on holidays, or weekends or after business hours and will be directed by CO or the CORs. Travel to a Government facility needed to perform the services doesn't change the Place of Performance to the Government Site.

4.3 TRAVEL

The Government encourages maximum utilization of teleconferencing and video conferencing for meetings.

The Government anticipates travel to perform the tasks associated with the effort, as well as to attend program-related meetings or conferences throughout the PoP. Travel shall be in accordance with the Federal Travel Regulations (FTR) and requires advanced concurrence by the COR. Travel and per diem shall be reimbursed in accordance with FTR. The Contractor shall provide cost estimates with each travel request. Each Contractor invoice shall include copies of all receipts that support the travel costs claimed in the invoice. The Government will not reimburse local travel within a 50-mile radius from the Contractor's facility. This includes travel, subsistence, and associated labor charges for travel time. Travel performed for personal convenience and daily travel to and from work at the Contractor's facility will not be reimbursed.

The total number of trips in support of this effort for each option period there is 30 trips, with 4 people traveling for an average of five days per trip. No travel is anticipated in support of the base period.

Anticipated travel can be all CONUS VA Facility locations, and are not limited to the following:

1. Washington, DC
2. Austin, TX
3. Denver, CO
4. Orlando, FL
5. Bay Pines, FL

4.4 KEY PERSONNEL

The Contractor shall provide and maintain all designated Key Personnel for the full duration of the contract PoP related to the base FFP effort. These individuals are critical to the management, technical execution, and continuity of HELM PL activities. It is expected that key personnel who possess the required key skillsets must be maintained for the full duration of the contract will remain part of the team supporting HELM PL throughout the contract. Technical leads should be cross-functional, supporting DevSecOps, Agile, and VA modernization strategies. When changes are necessary, the Contractor shall coordinate all proposed substitutions with the CO, VA PM, and CORs team to ensure proper review, approval, and transition planning. Any substitution must possess equal or greater qualifications, experience, and certifications to maintain uninterrupted contract performance

Key Personnel:

- IT Program Manager
- Enterprise/Solution System Architect
- Engineer Solution Lead
- Data Architect Lead
- Test Automation Lead
- Solution Technical Lead
- Cyber Security Architect /Policy Lead

Optional Task One and Optional Task Two Scrum Teams shall be staffed based on requirements processed through the RAP intake process described in PWS Section 5.2.2. The RAP analysis will determine the necessary labor mix, competencies, and team composition for each activation. The Contractor shall align all resources to the scope, backlog items, and SDLC needs identified

through RAP and ensure teams meet HELM PL delivery, modernization, and sustainment requirements.

The Contractor shall determine and provide the mix of key personnel to support the contract requirements. Some of the roles and skillset/certifications delivered may include team roles/responsibilities as outlined below:

Role	Certifications / Skillsets
Technical Lead	SAFe Architect (ARCH) or SAFe Agilest • Advanced technical leadership in Agile/DevSecOps • Experience leading cross-functional teams for modernization, sustainment, and integration • Deep expertise in VA enterprise systems (HELM, VistA, Supply Chain, Cloud, Security) • Red Hat Certified Specialist or Architect in OpenShift
Release Manager / Equivalent Role	SAFe Release Manager or equivalent, Information Technology Infrastructure Library (ITIL)
Scrum Master	SAFe Scrum Master (SSM) • Certified Scrum Master (CSM)
Cloud Engineer	AWS Solutions Architect or DevOps Engineer • Azure Solutions Architect or Azure DevOps Engineer • Red Hat Certified Specialist or Architect in OpenShift • Red Hat Certified Specialist or Architect in Enterprise Linux
DevSecOps Engineer / Security Specialist	AWS Solutions Architect or Developer • Azure Solutions Architect) or Developer) • ISC2 CISSP • CI/CD pipeline, secure development, Zero Trust alignment • Red Hat Certified Specialist or Architect in Ansible
Solution System Architect / Engineer	Certified SAFe Architect (ARCH) • Ability to develop DoDAF/UAF architecture models and support product specific architecture • Red Hat Certified Engineer in Cloud-native Applications
Solution Lead	SAFe APSM • SAFe PO/PM • SAFe Architect (ARCH) • SAFe Agilest • The Open Group Architecture Framework (TOGAF) • Control Objectives for Information and Related Technologies (COBIT) • Red Hat Certified Engineer or Specialist in Cloud-Native Applications
Data Architect	Certified Deployment Professional • Certified SAFe Agile Architect • Databricks Certified Data Engineer • Databricks Certified Generative AI Engineer
Data Engineer / Migration Specialist	Certified Deployment Professional Data Migration Plans (DMPs) • Databricks Certified Data Engineer • Databricks Certified Generative AI Engineer
Cyber Security Risk Lead	CISSP • CISM • GIAC GSLC
Cyber Security Architect / Policy Lead	CISSP-ISSAP • CISSP-ISSEP • Expertise in VA Zero Trust, TIC 3.0, ATO compliance, VA Handbook 6500 requirements

Integration Lead / Engineer	Salesforce Certified Administrator or Salesforce Certified Platform App Builder • HealthShare Health Connect HL7 Interface Specialist • InterSystems IRIS Core Solutions Developer Specialist Certification • Red Hat Certified Specialist or Architect in Cloud-Native Applications
Software Developer / Full-Stack Developer	AWS Solutions Architect or AWS Developer • Azure Developer or Azure DevOps Engineer • Secure Coding / RMF compliance • SAFe Practitioner • Fullstack experience (Java, .NET, Python, React, Angular, Node.js) • Cloud-native dev (VAEC, AWS, Azure) • CI/CD (GitHub, GitLab, Jenkins, SonarQube) • VA TRM compliance • API/ESB/HL7/FHIR/VALIP integration expertise • Red Hat Certified Engineer or Architect in Cloud-Native Applications
Test Automation Engineer	ISTQB Agile Tester Certification (WS15.1) • Automated/manual test capability, RTM compliance, Quality Manager tool proficiency
MUMPS Engineer / SME (VistA)	VistA/MUMPS proficiency • Secure Coding (VA Handbook 6500) • Recommended: VistA FileMan/KERNEL training • Experience supporting sustainment operations such as IFCAP, AEMS/MERS, table updates, patch remediation
VistA Kernel & FileMan Specialist	VistA Kernel/FileMan proficiency • FORUM/NPM patching knowledge • VistA Configuration (institution/division files), VistA menu tree and security key experience
Supply Chain Technical Specialist / Supply Chain Lead	APICS CPIM • CSCP • Nuvolet/SNOW • VA supply chain domain expertise, MAXIMO

5.0 SPECIFIC TASKS AND DELIVERABLES

The Contractor shall perform the following tasks and provide the specific deliverables described below for each product/project initiated within the PoP stated in this PWS.

The Contractor and/or its subcontractors shall be required, as part of performance under this Task Order, to work with other Government Contractors. In performance of this task order the Contractor shall provide full cooperation with all contractors working for and on behalf of the VA. The Contractor is not authorized to provide guidance, direction, and /or approval of any Contractor's work activities, work products, or deliverables; VA staff will provide all directions and/or approval.

Upon award, the CORs will establish initial contact between the Contractor and other Contractors. All interested parties shall participate as applicable. Nondisclosure forms between VA and Contractors shall be executed as appropriate.

The Contractor shall utilize the SDLC and apply the Agile framework for product management to deliver iteratively and incrementally, consistently producing high quality results that are cost effective, timely, and achieved through a highly collaborative manner.

The Contractor shall utilize VA TRM compliant tools in performance of Agile Product Management, test results, scenarios, and results for each product.

The Contractor shall adhere to VA policies by ensuring compliance with DevSecOps practices, implementing Agile methodologies, and supporting other OIT strategic initiatives. To achieve these requirements, the Contractor shall provide a team of subject matter experts (SME) who will facilitate the integration and oversight of capabilities at both the product line and the product/solution levels, working collaboratively with stakeholders and partners.

All tasks and deliverables described in Sections 5.0 through 5.13 shall be executed using an iterative Agile delivery model performed through recurring, timeboxed two-week sprints, unless otherwise approved by the CORs. Each sprint shall include Sprint Planning, Daily Scrum meetings, backlog refinement, build and integration activities, continuous testing, a Sprint Review, and a Sprint Retrospective. The Contractor shall ensure that all development, sustainment, DevSecOps, testing, data management, architecture, release preparation, documentation, and operational readiness activities are delivered incrementally within this sprint cadence.

The Contractor shall maintain all sprint artifacts including Sprint Plans, Sprint Backlogs, working software increments, test evidence, configuration items, defects, risks, impediments, and traceability data within VA approved Agile lifecycle management tools. These tools serve as the authoritative source for documenting progress, demonstrating completion of acceptance criteria, and supporting Product Line governance

VA will follow an intake process outlined in PWS Section 5.2.2 when new or existing products/applications/systems require support services from the task order.

5.1 PROJECT MANAGEMENT

5.1.1 CONTRACTOR PROJECT MANAGEMENT PLAN

The Contractor shall deliver a Contractor Project Management Plan (CPMP) that lays out the Contractor's approach, timeline, and tools to be used in execution of the task order. The CPMP should take the form of both a narrative and graphic format that displays the schedule, milestones, risks, and resource support. The CPMP shall also include how the Contractor shall coordinate and execute planned, routine, and ad hoc data collection reporting requests as identified within the PWS. The initial baseline CPMP shall be provided within one month of the award to the VA Product Manager/CORs who will approve/concur. The Contractor shall update and maintain the approved CPMP throughout the PoP. The updated CPMP shall be provided monthly, or as needed, to the VA Product Manager/CORs. The Contractor shall provide a contractor functional organization chart to ensure contractor leads along with SMEs are clearly delineated.

Deliverable:

- A. Contractor Project Management Plan

5.1.2 REPORTING REQUIREMENTS

The Contractor shall use the VA's implementation of the Jira, GitHub, and other VA approved toolsets to provide Agile project/product lifecycle management tool to track execution details. The VA approved toolset Project/Product Data and Artifact Repository shall be used to provide a

single authoritative project and product data and artifact repository. All OIT HELM PL project data and artifacts shall be required to be managed in this data and artifact repository daily. All checked out artifacts shall be checked back in daily and any data updated daily. VA approved toolset synchronizes all changed information immediately for all team members to access work proficiently without the concern of working on aged information.

The Contractor shall utilize the VA approved toolset to:

- a. Input and manage scheduled project/product sprints and backlog
- b. Input and manage project/product Agile requirements
- c. Input and manage project/product risks and issues
- d. Input and manage project/product configurations and changes
- e. Input and manage project/product test plans and execution
- f. Input and manage project/product planning and engineering documentation
- g. Input and manage project/product user guides and training materials
- h. Input and manage linkages to correlate requirements to change orders to configurable items to risks, impediments, and issues to test cases and test results to show full traceability.
- i. Input and manage linkages to correlate requirements to change orders to configurable items to risks, impediments, and issues to test cases and test results to show full traceability.
- j. Input and manage Enterprise-wide implementation
- k. Input and manage integration with interfaces

The Contractor shall show all Agile requirements, changes, tests performed and test results in the VA approved toolset to show evidence of code coverage and test coverage of all the requirements specified. This expectation shall allow VA to have high confidence in a fully documented, requirements traceability matrix, as evidenced by data in the tools. The Contractor shall track for each product. The Contractor shall support the CORs in the creation and management of a SharePoint based deliverable library and associated approval workflow. The Contractor shall provide items listed above into a monthly comprehensive Consolidated Performance Report containing list of accomplishments, list of software releases, list and link to all deliverables delivered for the month, HELM Products ATO and 508 compliance status, projected travel, projected critical roadblocks/, and planned work. Format and details will be coordinated with CORs and Contractor.

Deliverables:

- A. Consolidated Performance Report

5.1.3 PROGRESS REPORTS

The Contractor shall provide the COR with Monthly Progress Reports in electronic form in Microsoft Word and Project formats and stored in shared repository such as a Teams Channel. The report shall include detailed instructions/explanations for each required data element, to ensure that data is accurate and consistent. These reports shall reflect data as of the last day of the preceding Month.

The Monthly Progress Reports shall cover all work completed during the reporting period and work planned for the subsequent reporting period. The report shall also identify any problems that arose and provide a description of how the problems were resolved. If problems have not been completely resolved, the Contractor shall provide an explanation including their plan and

timeframe for resolving the issue. The report shall also include an itemized list of all Information and Communication Technology (ICT) deliverables and their current Section 508 conformance status. The Contractor shall monitor performance against the CPMP and report any deviations. It is expected that the Contractor shall keep in communication with VA accordingly so that issues that arise are transparent to both parties to prevent escalation of outstanding issues.

Deliverable:

A. Monthly Progress Report

5.1.4 TECHNICAL KICKOFF MEETING

A technical kickoff meeting shall be held within 10 days after award. The Contractor shall coordinate the date, time, and location (can be virtual) with the CO, the VA PM, the Contract Specialist (CS), and the CORs. The Contractor shall provide a draft agenda to the CO, VA PM, and CORs at least five calendar days prior to the meeting. Upon Government approval of the final agenda, the Contractor shall distribute to all meeting attendees. During the kickoff meeting, the Contractor shall present, for review and approval by the Government, the details of the intended approach, work plan, and project schedule for each effort via a Microsoft Office PowerPoint presentation. At the conclusion of the meeting, the Contractor shall update the presentation with a final slide entitled "Summary Report" which shall include notes on any major issues, agreements, or disagreements discussed during the kickoff meeting. The Contractor shall distribute the updated presentation and meeting minutes to the CO, VA PM, CORs and all attendees within three calendar days after the meeting.

Deliverable:

A. Kickoff Meeting Agenda, Kickoff Meeting Minutes and Final presentation

5.1.5 ONBOARDING / OFFBOARDING

The Contractor shall support the onboarding and offboarding of its staff. The Contractor shall provide a task order lead to support onboarding and offboarding actions in the Identity and Access Management (IAM) Portal, to include TMS training. A single Contractor Onboarding Point of Contact (POC) and back up POC shall be designated by the Contractor that tracks the onboarding, offboarding, and training status of all Contractor personnel. The Contractor shall maintain a Master Onboarding Tracking Document as described in section 5.1.5.4, and provided monthly to the CORs, VA PM or Government designee. The Contractor shall provide a Weekly Onboarding/Offboarding Status Report as described in sections 5.1.5.1 and 5.1.5.2. The format for the weekly onboarding and offboarding status reports shall be developed collaboratively and approved by the CORs and the Contractor which shall be saved with all other deliverables. The Contractor shall provide an onboarding status in the Weekly Onboarding/Offboarding Status Report to the CORs, VA PM or Government designee.

5.1.5.1 Onboarding Activities

Onboarding includes steps to obtain a VA PIV card, network and email account, complete training, initiate background investigations, and obtain Government Furnished Equipment (GFE). In addition, the Contractor shall identify individuals which may require elevated privileges to the necessary development and test environments for the various systems to be developed or enhanced.

The Contractor Onboarding POCs shall be responsible for accurate and timely submission of all required VA onboarding paperwork to the VA CORs or applicable systems used for onboarding. The Contractor shall be responsible for tracking the status of all its staff's onboarding activities

to include the names of all personnel engaged on the task, commercial email address, phone numbers, immediate task order supervisor, onboarding milestone dates, and their initial training date for VA Privacy and Information Security training. The Weekly Onboarding/Offboarding Status Report shall include:

- Current onboarding status for all personnel.
- Pending onboarding actions.
- Estimated completion dates for outstanding steps.
- Issues or delays impacting onboarding timelines.

5.1.5.2 Offboarding Activities

The Contractor shall ensure timely offboarding of personnel, including:

- Return of GFE.
- Revocation of elevated privileges.
- Deactivation of network and email accounts.
- Notification to CORs of personnel departure.

The Contractor shall provide an offboarding status in the Weekly Onboarding/Offboarding Status Report, detailing the status of all offboarding activities.

5.1.5.3 VA Mandatory Training

All resources are required to have access to the VA network and shall complete all the required VA Talent Management System (TMS) training courses within three business days of submitting an onboarding package. The Contractor shall work with its respective onboarding point of contact and CORs to obtain access to TMS to complete the mandatory training courses.

As an action under the Continuous Readiness in Information Security Program, VA's Assistant Secretary for Information and Technology issued a memorandum requiring all VA Government and task order staff to complete information security awareness and applicable role-based training. The Contractor shall ensure Training completion and track TMS Training Certificates for VA Privacy and Information Security Awareness, Rules of Behavior, Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act (HIPAA). If elevated privileges are required, Role-Based training shall be identified for completion prior to gaining additional access.

TMS training status shall be included in the Master Onboarding Tracking Document.

5.1.5.4 Master Onboarding Tracking

The Contractor shall maintain a Master Onboarding Tracking Document that includes:

- Names of all personnel engaged on the task.
- Commercial email address and phone number.
- Immediate task order CTR supervisor.
- Onboarding milestone dates.
- Initial VA Privacy and Information Security training date.
- Percentage of support of resource allocation to what specific product

Deliverable:

- A. Master Onboarding Tracking Document

5.2 HELM PRODUCT LINE MANAGEMENT SUPPORT

5.2.1 HELM PRODUCT LINE SUPPORT

The Contractor shall holistically advance the systems engineering maturity of the HELM PL by ensuring compliance with DevSecOps practices, implementing Agile methodologies, and supporting VA's Strategic Supply Chain Prioritization and Digital Modernization Strategy. To achieve this, the Contractor shall provide a qualified team of SMEs to facilitate the integration and oversight of capabilities & practices at both the product line and value stream levels, working collaboratively with stakeholders and partners. The Contractor shall support development of HELM PL briefing slides to include monthly Program Management Reviews (PMR) and Program Increment (PI) Planning committed and uncommitted objectives. The Contractor shall provide cross-functional SAFe resources to include SC Technical Expertise for the development of enhancements to the HELM products and underlying infrastructure in alignment with VA policies and procedures.

The Contractor shall:

- Track, process and manage Authority to Operate (ATO) activities for PL by working with each product and SMEs to ensure compliance.
- Provide technical leads/SAFe Roles for PL management for IT Program Manager Lead, Enterprise/Solution System Architect, Engineer Solution Lead, Data Architect Lead, Test Automation Lead, Solution Technical Lead , Cyber Security Architect /Policy Lead
- Assist in defining new application implementation requirements, to include the generation of Epics and translation to Features and User Stories which make up the Product Roadmap and Product Increment Plans while mitigating dependencies between them.
- Consolidate requirements or sequencing to generate product line efficiencies
- Understand future state requirements for the successful implementation of new applications in VA and identify impacts to legacy or dependent systems.
- Provide guidance on dependencies between implementation requirements within and outside the product to reduce risk as new capabilities are introduced and current systems are retired.
- Identify and analyze the systems targeted for integration and the design and technologies needed to implement them.
- Assist with database solutions and designs for data migrations for implementations at VA sites.
- Provide product line analyses of risks and issues to identify trends and possible opportunities for responses and mitigations.
- Understand current and future-state data flows, networking, cybersecurity, and infrastructure requirements.
- Conduct testing, training, and sustainment

5.2.2 REQUIREMENT ANALYSIS PROPOSAL INTAKE PROCESS

HELM PL requires a standardized, repeatable, and transparent intake process to manage Government provided requirements for existing products, ongoing work, and any new capabilities introduced during the PoP. The Contractor shall support the Government to mature,

operate, and continuously improve the existing HELM intake process, ensuring all requests are evaluated consistently and accurately, and in alignment with established prioritization criteria.

Applicable deliverables will be assigned during Requirements Analysis Proposal (RAP) process to ensure traceability, visibility and alignment with government expectations. The Contractor shall ensure that all intake artifacts and related workflow outputs are accessible to the Government and maintained in accordance with VA standards for configuration management, transparency, and auditability.

The Contractor shall:

- Develop and maintain intake Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), including required data elements, routing logic, approval steps, timelines, artifacts, workflows, forms, estimation model, and architecture reuse guidance.
- Ensure SOPs reflect the actual tools and processes used by HELM PL teams.
- Provide updates to the Intake Analysis and SOP, as needed or as directed, by HELM governance.

The Contractor shall not create a new custom-made intake application or standalone web portal. Instead, the Contractor shall use and enhance VA approved platforms (e.g., Jira, SharePoint, Confluence, Power Apps/Automate, or other approved tools) to support intake activities, workflow routing, estimation, documentation, and reporting.

Within the first 20 days after award, the Contractor shall implement all RAP Intake Process components associated with PWS subtasks 5.3 through 5.12. This deliverable establishes the standardized, repeatable, and transparent intake process required to manage Government-provided requirements for existing HELM PL products, ongoing work, and new capabilities introduced during the Period of Performance (PoP).

5.2.2.1 Requirements Analysis Proposal (RAP)

For each intake request, the Contractor shall develop a RAP that includes:

- The scope of the effort, high level objectives, and functional/nonfunctional requirements.
- Analyze each request to determine estimated LOE, required skill sets, potential scrum team sizing, risk factors, and estimated timeline.
- Expected labor mix and a burndown plan illustrating resource utilization across the PoP.
- Conduct interviews, workshops, or follow up sessions with VA requestors and stakeholders, as needed.
- High level schedule, milestones, and major dependencies.
- Identified risks, impediments, and mitigation recommendations.
- Required deliverables and applicable HELM PL processes.
- Establish a single, unified intake workflow for requirements—both new and existing.
- Receive, capture, and track all intake requests using VA approved tools.
- Ensure all requests remain visible to HELM PL leadership, CORs, VA PMs, product owners, and appropriate VA stakeholders.
- Coordinate with requestors to clarify scope, dependencies, constraints, and priority factors.
- Identify standardized LOE outputs to support HELM PL governance and prioritization

A RAP shall be provided within five days on Intake request, or an agreed upon date. The Contractor shall document and manage all agreed upon deviations from the RAP resulting from Agile development adjustments, changes in Government priorities, or unforeseen barriers.

A RAP must be reviewed and approved by HELM PL Leadership, VA PM, or the CORs. An approved RAP shall not constitute an obligation or directive to proceed with the applicable task(s). A contract modification will be required to execute an approved RAP.

Deliverables

- A. Intake Analysis and SOP
- B. RAP Tool
- C. HELM Product Team Request Intake Tool/Workspace

5.2.3 PROGRAM INCREMENT PLANNING

The Contractor shall support and deliver HELM PI Quarterly Planning activities to ensure alignment of product development objectives with VA strategic priorities. PI Planning shall be conducted in accordance with SAFe principles and HELM governance standards.

The Contractor shall:

- Facilitate and participate in HELM PI Planning sessions on a quarterly basis.
- Prepare and deliver all required planning artifacts, including PI Planning Agenda, Feature and Capability Backlogs aligned to VA priorities, Capacity Planning for HELM teams and resources, Dependency Identification and Resolution Plans across teams and programs, and Risk Assessment and Mitigation Strategies documented in a PI Risk Register included in PI Planning Summary Report.
- Coordinate with VA stakeholders to ensure all backlogs (initiatives, epics and stories) are prepared and prioritized and organized into Pre-Read Materials demonstrating that PL/SPL and Architecture visions are aligned, and Strength, Weakness, Opportunities and Threats (SWOT) analysis are completed prior to planning sessions and prepare PI Planning Summary Report, to include any objectives.
- Engage with other contractor teams and enterprise stakeholders during PI Planning to ensure shared understanding of dependencies, promote collaboration, and support efficient, non-duplicative execution of product development activities.
- Provide logistical and technical support for PI Planning events (virtual or in-person), including scheduling, tools setup (e.g., Jira, Rally, Mural), and facilitation.
- Provide post-PI planning support including updating the HELM PL Program Backlog and Roadmap and providing incremental improvement opportunities for each PI iteration to mature the Product Line PI Planning over time.
- Coordinate with VA Stakeholder to ensure PI Planning Objectives statuses are tracked
- Coordinate with VA stakeholders quarterly to determine actual completed objectives versus planned objectives and provide in a Quarterly PI report. The report shall provide the PI Planned vs Actual completed objectives.

Deliverables:

- A. PI Planning Agenda and Pre-Read Materials
- B. PI Planning Summary Report
- C. HELM PL Program Backlog and HELM Strategic Roadmap
- D. Quarterly PI Report

5.2.4 INNOVATION TREND ANALYSIS AND PLANNING

The Contractor shall support innovation and modernization efforts by identifying and analyzing emerging technologies and industry trends. The Contractor shall:

- Support HELM PL leadership to create baseline metrics and a roadmap structure for digital modernization strategies and to improve modern application architectures.
- Advise HELM PL of Artificial Intelligence (AI) driven analytics tools to identify performance bottlenecks and provide actionable insights, verified by subject matter experts, on emerging technologies that can improve system performance, enhance automation, and ensure cost efficiency.
- When requested, provide recommendations on emerging technologies assessing their potential impact on performance, automation, and operational efficiency.
- In cooperation with product managers and business stakeholders, identify realistic potential use cases for emerging technologies within supply chain.
- The Contractor shall advise software obsolescence planning for technical refreshes per TRM and Digital Transformation Center (DTC).

5.3 SCRUM TEAM SUPPORT (OPTIONAL TASK 1)

VA may exercise this Optional Task for Scrum Team support, at any time and from time to time within the base and/or each option period, to support HELM PL products and projects with the continuous delivery pipelines as described in PWS sections 5.5 through 5.12. Each exercise may encompass more than one product or project area. The Contractor shall provide Agile Scrum Teams to support VA Products delivery, including development, testing, integration, data activities, configuration, training, sustainment, and modernization. These teams shall follow SAFe Agile, DevSecOps, and HELM PL governance practices and shall meet or exceed maturity expectations for iterative delivery.

These teams shall provide comprehensive end-to-end support across the SDLC which may include:

- Backlog refinement, elaboration, and decomposition into Features and User Stories
- Sprint Planning, execution, reviews, and retrospectives
- Building, testing, and delivering working software increments
- Supporting DevSecOps pipelines and automation
- Integrating with dependent solutions and enterprise services
- Providing Tier II/III troubleshooting and sustainment support
- Supporting PI Planning and Product Line roadmap execution
- Ensuring delivery of high-quality, traceable, and testable work products
- Enabling accurate measurement of business value, throughput, and delivery efficiency
- O&M sustainment services
- Technical Support

Scrum Team Type and Sizes:

Scrum Teams shall be activated only when exercised by the Government via a contract modification. See the HELM Intake Process, see PWS paragraph 5.2.2. A Full-Time Equivalent is considered 1920 hrs. per 12 months. All team types follow the same activation rules, reporting

requirements, and SAFe compliance. The specific scope of functionality to be delivered for each build in the optional task shall be determined through requirements submitted through the Intake Process. Teams shall be priced for a monthly increment with PoPs ranging from one to twelve months and shall coincide with the period in which it is exercised. Each Team exercised shall not exceed 12 months or the period in which it is exercised. HELM PMs prior to start of a build cycle when applicable shall approve based on current business priorities.

5.3.1 MICRO SCRUM TEAM

The Contractor shall provide a scrum team consisting of up to 1-2 FTE resources comprised of the appropriate technical skill sets to support multiple builds throughout the PoP. This team size is recommended for focused enhancements, technical tasks, platform/DevSecOps support, or discovery work.

This may be exercised up to the Not to Exceed (NTE) amount of 798 months over the life of the task order.

5.3.2 SMALL SCRUM TEAM

The Contractor shall provide a scrum team consisting of up to 3-4 FTE resources comprised of the appropriate technical skill sets to support multiple builds throughout the PoP. This team size is recommended for focused enhancements, technical tasks, platform/DevSecOps support, or discovery work.

This may be exercised up to the NTE amount of 798 months over the life of the task order.

5.3.3 MEDIUM SCRUM TEAM

The Contractor shall provide a scrum team consisting of 5-6 FTE resources comprised of the appropriate technical skillsets to support multiple builds throughout the PoP. This team size is recommended for post deployment support, development efforts, backlog, ongoing enhancements, or integrations.

This may be exercised up to the NTE amount of 912 months over the life of the task order.

5.3.4 LARGE SCRUM TEAM

The Contractor shall provide a scrum team consisting of 7 plus FTE resources comprised of the appropriate technical skillsets to support multiple builds throughout the PoP. This team size may be appropriate for major modernization efforts, high volume feature delivery, or large backlog surges

This may be exercised up to the NTE amount of 684 months over the life of the task order.

5.4 HIGHLY TECHNICAL SCRUM TEAM SUPPORT (OPTIONAL TASK 2)

VA may exercise this optional task for highly technical Scrum team(s) at any time and from time to time within the base and/or each option period, to support HELM PL products and projects with the continuous delivery pipelines as described in PWS sections 5.5 through 5.12. Each exercise may encompass more than one product or project area and shall coincide with the period in which it is exercised.

When requirements exceed the capabilities or depth of standard scrum teams, the Government Contractor shall provide highly skilled Technical SME Scrum Teams capable of rapidly scaling to meet evolving VA requirements. These teams shall deliver advanced technical expertise to support DevSecOps activities and conduct specialized analyses, including AI driven analytics and solutioning, for needs that extend beyond the planned product backlog associated with HELM Integration and Modernization. SME support may be required for urgent or complex tasks involving data management, implementation support, VA specific system integrations, network engineering, or other advanced technical issues not addressed within standard sprint execution. These teams follow the same activation and pricing structure but include specialized technical skill sets.

Examples of SME skillsets may include, but are not limited to:

- Cloud engineering and architecture (AWS, Azure, VA Enterprise Cloud, Platform One)
- AI/Machine Learning (ML) engineering, data science, predictive modeling, and advanced analytics
- Cybersecurity engineering, ZTA, Risk Management Framework (RMF)/ Assessment and Authorization (A&A) Support
- DevSecOps engineering, CI/CD pipeline development, automation, and platform hardening
- SME knowledge for Enterprise Solution & integration architecture to include (Fast Healthcare Interoperability Resources (FHIR) Enterprise Service Bus (ESB) patterns)
- Application Programming Interface(API) and integration engineering, including VA specific interoperability and FHIR based integrations
- Network engineering, firewall configuration, and VA enterprise network optimization
- Database engineering; Extract, Transfer, Load (ETL) development; data migration; and enterprise data governance
- Performance engineering, resiliency engineering, load testing.
- VA-specific system integration (Master Veteran Index (MVI), Veterans Health Information System and Technology Architecture (VistA) Interfaces, Lighthouse, APIs etc. as applicable)
- ESB/ Enterprise Application Integration (EAI) integration frameworks
- VA Enterprise Logging, monitoring, and observability tools
- Specialized support for VA unique compliance frameworks, configuration standards, and change management requirements

5.4.1 MICRO HIGHLY TECHNICAL SCRUM TEAM

The Micro Team shall consist of 1-2 FTE resources, consisting of highly skilled technical experts, with the ability to scale based on VA requirements

This may be exercised up to the NTE amount of 684 months over the life of the task order.

5.4.2 SMALL HIGHLY TECHNICAL SCRUM TEAM

The Small shall consist of 3-4 FTE resources, consisting of highly skilled technical experts, with the ability to scale based on VA requirements. Minimum required roles and qualifications include: The Contractor shall provide product advanced skillsets in areas related to DevSecOps support.

This may be exercised up to the NTE amount of 570 months over the life of the task order.

5.4.3 MEDIUM HIGHLY TECHNICAL SCRUM TEAM

The Medium shall consist of 5-6 FTE resources, consisting of highly skilled technical experts, with the ability to scale based on VA requirements. Minimum required roles and qualifications include: The Contractor shall provide product advanced skillsets in areas related to DevSecOps support.

This may be exercised up to the NTE amount of 342 months over the life of the task order.

5.4.4 LARGE HIGHLY TECHNICAL SCRUM TEAM

The Large Team shall consist of 7 plus FTE resources, consisting of highly skilled technical experts, with the ability to scale based on VA requirements. Minimum required roles and qualifications include: The Contractor shall provide product advanced skillsets in areas related to DevSecOps support.

This may be exercised up to the NTE amount of 171 months over the life of the task order.

5.5 SUPPLY CHAIN PRODUCT SUPPORT (TEAMS)

The activities in this product/project area are applicable to Optional Task One Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.3 and Optional Task Two Highly Technical Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.4.

5.5.1 SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT LIFECYCLE ACTIVITIES

The Contractor shall provide a hybrid SDLC approach that integrates Agile iterative delivery with the documentation, governance, compliance, and quality controls required by VA. The Contractor shall continuously support the iterative build and development methodology to complete all epics and user stories identified in the backlog and shall ensure that delivery practices remain consistent with the SDLC approach defined within PWS Section 5.5 and all related subsections. Prioritization shall be informed by discovery activities, stakeholder input, operational needs, and product Key Performance Indicators/Objectives and Key Results (KPIs/OKRs). KPIs/OKRs shall be developed in coordination with the VA Product Owner and stakeholders and shall include methodologies that enable objective, lifecycle long evaluation of product performance and user outcomes. The hybrid model shall enable evolutionary (iterative and incremental) product development that produces high-quality outcomes in a cost-effective, timely, and collaborative manner. This requires open communication and coordination across all participants contributing to a project, program, or portfolio with multiple stakeholders and consumers.

The Contractor shall design, configure, develop, modernize, enhance, maintain, test, and deploy builds of each product on a recurring basis no shorter than two weeks and no longer than three months throughout the Period of Performance. The Contractor shall provide all deliverables Build and Deployment Packages and artifacts specified herein that satisfy VA documentation, compliance, and code delivery requirements, and shall ensure these artifacts conform to applicable VA policies and enterprise standards. The Contractor shall leverage and reuse relevant content and existing documentation where appropriate to meet the expectations of required package deliverables.

The Contractor shall utilize DevSecOps principles, hybrid SDLC practices, and SAFe frameworks in partnership with VA to further mature the HELM PL. The Contractor shall follow an agile process model for the development of HELM capabilities, including ongoing

requirements, elaboration and decomposition, iterative design and solutioning, and continuous integration of working software. The Contractor shall deliver, when applicable, an Updated Technical Design and Product Schedule and Roadmap for each product when applicable. The Contractor shall ensure that all SDLC activities align with evolving VA governance processes, security controls, and enterprise architecture methodologies, allowing the SDLC approach to adapt as VA standards and toolsets mature over the life of the task order.

The Contractor shall produce all required SDLC deliverables in accordance with VA standards, including but not limited to Sprint/Iteration Planning Artifacts, Build and Deployment Packages, Compliance Documentation, Updated Technical Designs, Product Schedules/Roadmaps, and Product Plans/Modernization Roadmaps with associated KPIs/OKRs. All deliverables shall be maintained as current, review ready artifacts that support VA governance, traceability, and oversight throughout the Period of Performance.

Deliverables:

- A. Sprint/Iteration Planning Artifacts
- B. Build and Deployment Packages
- C. Compliance Documentation as applicable
- D. Updated Technical Design
- E. Product Schedule / Roadmap
- F. Product Plan / Modernization Roadmap with KPIs/OKRs

5.5.2 CONFIGURATION MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall:

- Comply with the existing Configuration Management plans in place and offer procedural improvements to VA to mature existing processes.
- Identify the standard and unique aspects of configuration management to be performed for each Agile Product Team (APT) by establishing a Product Configuration Management (CM) Plan (PCMP) which meets OIT VA CM plan requirements. The Contractor shall reflect all CM required activities and standards in each product-level CM plan while determining the unique aspects of the product which require individualized procedures. The CORs and VA PM shall approve the PCMP.
- Deliver a Recommended List of Configuration Items as part of the PCMP to be placed under configuration and change control. The Contractor shall identify types of configuration items pertaining to each product to be placed under configuration management. Based on Health Portfolio requirements, and the unique needs or nature of each product, the Contractor shall determine the components within each product that must be under configuration control.
- Use a VA-approved tool and repository for all software source code and electronic artifact configuration and version management. The Contractor shall use the VA-approved tool to manage change, activity, issue, action, risk, and other product data as prescribed by VA standards and processes. If assigned a product using tools that are being decommissioned the Contractor shall assist the VA Tools Team in migrating products using other Change and/or Configuration Management tools.
- Ensure that all product software and non-software artifacts are versioned correctly according to VA standards and follow a build/release promotion versioning approach which identifies all major and minor update changes to the components.
- Create Project and Product Artifacts baselined and versioned in the CM repository to allow the tool to show active and past histories of the check-ins and check-outs of all

software components, data, and software project engineering documents. Maintain all baselines of software, software builds, and electronic artifacts in the repository, labeling updates and versions according to CM procedures.

- Establish and maintain status reporting on change and configuration management activity and ensure VA approved tools data records and artifacts are filed and updated daily.
- Develop and manage a CM process that supports all necessary changes for the project including changes to Definition of Done, Acceptance Criteria and any other items deemed necessary.
- Create and maintain baselines of all software, builds, and electronic artifacts in the repository, and develop a Version Description Document (VDD) for all product releases.

Deliverables:

- A. Product Configuration Management Plan
- B. Version Description Document

5.5.3 RISK & ISSUE MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall perform risk management for all work conducted under this task order and shall enter risk information into the Product Risk Management Registry using the VA approved toolset the VA Product (Line) Accountability and Reporting System (VA PARS) Dashboard, JIRA/GITHUB and/or other OIT approved tools maintained by the VA.

The Contractor shall:

- Comply with the existing Risk Management Plan (RMP) by the VA.
- Use the VA approved tool to create, update, and actively manage a project risk register (risk log) that identifies potential circumstances that may negatively impact project success, describes the possible impacts, and documents actions to reduce or eliminate those impacts. Critical risks, as determined by the VA PM, shall also be recorded in the VA PARS Dashboard, JIRA/GITHUB and/or other OIT approved tools.
- Use the VA approved tool to support and facilitate risk meetings and reviews.
- Actively manage risks and issues, determine level of effort, develop approved mitigations and Plans of Action and Milestones (POA&M), and assess or reassess probability and severity throughout the project lifecycle.
- Assess the status of assigned risks and provide a weekly Risk Management Status Report to the VA for inclusion in the broader Risk Management Registry. When new risks arise that could affect development, testing, or deployment schedules, the Contractor shall notify the CORs and VA PM via email within 24 hours. The email subject line shall state: "{Project Name} Risk Alert Notification."

5.5.4 SCHEDULE MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall create, maintain, analyze, and report individual product Roadmaps and Release Train Schedules in the VA-approved toolset. The Contractor shall provide schedule updates within the VA-approved toolset on a weekly basis. The Contractor shall evolve the roadmap, iteratively maturing. HELM PL support shall include management of patches to mitigate collisions in addition to the PL tracking. HELM PL tracking shall be planned/coordinated to ensure optimized sequencing of releases to avoid patch collisions, and all risks are documented in VA approved toolset within two days of the risk being realized.

The Contractor shall rollup product roadmaps to produce HELM PL Strategic Roadmap.

Deliverables:

- A. Individual Product(s) Roadmap
- B. HELM PL Strategic RoadMap

5.5.5 USER EXPERIENCE MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall apply Human Centered Design (HCD) principles across HELM PL development, modernization, and sustainment activities to ensure solutions are intuitive, accessible, and aligned with end user needs. All user experience (UX) research, findings, and design decisions shall be documented and maintained in VA approved tools to support traceability, PL visibility, and continuous improvement. The Contractor shall ensure all UX research, insights, artifacts, and design decisions are documented in VA approved tools and linked to requirements, backlog items, and PI Planning artifacts to maintain full traceability and alignment with HELM PL governance.

The Contractor shall conduct user research to identify and validate the needs, workflows, and operational challenges of VA supply chain, logistics, and acquisition stakeholders supported by HELM SCM capabilities. Research activities shall gather input from representative user groups across VA to inform requirements, process improvements, and solution design. Findings shall be incorporated into system development and modernization efforts to ensure capabilities are usable, aligned with mission needs, and supportive of VA's standardized, streamlined, and modern enterprise supply chain objectives. All research shall follow established human centered design practices and comply with VA accessibility and usability standards.

The Contractor shall:

- Conduct user research studies to understand users' goals, needs, and pain points, applying these insights to define product functionality.
- Engage with product stakeholders to determine the user base, propose survey questions, and identify the best methods for survey distribution.
- Disseminate surveys, collect feedback, and analyze the data to provide insights into how products can be updated based on user input.
- Craft and test design deliverables such as wireframes and prototypes to facilitate usability testing and agile development.
- Document all findings and insights in a User Experience Monthly Report and update the product backlog accordingly

Deliverable:

- A. User Experience Report

5.5.6 AGILE REQUIREMENTS ELABORATION

The Contractor shall complete an initial Backlog Refinement session with the VA team to properly understand and elaborate business Agile requirements. The outcome of this session shall be a complete review of the initial user stories, consensus among team members, including user stories added as a result of Backlog Refinement. This would be achieved by decomposing Initiatives into Epics, Epics into Stories and tasks that represent stakeholder needs, business requirements, business rules, requirements visualizations and user story elaborations. Backlog Refinement and prioritization with the VA team are continued throughout the product life cycle and shall be managed throughout the PoP. The Contractor shall facilitate any stakeholder briefings, meetings and/or elicitation sessions.

The Contractor shall:

- Ensure all Epics, including Standard Epics, as defined in Attachment 3: HS Agile _Epics Operating HS Agile Lifecycle Management Library Epic Document– Current Product Line Backlog, are included and executed as appropriate within the overall Agile Backlog Grooming effort.
- Populate the backlog during an initial planning session identifying all features the team considers relevant to building the product.
- Establish initial Unit of measurement (e.g. Story Points) as the estimated relative complexity of user stories.
- Prioritize the backlog of initiatives, epics, stories, and tasks, in collaboration with the VA team using the VA Approved tool to create a refined backlog report.
- Execute requirements reviews with stakeholders and record results of reviews using the VA Approved Tool, updating requirements data as a result of the reviews.
- Identify the non-production environmental access that is needed 30 days prior to configuration start.
- Ensure initiatives, epics, stories, and tasks, stakeholder needs, visualizations, stories, and other sources of requirement's information for functional and non-functional requirements are input and maintained in VA Approved Tools to comprise a Requirements Package.
- Ensure all requirements' data is under change control and is fully linked to work items that show traceability to design changes, configurable items, test cases and test results.
- Provide notification upon completion that the Requirements Package is ready for VA Review and Approval.

Deliverable:

A. Refined Backlog Report

5.5.7 CONTENT DESIGN

The Contractor shall:

- Employ design process management by breaking designs into small, bite-sized implementations and collecting data from each deployment to inform priorities and decisions in the next iteration.
- Write and edit plain language content. See <https://design.va.gov/> for the style guide.
- Ensure consistency and continuity in Health product information architecture, including URL schema, page layout, menus and navigation, user flows, and search engine optimization. Work with all VA Product Teams to incorporate new, both authenticated and unauthenticated, content and tools, into the Information Architecture Document to be included in the Solution Architecture Package (PWS Section 5.9.1 Solution Architecture Planning and Execution) of HELM products.
- Craft, test, and deploy design deliverables, including Wireframes, low- and high-fidelity prototypes, or interactive web forms to be included in the Solution Architecture Package (PWS Section 5.9.1, Solution Architecture Planning and Execution) to facilitate usability testing and agile development of health products. As appropriate, create and update prototypes to conduct facilitated demos or usability testing to elicit feedback for improvements to the design.

- Develop designs that adhere to VA's application of the U.S. Web Design System, available on <https://design.va.gov>. If the Contractor determines a need for a new pattern, the Contractor shall collaborate with PM/COR to design that pattern. The Contractor shall work with the Enterprise Architecture team to build and validate new enterprise design pattern and document within the User Experience Design Document
- Support and comply with all user experience guidelines and standards as defined by VA, currently at <https://department-of-veterans-affairs.github.io/va-digital-service-handbook/>

5.5.8 PRODUCT ARCHITECTURE

The Contractor shall lead architecture and discovery activities for each assigned HELM product, ensuring that solution's intent, requirements, and technical direction are clearly defined, documented, and aligned with PL guidance. The Contractor shall be responsible for translating business needs into product-specific architectural models, epics, features, and stories, while managing product-level risks, dependencies, and design considerations. The Contractor shall work directly with VA customers and product stakeholders to understand operational needs, prioritize capabilities, establish the product vision and roadmap, and ensure that the product's technical architecture supports both near-term delivery and long-term modernization objectives.

The Contractor shall maintain accurate and current architecture artifacts and guide work through the product team as described below.

- Perform product-level discovery and planning for the assigned product, including review of existing VA solutions, dependent products, and business processes specific to that product.
- Build and maintain a HELM-wide SAFe Architectural Runway by working with PL leadership, solution architects, and dependent teams to define and evolve shared technical foundations, architectural enablers, integration points, and cross product capabilities; update quarterly prior to each PI.
- Work closely with VA customers for that product to understand requirements, map needs to VA capabilities, and support refinement of epics into features and stories.
- Develop AS IS Architecture Models for the specific product using VA-prescribed and enterprise-approved architecture formats (such as DoDAF and UAF), capturing user feedback, technical baselines, and product-specific process flows.
- Develop TO BE Architecture Models for the product using the current VA-approved enterprise architecture methodology, representing the future-state architecture that aligns with Product Line and enterprise direction.
- Develop and maintain current architecture diagrams (logical, network, and dataflow) for the product, update each release and consistent with the enterprise architecture modeling approach in use at the time.
- Develop a Solution-Level Roadmap for a particular HELM product that provides an outline as to how various products, technologies, or systems will be integrated over a multi-year horizon.
- Define solution-level (product-specific) epics with acceptance criteria and ensure alignment to product goals and Product Line architecture.
- Develop the Solution Architecture for the product, including technical, business, and data models/components, in accordance with the architectural modeling standards and practices adopted by VA during the period of performance.
- Support early user interface and technical prototypes for the product.

- Support business process modeling for product workflows.
- Guide product team execution by maintaining requirements, updating solution intent, and ensuring alignment to planned KPIs during PI execution.

Deliverables:

- A. Product Line SAFe Architectural Runway
- B. AS IS Architecture Model
- C. TO BE Architecture Model
- D. Architecture Diagrams
- E. Solution-Level Roadmap (product-specific)
- F. Solution Architecture (product-specific)
- G. Product-Specific Data Models
- H. User Research Artifacts
- I. Solution (Product) Roadmap

5.5.9 PRODUCT TESTING

The Contractor shall perform product-specific testing activities in alignment with the hybrid SDLC model, Agile development practices, and continuous delivery approach described in this PWS. The Contractor shall conduct testing on a recurring, iterative basis to validate functionality, performance, accessibility, security, and interoperability of each product throughout the development lifecycle. Testing shall be integrated into every sprint and release cycle and shall comply with VA policy, VA governance processes, and VA-approved testing requirements, including Health Portfolio Jira Management Requirements where applicable.

The Contractor shall design, implement, and maintain automated test scripts wherever feasible to improve coverage, reduce manual effort, and support consistent, repeatable validation of product functionality. Automated regression testing and continuous integration capabilities shall be leveraged using VA TRM-approved tools. The Contractor shall support manual testing where necessary for specialized validation or compliance activities.

The Contractor shall work collaboratively with product teams, VA stakeholders, and dependent solution groups to define test conditions, maintain alignment with evolving requirements, validate acceptance criteria, and ensure readiness for release. The Contractor shall support continuous improvement by refining test approaches, expanding automation capabilities, and improving test quality over the Period of Performance.

5.5.9.1 Integrated Testing Activities

The Contractor shall plan, execute, document, and maintain testing activities across all phases of the system lifecycle, including user story, sprint, build, release, and production readiness testing.

At a minimum, testing shall include:

- Unit testing
- Functional testing
- Accessibility testing (Section 508)
- System testing
- Reliability testing
- Usability testing
- Interoperability testing

- Regression testing (automated where feasible)
- Security testing
- Performance and load testing

The Contractor shall conduct testing of non-functional requirements, including installation, configuration, backout, rollback, failover, and recovery procedures. Testing shall utilize continuous integration and automated regression capabilities using VA TRM-approved tools, such as Selenium, JUnit, NUnit, Jenkins, GitLab CI/CD, Cucumber, Postman, and Cypress, provided they are approved at the time of use.

The Contractor shall participate in and support enterprise and compliance testing activities, including:

- Security assessments
- Accessibility compliance reviews
- Performance and load testing events
- Technical standards validation
- Architectural compliance reviews
- User Acceptance Testing (UAT)
- Initial Operational Capability (IOC) validation

Security scanning shall be performed using VA-approved tools, including Web Application Security Assessments (WASA), static code analysis (e.g., Fortify), and dependency/vulnerability scanning solutions. The Contractor shall remediate identified vulnerabilities in accordance with VA-defined severity timelines.

5.5.9.2 Test Planning and Documentation

The Contractor shall:

- Develop and maintain a Test Plan within the VA Quality Manager tool.
- Provide complete Test Strategy and Test Execution content using VA-provided templates.
- Enter all test cases, test scripts (automated and manual), test data, execution results, and supporting artifacts into the VA-approved tool.
- Maintain and update the Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM) to ensure bi-directional traceability between requirements, test cases, defects, and releases.
- Update all testing artifacts daily to ensure visibility and accuracy of status.
- Place all testing artifacts under version control in a VA-approved repository.
- Develop and deliver a Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM) that documents and maps all requirements to corresponding design elements, test cases, and validation evidence, and shall update the RTM throughout the period of performance to ensure complete traceability.

5.5.9.3 Defect Management

The Contractor shall:

- Log all defects in the VA-approved tool within one business day of identification.
- Assign severity and impact levels consistent with VA-defined criteria.
- Support the VA PM and CORs in defect prioritization and backlog grooming.

- Track defects through resolution, retesting, and closure.

Defects shall be remediated within the following maximum timeframes:

- Critical – 5 business days
- High – 10 business days
- Medium – 30 business days
- Low – As prioritized by the VA PM

Defects shall not be closed without documented validation evidence and successful retesting.

5.5.9.4 Reporting

The Contractor shall provide:

- Test execution status reporting per sprint and per release.
- A Test Summary Report at the conclusion of each release (or sprint if required).
- Performance and load testing reports.
- Security scan results and documented remediation evidence.
- Daily defect status updates.

All assessment results from Contractor-led and VA-led reviews shall be consolidated in the VA-approved tool for reporting and audit purposes.

5.5.9.5 Release Readiness Criteria

Prior to production deployment, the Contractor shall:

- Execute no less than ninety-five percent (95%) of planned test cases for the release.
- Ensure all Critical and High defects are resolved or formally accepted by the VA PM.
- Ensure zero (0) open Critical or High security vulnerabilities unless risk acceptance is formally approved by the Authorizing Official (AO).
- Obtain documented VA PM approval to proceed to production.

Deliverables:

- A. Test Plans
- B. Test Cases
- C. Test Scripts (including automated test scripts where applicable)
- D. Test Execution & Summary Reports
- E. Defect Management Reports
- F. Requirements Traceability Matrix (RTM)
- G. Test Summary Report(s) (per sprint and/or release as required)

5.5.10 DATA MANAGEMENT AND MIGRATION SUPPORT

The Contractor shall provide support for database solutions and design strategies for data migration during VA site implementations, and shall supply resources for site data mapping, extraction, transformation, migration, analytics, and validation from VA legacy systems (e.g., AEMS/MERS, GIP, Maximo) to modernize systems as required. Data may need to be delivered to third parties (e.g., MEDLOG) in accordance with the standards provided. The Contractor shall comply with PWS paragraph 5.5.1 SDLC Activities for all data migration development efforts and shall adhere to applicable government and VA standards, including security and organizational controls for scripts, tools, and artifacts.

5.5.10.1 Data Tools Development and Testing Support

The Contractor shall design, develop, test, update, and manage tools to obtain and manage data sets from disparate sources, including subject matter expert input. The Contractor shall provide project management plans for these tool development efforts and be accountable to cost and schedule; tool development and updates shall follow VA TRM-approved technologies and practices, as applicable.

Key activities include:

- Developing and testing data tools to obtain and manage data sets from various sources.
- Managing updates to tools and supporting ongoing operations aligned to the project management plan.
- Providing project management plans and periodic updates that govern scope, schedule, and cost for data tool development and testing.

5.5.10.2 Data Extraction and Analytics

The Contractor shall perform mapping, extraction, transformation, migration, and analytics for data from disparate legacy sources, and provide analytical support to establish and refine extraction, transformation, and migration standards and processes. The Contractor shall troubleshoot and resolve identified data issues, and provide periodic input to updates and/or assist in establishing the Data Migration Plan (DMP), including schedules where one is not already established by the VA. The Contractor shall adhere to government standards where applicable for the security and organization of extraction and transformation scripts.

Key activities include:

- Developing, organizing, and maintaining data extraction scripts.
- Establishing and updating the Data Migration Plan and schedule (as applicable).
- Delivering mapped and transformed data to VA systems and approved third parties (e.g., MEDLOG) per provided standards.

5.5.10.3 Data Mapping and Validation

The Contractor shall perform comprehensive data mapping analysis to ensure data from legacy systems is identified, cleansed, enriched, and structured appropriately for migration. The Contractor shall develop and provide a Data Mapping and Validation Plan, execute validation activities, analyze results, and identify corrections for any data issues. A Data Mapping Document shall be maintained to reflect the authoritative mapping rules, transformations, and quality checks for each migration.

Key activities include:

- Producing and maintaining a Data Mapping and Validation Plan.
- Conducting data profiling, cleansing, enrichment, and validation aligned to VA standards.
- Generating Data Mapping Analysis and Validation Results and implementing corrective actions.

5.5.10.4 Migration Planning, Environment Support, and Testing

The Contractor shall support the migration of products between environments (e.g., development, test, staging, production) by coordinating with infrastructure points of contact and providing technical support for testing, configuration, and documentation. The Contractor shall

develop and provide a Migration Support Plan that identifies tasks, schedules, and roles, along with a Migration Test Plan that outlines the testing approach and pass/fail criteria; execution results shall be documented in a Migration Test Summary Report.

Key activities include:

- Coordinating environment migrations with infrastructure POCs.
- Providing technical support for migration testing, configuration, and documentation.
- Developing and maintaining migration planning and testing artifacts that confirm readiness and quality.

Deliverables:

- A. Data Tools Development and Testing Project Management Plans - due four (4) weeks after kickoff
- B. Updates to the Data Tools Development and Testing Project Management Plans - as required
- C. Data Extraction Scripts - developed and updated as needed
- D. Data Migration Plan and Schedule (or updates, as applicable) - as needed
- E. Data Mapping Document
- F. Data Mapping and Validation Plan
- G. Data Mapping Analysis and Validation Results
- H. Data Migration Support Plan
- I. Data Migration Test Plan
- J. Data Migration Test Summary Report

5.5.11 TRAINING SUPPORT

The Contractor shall provide comprehensive training support for product users to ensure effective adoption, operational readiness, and ongoing proficiency. Training shall comply with VA standards, use VA approved platforms, and be tailored to accommodate both new and existing users.

The Contractor shall provide training based on requirements which can contain the following:

- Develop and Deliver Virtual Training - provide virtual learning sessions, including instructor led virtual classes, webinars, demonstrations, and interactive training modules to support onboarding and ongoing education for HELM Product Line users.
- The Contractor shall provide recordings of training webinars.
- Create Virtual Training Materials and Artifacts - Develop and maintain user focused training materials, including presentations, guides, reference documents, job aids, videos, and self-paced learning content. All materials shall be stored in VA approved repositories.
- Support New and Existing Users - Deliver training designed for both new users requiring introductory instruction and existing users requiring refresher training or updated instruction for new functionality or existing functionality due to bug fixes, enhancements, or procedural changes.
- Provide Post Training Support - Offer follow up sessions, office hours support, and Q&A opportunities to ensure users can effectively apply learned content and incorporate updated processes related to HELM Product Line solutions.

- Maintain Training Schedules and Attendance - Coordinate with VA stakeholders to schedule training sessions, manage registration, track attendance, and report training metrics in VA approved formats.
- Update Training Content with Each Release - Enhance or revise training content to align with system updates, new features, user interface changes, bug fixes or workflow modifications resulting from HELM Product Line releases or enhancements.
- Develop TMS Training when applicable
- Provide comprehensive Training Plan

Deliverables:

- A. Training Plan
- B. Virtual Training Schedule
- C. Training Materials and User Guides
- D. Training Attendance and Metrics Reports
- E. Updated Training Content per Release
- F. Recorded Training Webinar

5.5.12 AI/ML OPTIMIZATION AND PREDICTIVE ANALYTICS

The Contractor shall incorporate artificial intelligence and machine learning (AI/ML) capabilities for HELM PL to optimize products and reduce operational risks.

The Contractor shall:

- Implement AI/ML algorithms to enhance predictive forecasting and provide near real-time data insights into inventory levels and demand. Provide an AI/ML Model Validation Report to describe and validate these algorithms.
- Develop automated capabilities for the identification and validation of product substitutions during supply disruptions to maintain continuity of care. Provide a Predictive Forecasting Analysis defining these capabilities.
- Provide actionable analytics to empower stakeholders with information needed for continuous improvement and operational excellence.
- Provide a Product Substitution Automation Guide to describe how product substitutions are implemented by the system.

Deliverables:

- A. AI/ML Model Validation Report
- B. Predictive Forecasting Analysis
- C. Product Substitution Automation Guide

5.6 RELEASE SUPPORT

The activities in this product/project area are applicable to Optional Task One Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.3 and Optional Task Two Highly Technical Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.4.

The Contractor shall support the VA DevSecOps Release Process. The Release Process governs deployment of new functionality, enhancements, and defect remediation in alignment with the VA DevSecOps Release Framework. The Contractor shall use the VA approved release calendaring process and toolset (e.g., ServiceNow) to track release activities, dependencies, special works in progress, and production deployment events.

The Contractor shall provide all required information to populate and maintain ServiceNow release calendar entries for each release.

The DevSecOps Release Process includes pre-release and release activities and may require coordination with an appropriate Release Train Engineer (RTE) Lead.

5.6.1 PRERELEASE SUPPORT

The Contractor shall support the HELM PL Release Process throughout the build lifecycle, ensuring alignment with HELM Agile, DevSecOps, and CI/CD workflows. VA Release Agents shall review artifacts for completeness, traceability, and compliance with Release Process standards. The Contractor shall integrate secure code scanning, CI/CD pipelines, configuration validation, dependency inventories, and artifact promotion controls.

The Contractor shall prepare the Build Release Package, including:

- Production Operations Manual (POM) / Technical Manual (workflows, RACI, dependencies, monitoring indicators)
- User Guide for business and HELM PL users
- Version Description Document (VDD) (configuration, traceability, audit support)
- Transition Plan (architecture, interfaces, environments, pipeline dependencies)
- Deployment & Installation Guide (deployment patterns, rollback, contingency, Disaster Recovery (DR), security keys)
- All ATO related documentation, including RMF, scanning evidence, and continuous monitoring items.
- The Contractor shall collaborate with the VA PM, HELM Leadership, and stakeholders to develop a comprehensive Build Release Package that satisfies all HELM release readiness, deployment, and governance requirements.
- The VA assigned contractor Release Agents shall perform ongoing reviews of HELM product artifacts within VA mandated repositories and provide feedback on documentation completeness, traceability, and compliance with Release Process standards.
- The Contractor shall ensure that code commits, test results, configuration items, dependency inventories, and deployment artifacts meet HELM quality gates and are properly linked in HELM repositories, backlogs, and pipeline orchestration tools.
- Pre-Release Support shall integrate HELM's DevSecOps toolchain, including automated CI/CD pipelines, secure code scanning, configuration validation, and artifact promotion controls.

All prerelease activities shall comply with HELM PL governance, VA Agile/DevSecOps policies, VA security and quality standards, and CI/CD integration requirements.

Deliverables:

- A. Build Release Package

5.6.2 ASSESSMENT AND AUTHORIZATION SUPPORT

The Contractor shall provide documentation, support, and coordination with VA Information Security Officers (ISO), Field Security Services (FSS), and the Office of Cyber Security (OCS) to support ATO compliance.

The Contractor shall:

- Support assessment requirements in accordance with VA Directive 6500 and VA Handbook 6500.
- Participate in vulnerability scans and quality reviews in accordance with NIST SP 800-53 Rev.5 and other applicable guidance.
- Remediate critical and high severity vulnerabilities identified through government scans.
- Provide vulnerability scanning reports and risk assessments in accordance with NIST SP 800-30 Rev. 1.
- Comply with OMB Memorandum 11-11 and VA enterprise cybersecurity strategy requirements.
- Support secure authentication via SAML tokens.
- Develop and maintain Assessment & Authorization artifacts required for ATO requests as described in NIST SP 800-37 Rev. 2.

The Contractor shall provide Assessment & Authorization artifacts, as necessary, which include, but are not limited to:

- Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA)
- Risk Assessment (RA)
- Security Configuration Checklist (SCC)
- System Interconnection Agreements (MOU/Interconnection)
- Interconnection Security Agreement (ISA), as applicable

Deliverables:

- A. Vulnerability Scanning Reports and Risk Assessments
- B. A&A Artifacts Required by the A&A Review Process

5.6.3 INITIAL OPERATING CAPABILITY SUPPORT

The Contractor shall support the Initial Operating Capability (IOC) evaluation for HELM PL product line, including Asset Management, Inventory Management, Prosthetics, and other supply chain modernization solutions. IOC is a limited production release conducted after all testing has been completed and user acceptance has been granted. During IOC, the Contractor shall assist HELM PL by tracking issues, investigating defects, supporting remediation activities, and ensuring that IOC entry and exit criteria are met for each applicable HELM product.

The Contractor shall support a 10-day errorfree IOC period in the production environment. All issues and defects identified during IOC shall be documented in the Defect/Fix Status Report. For each defect, the Contractor shall prepare an IOC Defect Resolution Plan that identifies the corrective action, required updates to software code or documentation, and impacts to schedule. Upon CORs approval, the Contractor shall execute the approved plan and deliver updated software source code, compiled code, and supporting documentation.

Following any defect correction, the IOC period shall continue for a minimum of five consecutive error free business days before IOC may be exited. The Contractor shall coordinate installation and configuration of updates at VA test sites and support validation of fixes across the relevant HELM product lines.

The Contractor shall support all IOC entry and exit activities and shall prepare and deliver an IOC Entry Request and final IOC Exit Summary documenting completion of all requirements and readiness for full deployment.

Deliverables:

- A. Defect/Fix Status Report
- B. IOC Defect Resolution Plan
- C. Updated Software Source Code, Compiled Code, and Supporting Documentation
- D. IOC Entry Request and IOC Exit Summary

5.6.4 RELEASE AND DEPLOYMENT SUPPORT

The Contractor shall support both release activities (preparing, documenting, packaging, and obtaining required approvals for a software version) and deployment activities (executing the movement of that version into production). The Contractor shall ensure all Pre-Release, A&A, and IOC criteria have been met before deployment occurs. The Contractor shall coordinate each release with VA technical staff, integration partners, and teams supporting interfacing systems to resolve issues and ensure all required components are migrated to the appropriate technical environments as planned.

The Contractor shall participate in release and deployment planning and coordination meetings, verify that deployment checklists, prerequisites, and dependencies are complete, and confirm readiness for production migration. The Contractor shall prepare and maintain all documentation and artifacts that make up the Release and Deployment Support Package, which includes, at a minimum:

- Solution Deployment Package (SDP), including smart scripting and all required artifacts covering Release Management, Product Documentation, and Product Support phases
- Updated Build Release Package reflecting final build and deployment changes
- Release Notes describing new features, fixes, and configuration changes
- Updated design documents
- Final source code
- Evidence of compliance with the VA DevSecOps Release Framework
- Final technical and operational documentation reflecting any changes during IOC or production deployment

The Contractor shall also define the processes, coordination activities, responsibilities, and overall approach for carrying out all release and deployment tasks in the Release and Deployment Support Plan.

The Contractor shall ensure these materials remain current and are recorded using VA-approved tools that support documentation, workflows, and release tracking. To support the complete lifecycle of preparing and delivering a release into production, the Contractor shall perform activities that span planning and readiness, deployment execution, post-deployment monitoring, and release closure.

The following subsections define the major activity areas required to ensure each release is prepared, deployed, validated, and completed in a controlled and coordinated manner.

5.6.4.1 Execute Deployment Activities

The Contractor shall carry out deployment activities to ensure that approved releases are successfully migrated into the production environment. These activities include:

- Providing deployment support for all scheduled releases.
- Promoting validated build artifacts through approved CI/CD pipelines.
- Executing deployment according to documented strategies, procedures, and rollback plans.
- Validating configurations, interfaces, and data flows immediately following deployment.
- Documenting observed results and resolving issues encountered during execution.

5.6.4.2 Monitor and Validate Production Deployment:

The Contractor shall perform monitoring and validation activities following deployment to ensure the operational stability of the released product. These activities include:

- Monitoring and documenting the operational solution immediately following deployment.
- Providing oversight and support for a minimum of 90 days to ensure a stable transition to operations support.
- Validating system performance, integrations, and dependencies in the production environment.
- Supporting VA in any required post-implementation reviews (PIR).
- Providing information, updates, and artifacts needed for VA to evaluate deployment results and determine corrective actions.

5.6.4.3 Complete Release Acceptance and Closure Activities:

The Contractor shall complete the release lifecycle by ensuring acceptance, documentation updates, and closure actions are performed in coordination with VA stakeholders. These activities include:

- Coordinating with VA to confirm acceptance of the deployed release.
- Completing all documentation updates, issue resolutions, and closure activities using VA-approved tools.
- Utilizing the VA-approved calendaring process to track release and implementation schedules, special works in progress, and other deployment activities in the production environment.
- Providing required data and updates to ensure the VA-approved calendaring process is accurately populated and maintained.
- Supporting enterprise scheduling, communication, and visibility requirements.
- Ensuring final documentation reflects updates made during IOC or production deployment and resolving any discrepancies identified by VA.

Deliverables:

- A. Release and Deployment Support Package including the Solution Deployment Package (SDP)
- B. Release and Deployment Support Plan

5.7 POST DEPLOYMENT SUPPORT

The activities in this product/project area are applicable to Optional Task One Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.3 and Optional Task Two Highly Technical Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.4.

Upon completion of the first product build release and each subsequent release for HELM managed software, the Contractor shall provide defect management support and coordination. Within Incident Management, defect management shall follow established VA policies and be documented through tickets as a "bug" or "defect", to indicate an identified problem that is not working as designed. Defect correction may be planned for inclusion in a subsequent production release, emergency release, or prioritized in the product backlog. Defects may be identified by the VA PM, end users, the OIT Enterprise Service Desk (ESD), Help Desk, the Contractor, or Business/Product Owners. For each defect identified, the Contractor shall develop and submit Post Deployment Defect Resolution Plan that includes severity classification, triage results, remediation approach, timeline, and required updates to code and artifacts maintained in VA approved tools. Following the VA PM's approval of the Contractor Post Deployment Defect Resolution Plan, the Contractor shall execute the approved plan.

Provide Post-Deployment Hypercare

- Provide 90 days of post-deployment intensive monitoring and customer service support (hypercare) to ensure stable operations, defect mitigation, and seamless transition to sustainment support.
- Coordinate with the ESD for issue routing and Tier II/Tier III support.

The Contractor shall continue to provide post sustainment defect support for 90 days after contract completion (the warranty period).

5.7.1 TIERED SUPPORT MODEL SUPPORT

Tier 1 shall be handled by OIT ESD and Tiers 2 and 3 shall be provided by the Contractor. The Contractor shall meet the Tier 2 and 3 response times as shown in the table below.

- Tier 1 – Application error messages – handled by ESD.
- Tier 2 – Report generation, production research, database updates, batch job support shall be handled by the Contractor during VA approved support hours.
- Tier 3 – Application code changes, defect corrections, security compliance updates, and related remediation – shall be handled by the Contractor during VA approved support hours.

5.7.2 TIER 2 AND TIER 3 RESPONSE REQUIREMENTS

Severity Code	Tier 2 Initial Response	Escalation to Tier 3	Tier 3 Response	Tier 2 Update Frequency	Resolution Time**
1 – Critical	15 minutes	0–15 minutes	15 minutes	Hourly or on call until resolved	0–2 business hours
2 – Serious	1 hour	30 minutes	1 hour	Hourly or on call	2–4 business hours
3 – Moderate	4 hours	1 hour	4 hours	Daily	4–8 business hours

Resolution times shall align with the established Service Level Agreement (SLA) for each product.

In the event a defect or bug causes a high priority or critical outage rendering the software application and/or infrastructure to be inoperable and triggers a major incident. The responsible application team shall initiate the major incident steps outlined within the HELM O&M Plan to restore the effected application and/or infrastructure. The Contractor shall create and distribute an After-Action report within 24 hours via email to VA PM, CORs and Business Stakeholders.

Deliverables:

- A. Post Deployment Defect Resolution Plan
- B. After Action Report

5.7.3 AFTER BUSINESS HOUR SUPPORT

The Contractor shall maintain a phone tree support structure to ensure timely escalation and coordination during weekends and other periods outside standard support hours when critical or high severity issues arise. Technical support teams follow established VA procedures and shall integrate with VA's ESD to ensure proper resolution or escalation (Tier 2, 3) of all issues within established time frames.

The Contractor shall follow VA incident response procedures. The Contractor shall support a non-business hours rotation schedule to respond to HELMs monitoring and alerting platform to incidents on monitored HELM applications. The Contractor shall provide specific escalation policies based on the needs of the individually supported products.

The contractor shall be required to support go-live preparations, scheduled maintenance, and production patching during non-business hours as required.

5.8 VALIP SUSTAINMENT SUPPORT

The activities in this product/project area are applicable to Optional Task One Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.3 and Optional Task Two Highly Technical Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.4.

VA Logistics Integration Platform (VALIP) provides a modern industry standard platform for real-time interoperability for HELM PL. Built on a scalable and highly available OpenShift Kubernetes containerized framework, VALIP currently uses Red Hat, InterSystems and DataBricks integration (subject to change), data management and API technical components to orchestrate data sharing and services across the PL. This shared orchestration layer simplifies infrastructure maintenance of applications in the VAEC while adhering to a DevSecOps framework to integrate security into all phase of software development and the CI/CD pipeline. VALIP enables data exchange between legacy and new systems in the enterprise through Extract Transform and Load (ETL), simple messaging(e.g., HL7, EDI or XML), abstraction through an API layer or through publishing a subscribe model that hides complexities of the actual implementation from consumers.

VALIP serves as a comprehensive, cloud-based ecosystem, delivering seamless integration and interoperability for all products within the VA Supply Chain Portfolio, which includes commercial off-the-shelf (COTS), Government off-the-shelf (GOTS), and Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) solutions. The VALIP platform is designed to facilitate comprehensive batch and real time data integration across diverse systems, supporting unified supply chain operations while

leveraging the scalability, flexibility, and high availability of a modern cloud-native environment.

VALIP provides a containerized multi-tenant environment within the VA Enterprise Cloud (VAEC) and VA Platform One (VAPO) to allow multiple HELM products to share a single cluster while maintaining isolation, security, and resource control. VALIP supports both soft (logical isolation within one cluster) and hard (physical isolation in separate clusters) multi-tenancy. VALIP shared resources provide the infrastructure support, cost visibility, security monitoring and incident mitigation necessary for HELM PL products to maintain high availability and services to their VA customers.

Utilizing robust API management, near real-time messaging, and service orchestration, VALIP ensures adaptability to the evolving needs of the VA supply chain. As a cloud-based ecosystem, VALIP must interface with the Legacy VISTA and Supply Chain Systems, Oracle Health Electronic Health Record (EHR) and the Integrated Financial Management System (iFAMS) for the purpose of streamlining the supply chain workflows, clinical care, and financial processes.

VALIP's cloud-based ecosystem enables precise tracking of inventory, including medical devices and pharmaceuticals, from procurement through patient utilization. This shall ensure a more effective supply chain management operation by way of better end-to-end visibility and connecting demand, asset, distributor, and supplier data within a secure, cloud-enabled network.

VALIP incorporates artificial intelligence and machine learning (AI/ML) to optimize supply chain operations, reduce risks, enhance predictive forecasting, and maintain continuity of patient care by minimizing inventory bottlenecks and disruptions. Actionable analytics shall empower stakeholders with the information needed for continuous improvement and operational excellence.

The VALIP cloud-based ecosystem enables automated data exchange between internal and external supply chain partners, automates the identification and validation of product substitutions during supply disruptions, as well as enable the provisioning of a centralized dashboard to monitor purchase orders and demand fluctuations in real time.

5.8.1 VALIP CLOUD ECOSYSTEM DEVELOPMENT AND MANAGEMENT

The Contractor shall update the current design and implement, and maintain VALIP as a comprehensive, cloud-based ecosystem that delivers seamless integration and interoperability for all products within the HELM Product Line. The Contractor shall ensure the platform supports diverse systems, including COTS, GOTS, and SaaS solutions, while leveraging the scalability, flexibility, and high availability of a modern cloud-native environment and adhering to VA's TRM. To define and govern this environment, the Contractor shall develop and maintain a VALIP Solution Architecture Package that documents the overall architecture, integration patterns, and orchestration framework supporting enterprise interoperability.

The Contractor shall:

- Architect VALIP to serve as the central integration hub, facilitating comprehensive data integration across diverse supply chain systems, as defined within the VALIP Solution Architecture Package.

- Utilize robust API management, near real-time messaging, and service orchestration to ensure the platform adapts to the evolving needs of the VA supply chain, with interfaces and data exchanges documented through an Interface Control Document (ICD).
- Establish a secure, cloud-enabled network that connects providers, distributors, and suppliers to provide end-to-end visibility, with interfaces and connectivity standardized and maintained via ICDs.
- Ensure the ecosystem supports high availability and disaster recovery requirements to maintain continuity of patient care and minimize inventory bottlenecks in multi-Availability Zones/Regions, supported by a Cloud Capacity and Scalability Plan that defines performance thresholds, scaling strategies, and resource provisioning.

Deliverables:

- A. VALIP Solution Architecture Package
- B. VALIP Interface Control Document
- C. Cloud Capacity and Scalability Plan

5.8.2 INTEGRATION AND INTEROPERABILITY

The Contractor shall develop and manage integrations to streamline HELM PL and supply chain workflows, clinical care, and financial processes. As the primary messaging and data middleware solution for the HELM PL, the Contractor shall ensure VALIP interfaces with critical incumbent systems, enterprise systems, including the Oracle Health EHR and iFAMS, and other integrations as applicable. Moreover, the Contractor shall ensure that all required and essential inbound & outbound messaging formats are supported as determined by the information systems in the HELM PL. To ensure consistency, accuracy, and governance across all integrations, the Contractor shall develop and maintain a Data Mapping and Validation Plan that defines data standards, transformation logic, and validation procedures.

The Contractor shall:

- Develop and maintain bi-directional interfaces between VALIP and Oracle Health EHR to ensure logistics data is fully integrated with clinical records, aligned to defined data mappings and validation rules within the Data Mapping and Validation Plan.
- Develop and maintain interfaces between VALIP and iFAMS to streamline financial processes and ensure financial data integrity regarding procurement and inventory, supported by standardized data mapping and validation procedures.
- Develop and maintain integrations between VALIP and Asset/Item Management systems to streamline asset, space, facility and items across the enterprise by standardized data mapping and validation procedures.
- Develop and maintain synchronization with systems of record (e.g., CDW, SDP and Nuvo) for VALIP data integrity and between disparate configuration management databases (CMDB).
- Develop and maintain one-way and bi-directional interfaces between incumbent and modernized financial management systems to ensure uninterrupted mission-critical financial operations, validated through execution of Integration Test Plans and Results.
- Provide a Data Mapping and Validation Plan which would define the data mappings used to implement one way and bi-directional interfaces between incumbent and modern information systems.
- Provide an Integration Test Plans and Results document with test plans and test results validating the above integrations.

- Enable automated data exchange between internal and external supply chain partners. Provide an External Partner Connectivity Report defining these data exchange mechanisms.
- Ensure precise tracking of inventory, including medical devices and pharmaceuticals, from procurement through patient utilization, supported by validated integrations and tested interfaces as documented in Integration Test Plans and Results.

Deliverables:

- A. Data Mapping and Validation Plan
- B. External Partner Connectivity Report
- C. Integration Test Plans and Results

5.9 BUILD AND DEVELOPMENT

The activities in this product/project area are applicable to Optional Task One Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.3 and Optional Task Two Highly Technical Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.4.

The Contractor shall continuously support the iterative release and configuration methodology to complete all epics and user stories identified in the backlog.

5.9.1 SOLUTION ARCHITECTURE PLANNING AND EXECUTION

The Contractor shall create a Solution Architecture Package that includes the initial business, systems, application, and data architectures for the new features and capabilities using an architecture framework, approved by the VA PM/CORs. These documents shall be updated utilizing VA approved templates and GitHub or VA approved tool when appropriate and approved by the CORs/PM in each subsequent Sprint. Each subsequent update shall include a Changes Page, which specifies the updates made to the document for review and approval by the CORs or/PM. The Contractor shall also outline any initial gaps, questions or challenges that may hinder progress in future Builds or Sprints.

The Contractor shall:

- Support the setting up of all needed development and test environments as required to complete required build development and testing. Coordinate with VA to ensure alignment with all development and test environments. The Contractor shall work with VA to ensure required specifications are provided no later than 30 days prior to environment need date.
- Develop, support, and/or maintain the VA ATO to obtain/maintain approval, as required. Required ATOs must be obtained prior to build release and ATO approval timelines, including all necessary security scanning and remediations, must be considered in build planning activities.
- Develop and deliver automated build and automated publishing capabilities to schedule jobs and support continuous integration for every sprint. Automated build tools shall be in compliance with the approved list from the One-VA TRM and code shall be demonstrable and stable enough to be promoted to another environment without issue by evidence of the status of tests and results in the VA approved tool (currently GitHub/Jira).

- When developing an interface, the Contractor shall identify such issues with the Government for proper Integration Control Registration (ICR) and await approval from the Government to proceed.
- When developing an interface, the Contractor shall ensure the requirements are added to the backlog with priority to integrate the product into the Product Line Architecture.
- When developing an interface, the Contractor shall also ensure the product complies with Product Line ICDs, if existing, or assist in the creation of new ICDs to support new integrations that have been approved through the Configuration Control Board.

Deliverables:

- A. Solution Architecture Package
- B. ICR Issues (As Applicable)
- C. ICD (As Applicable)

5.9.2 BUILD PLANNING

Backlog grooming and prioritization are continued throughout the product life cycle and shall be managed throughout PoP. The Contractor shall develop builds of each product on a continuous basis no shorter than two weeks but no longer than three months in duration. The Contractor shall develop and deliver a Build Plan in collaboration with the project team prior to beginning the build. The Build Plan is the scope of work which shall be completed in the agreed upon build timeframe. Each build must end with a release production. Each build shall be made up of individual sprints, be fully tested by end users, and end in a release to production. The Build Plan must be completed prior to the start of the build timeframe. After the build plan is approved and the team is ready to start the build, the three months or less build cycle shall start. Planning for future builds shall occur during the execution of current builds.

The Contractor shall maintain the product backlog, continuously, for each build, in every release and throughout the life of the PoP within the VA approved tool. All activities scheduled in each build and backlogs shall be captured and have status showing all work items, changes, impediments, and retrospectives. All data and artifacts in the VA approved tool shall be fully linked to requirements data and test data.

The Contractor shall:

- Facilitate review, elaboration, and prioritization of the backlog Attachment 2_HELM_Backlog. This backlog grooming shall occur continuously throughout the build to ensure the highest product priorities are being met.
- Facilitate selection of prioritized items from the product backlog to be included in the next build with approval of VA PM, CORs and incorporate those items into a Build Plan for posting to VA approved tool.
- Conduct an Initial Design Review with stakeholders to ensure the design is technically and fiscally able to be completed during the build.
- Provide support for identification of field sites, test environments, acceptance criteria, and ATO requirements.
- Coordinate in the validation or creation of Interconnection Security Agreement/Memorandum of Understanding (ISA/MOU) and SLAs for partner dependencies that specifically highlight the commitment of partners to associated release.

The ISA specifies the technical and security requirements of the interconnection and the MOU defines the responsibilities of the participating organizations.

The Contractor shall provide a Build Test Plan to the VA PM, or CORs / for approval prior to initiating any development activities. This plan shall include both Contractor and VA testing activities, dependencies, and descriptions of the interfaces and interactions between solution components that are needed to test and validate. The Build Test Plan shall specify the types and scope of testing to be conducted during each product build (e.g. unit, functional, accessibility, system, reliability, usability, interoperability, regression, security, performance). The Contractor shall include testing related to non-functional requirements, (e.g. load, performance, installation, back-out, and rollback) in the Build Test Plan. The Contractor shall populate its Test Strategy section of the test plan in VA's approved tool within 15 days of the completion of the Build Plan.

At the conclusion of the Build Planning phase, the Contractor shall provide a Build Release Planning Package outlining the prioritized capabilities, estimation of size and timeline for completion.

Deliverables:

- A. Build Plan
- B. ISA/MOUs and SLAs
- C. Build Test Plan
- D. Build Release Planning Package

5.9.3 SPRINT PLANNING

Once build planning is completed and accepted, the Contractor shall initiate Sprint Planning for each Sprint of the release. All activities scheduled in each sprint and backlog shall be captured and have status showing all work items, changes, impediments, and retrospectives. All data and artifacts in VA Approved Tool shall be fully linked to requirements data and test data.

The Contractor shall:

- Initiate and participate in a Sprint Planning Meeting, at the beginning of each sprint. The Contractor shall update the Sprint Plan in the VA Approved Tool after the Sprint Planning.
- Support, coordinate and provide input for the Sprint Acceptance Criteria in VA Approved Tool. The Sprint Acceptance Criteria shall be coordinated and approved for every sprint. This task shall result in an Approved Sprint Plan.
- Collaborate with the Business/Product Owner to take the approved prioritized items identified from build planning and create and prioritize the sprint backlog.
- Identify user stories and tasks to be completed within the sprint, the agreement of acceptance criteria for the sprint, and readiness to begin sprint.
- Conduct a sprint design to understand what problem needs to be solved for each user story, understand critical business functions, test initial concepts, and look for objective feedback. Methods of design could include mock-ups, storyboards, and rapid prototyping.
- Collaborate with key VA Stakeholders to determine the testing events required for the Sprint.

Deliverables:

- A. Sprint Plan

5.9.4 SPRINT EXECUTION

All activities executed in each sprint and backlog shall be captured and have status showing all work items, changes, risks, issues, impediments, and retrospectives. All data and artifacts in VA Approved Tool shall be fully linked to requirements data and test data.

The Contractor shall:

- Provide a certified Scrum Master to facilitate all ceremonies, ensure VA approved tool is updated daily, enforce scrum framework, track and assist with removing impediments.
- Conduct sprint development including disciplined testing (unit, functional, regression) and reviews as a continuous process, to avoid finding issues at the end of sprint development. Develop the features and capabilities as work items in VA approved tools that were established in the Sprint Plan.
- Develop the features and capabilities as work items in VA Approved Tool that were established in the Sprint Plan.
- Complete sprint configuration including disciplined testing (unit, functional, regression) and reviews as a continuous process, to avoid finding issues at the end of sprint development.
- Initiate and conduct daily scrums (typically 15 minutes) to show the team progress, impediments and daily plans.
- Update the VA Approved Tool daily, to include progress on tasks during sprints, blockers and dependencies.
- Coordinate and support demonstration of the sprint activities with the project team and Users at the end of each sprint. This is termed a Sprint Review and shall result in Customer Acceptance of the Sprint.
- Develop and deliver automated build and automated publishing capabilities to schedule jobs and support continuous integration for every sprint. Automated build tools shall be in compliance with the approved list from the One-VA TRM and code shall be demonstrable and stable enough to be promoted to another environment without issue by evidence of the status of tests and results in the VA approved tool (currently Jira/GitHub).
- The Contractor shall document all activity executed in each sprint and updates to the backlog in Jira/GitHub or VA approved tool including all project artifacts such as work items, changes, risks, issues, impediments, and retrospectives. All data and artifacts in VA approved tool shall be fully linked to requirements data and test data. All project artifacts and source code shall be under change and configuration management as specified by the CORs or /PM using Jira/GitHub or VA approved tool.
- Initiate and facilitate a Sprint Retrospective at the end of the Sprint to capture team performance lessons learned. The Contractor shall provide a Sprint Retrospective Report.

Deliverable:

- A. Sprint Retrospective Report

5.10 APPLICATION PERFORMANCE MONITORING AND ALERTING

The activities in this product/project area are applicable to Optional Task One Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.3 and Optional Task Two Highly Technical Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.4.

5.10.1 APPLICATION PERFORMANCE MONITORING (APM)

The Contractor shall provide Application Performance Monitoring (APM) capabilities to ensure the reliability, availability, and performance of HELM PL applications. All APM activities shall comply with VA DevSecOps, Enterprise Operations, and OIT monitoring standards.

The Contractor shall:

- Implement VA Approved Monitoring Tools - Deploy, configure, and maintain TRM approved APM tools to monitor application health, performance, resource utilization, transaction flows, and end user experience.
- Provide Real-Time Monitoring and Alerting - Continuously monitor key performance indicators, latency, error rates, throughput, and capacity utilization, and configure automated alerts for threshold violations.
- Conduct Performance Analysis - Perform recurring analysis of performance data, establish performance baselines/thresholds, identify bottlenecks or degradation trends, and recommend corrective actions or optimizations as necessary. Provide Performance Trend Analysis report and Performance Baseline and Threshold Documentation.
- Support Incident Management and Root Cause Analysis - Use APM telemetry to support identification, diagnosis, and resolution of production incidents in accordance with VA incident management processes. Provide Incident and Root Cause Analysis reports as required.
- Integrate APM with DevSecOps Pipelines - Incorporate APM monitoring and performance validation into CI/CD pipelines to support continuous testing, quality gates, and release readiness. Deliver Monthly APM Performance Reports.
- Support Capacity and Scalability Planning - Provide analysis and forecasting data to support infrastructure scaling and capacity planning for SCM applications

Deliverables:

- A. Performance Trend Analysis Report
- B. Performance Baseline and Threshold Documentation
- C. Incident and Root Cause Analysis Reports (as required)
- D. Monthly APM Performance Report

5.10.2 APPLICATION MONITORING PLAN

As part of HELM Development and Operations, the Contractor shall utilize Application Performance Monitoring strategies for application health and performance and develop product performance metrics that shall be monitored throughout the contract.

The Contractor shall provide an Application Monitoring Plan that defines how metrics shall be monitored throughout the performance of the requirements, including the automated testing tools and automated SLA is testing scripts that shall be used. The Contractor shall provide the Application Monitoring Plan to the VA PM, CORs and/or for review and approval. Upon approval, the Contractor shall implement application monitoring in accordance with the VA Directive 6500.

The Contractor APM processes shall:

- Ensure that custom software components can be instrumented to support a VA approved performance monitoring standard (e.g. Open Tracing)

- Produce and maintain documentation describing data flow through the application, focusing on how and when the application passes/accepts data to/from other systems or end users.
- Ensure that all workflows and actions identified during the HCD process are distinctly mapped/measured in the monitoring environment.
- Define and describe how monitoring of the system, network, application, database logs, and performance metrics via VA approved VAEC/Cloud Service Provider (CSP) monitoring tools shall occur (and be executed) and ensure that code and logic changes are accurately reflected in the monitoring tools.
- Write and monitor synthetic monitoring scripts for VA infrastructure and applications.
- Perform postmortems of any outages occurred, including root cause analysis and steps to prevent future outages and provide Postmortem Reports accordingly.

The Contractor shall document in the Monthly Status Report performance metrics including but not limited to number of issues reported, problem type identification, percentage (%) resolved, time for resolution, priority, severity, etc. as agreed to with the VA PM, and/or CORs. The Contractor shall provide a Response Time Monitoring Report, appended to the Monthly Status Report, that provides response time frames at the 50th, 75th, 95th, and 99th percentiles for each health product.

Deliverables:

- A. Application Monitoring Plan
- B. Postmortem Reports

5.10.3 DECOMMISSIONING SUPPORT

The Contractor shall provide an approach and plan for decommissioning VA legacy systems being replaced by “to-be” systems. The approach should encompass identifying, gathering, and analyzing representative system-specific data to understand the conditions, parameters, limitations, and other factors that shall drive decommission plans. Topics of interest and data sources may include, but not be limited to, the following:

- Users/user communities
- System features including how they are used to support user community business operations and what gaps exist between legacy systems and the “to-be” systems
- Data movement within legacy systems, across integrated solutions, and downstream to reporting tools
- Data retention requirements
- Regulations and policies
- Legal review of Course Of Action (COA) for records retention purposes
- Contractual support and implications for, or issues concerning, reduced or eliminated contractual support requirements
- System integrations
- Architecture

5.10.3.1 Alternate Solutions for Decommissioning Systems

The Contractor shall identify alternate solutions for decommissioning each legacy system. Depending on the data gathered, this may include a series of interim or transitional steps leading towards the long-term solution. Based on the alternatives identified, the Contractor shall perform an analysis of alternatives for VA leadership to select as the long-term enterprise

approach. The Contractor shall provide an Analysis of Alternatives for an Enterprise Decommissioning Approach.

Based on scope of issues discovered, determine alternatives to facilitate shut down (e.g., maintain legacy systems until retention period ends; develop archive systems; consolidate legacy systems' data in single legacy system instance; rely on Corporate Data Warehouse (CDW), Jira or Confluence archive instance; and others).

The Contractor shall develop a decommissioning analysis document for each legacy system which shall include, but is not limited to:

- System description
- Technical architecture (to include internal and external interfaces)
- Data exchange
- Data retention requirements
- Decommissioning dependencies
- System support resources
- Decommissioning costs

5.10.3.2 Decommissioning Plan

The Contractor shall develop and maintain an iterative Legacy System Decommissioning Plan for the designated legacy system identifying the approach, steps, and responsibilities for decommissioning each legacy system.

5.10.3.3 Technical Support for Decommissioning

Upon approval of a Legacy System Decommissioning Plan, the Contractor shall provide technical support for executing the Plan. Technical Support shall include any migration of data to secure storage, standing up servers for data retention, physically dismantling legacy servers and turning equipment in to be excessed, and modifying/closing user access.

Deliverables:

- A. Analysis of Alternatives for an Enterprise Decommissioning Approach
- B. Legacy Decommissioning Analysis Document
- C. Legacy System Decommissioning Plan

5.11 MIGRATION TO CLOUD ENVIRONMENT & HOSTING SUPPORT

The activities in this product/project area are applicable to Optional Task One Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.3 and Optional Task Two Highly Technical Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.4.

The Contractor shall provide comprehensive cloud migration, hosting, and sustainment support to transition HELM PL applications, services, data, and integrations from legacy on premise or hybrid environments into the VAEC or other VA approved cloud environments. The Contractor shall ensure all migrated systems meet VA security, performance, interoperability, and availability requirements.

The Contractor shall perform the following activities:

5.11.1 CLOUD ARCHITECTURE AND MIGRATION PLANNING

- Develop a Cloud Migration Strategy and Architecture Blueprint that defines target state architectures, cloud service models (IaaS/PaaS/SaaS), data flow, network topology, IAM requirements, and dependencies.
- Develop a Cloud Migration Support Plan that defines how the system will be supported during and after migration.
- Conduct assessments of existing applications, infrastructure components, and interfaces to determine migration readiness, required refactoring, containerization needs, and performance impacts.
- Conduct cloud capacity, resiliency, and cost optimization planning based on VA operational and scalability requirements.

5.11.2 MIGRATION EXECUTION AND IMPLEMENTATION SUPPORT

- Build and configure cloud environments, including Virtual Private Cloud (VPC) networking, firewalls, subnets, load balancers, security groups, IAM roles, container orchestration (e.g., Kubernetes), and monitoring frameworks.
- Execute migration activities including data replication, cut-over planning, Domain Name System (DNS) updates, configuration synchronization, and failover testing.
- Re-platform, re-host, re-architect, or retire components as required to achieve target cloud architecture.

5.11.3 CLOUD SECURITY AND COMPLIANCE

- Ensure cloud solutions comply with NIST SP 800-53 REV 5, VA Directive 6500, VA ZTA principles, IPv6 requirements, and all other VA cybersecurity policies.
- Implement required cloud security controls, including encryption in transit and at rest, boundary protection, audit logging, identity federation, and secrets management.
- Support ATO updates or new ATO packages for cloud-deployed systems.

5.11.4 CLOUD TESTING AND VALIDATION

- Develop and execute a Cloud Migration Test Plan, including functional, regression, performance, continuity of operations, security, and integration testing.
- Validate connectivity to external dependent systems (e.g., Oracle Health EHR, iFAMS, CDW, VA network services).
- Conduct end to end validation in nonproduction and production environments to ensure functionality after migration.

5.11.5 CLOUD HOSTING O&M (POST MIGRATION SUPPORT)

- Provide hosting support for all HELM systems migrated to the cloud, including continuous monitoring, incident response, patching, backup, disaster recovery, performance tuning, Post Migration Validation Report, and capacity adjustments.
- Configure and maintain cloud native monitoring and observability tools (e.g., CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, Dynatrace, AppDynamics, APM tools) to ensure application health.
- Maintain continuous integration/continuous deployment (CI/CD) pipelines in cloud based DevSecOps toolchains.

5.11.6 DISASTER RECOVERY (DR) AND CONTINUITY OF OPERATIONS (COOP)

- Establish DR/COOP environments with defined RTO/RPO thresholds for each HELM system.
- Perform periodic DR failover tests and document results in a Cloud DR Validation Report.
- The Contractor shall provide DR/COOP Plan and test results.

5.11.7 DOCUMENTATION AND KNOWLEDGE TRANSFER

- Deliver Cloud Architecture Documentation, Migration Runbooks, Operations Manuals, ATO updates, and cloud configuration baselines.
- Provide training to VA staff on cloud operations, monitoring, and system administration.

Deliverables:

- A. Cloud Migration Strategy & Architecture Blueprint
- B. Cloud Migration Support Plan
- C. Cloud Migration Test Plan
- D. Updated ATO/A&A Artifacts
- E. Post Migration Validation Report
- F. DR/COOP Plan and Test Result

5.11.8 VAEC CLOUD HOSTING

The Contractor shall support the migration from the current environment to the VAEC Cloud environment. The Contractor shall coordinate with existing infrastructure POC, and provide technical support for testing, configuration management, and documentation. In addition, the Contractor shall conduct testing and verify application functionality is operating as designed, both during and after the migration.

The Contractor shall:

- Coordinate with the VA Cloud team to develop a clear approach to data migration and replication that minimizes the project production downtime.
- Provide a VAEC Migration Support Plan that identifies the tasks, schedule, as well as the roles and responsibilities for migration.
- Provide a VAEC Migration Test Plan that identifies the Contractor's testing approach to include but is not limited to the following pass/fail criteria, risks, and rollback plan.
- Execute testing in accordance with the approved plan and provide a VAEC Migration Test Summary Report that identifies the tests executed, what tests passed or failed as well as any defects encountered during the migration test.
- Respond to project-related technical questions from either the VAEC or from existing infrastructure POC.
- Validate project is operating as required in all of its production and non-production environments. The Contractor shall support the resolution of migration anomalies.
- Ensure all the development and build tools, as well as interfaces to external systems, are operating in their new cloud environments as required.
- Support the validation of the project connectivity (endpoints) including project-dependent systems and interfaces as defined in the System Design Document.

Deliverables:

- A. VAEC Migration Support Plan
- B. VAEC Migration Test Plan
- C. VAEC Migration Test Summary Report

5.11.9 EXTERNAL HOSTED APPLICATION

The Contractor shall support the external hosting of a commercially provided application by way of a SaaS delivery mechanism. The Contractor shall coordinate with the SaaS infrastructure POC (PaaS and/or IaaS) for the purpose of providing technical support as it pertains to understanding and aligning the SaaS provider's business operation methods with the VA's requirements governing incident management, application downloading, application installation, application testing, dynamic provisioning of virtual computing resources, cybersecurity, data management, privacy management, configuration management, Disaster Recovery & Reconstitution, Account Management (Root Admin, Local Admin, General End-Users, Superusers and assign appropriate Groups, Roles and responsibilities) and system documentation.

5.12 INFRASTRUCTURE AND SECURITY REQUIREMENTS

The activities in this product/project area are applicable to Optional Task One Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.3 and Optional Task Two Highly Technical Scrum Team Support requirements at PWS Section 5.4.

The Contractor shall support the HELM PL by documenting the technical architecture of the infrastructure that supports the information systems which comprise the HELM PL. As part of this effort, the Contractor shall:

- Document current and future state data flows, networking, cybersecurity, and infrastructure requirements for the successful implementation of new applications.
- Identify and analyze systems targeted for integration and the design and technologies needed to implement them.
- Develop "As-Is" and "To-Be" DoDAF compliant Architecture Models, including architecture diagrams detailing the conceptual, logical and physical design of the VA or external SaaS, PaaS, IaaS provider's infrastructure and infrastructure services for which the HELM Product Line information systems may rely on.
- Ensure that any infrastructure or infrastructure services architecture developed aligns with the VA's enterprise strategy, roadmap, and direction.
- Comply with all federal and VA security and privacy requirements, including the development of A&A artifacts to obtain and maintain an ATO for all HELM Product Line systems.
- Assess Vulnerability Scanning reports to include documentation within the ATO artifact repository for the reports and assessments.
- When applicable, upload appropriate artifacts and update information in VA's Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC) Tool(s).

Deliverables:

- A. As-Is and To-Be DoDAF Architecture Models
- B. DoDAF compliant Architecture Diagrams

- C. Solution Architecture Package
- D. Vulnerability Scanning Reports and Assessments
- E. Assessment & Authorization (A&A) Artifacts

5.13 TRANSITION SUPPORT (OPTIONAL TASK 3)

If this optional task is exercised by VA, the Contractor shall provide a plan for 60 days of outgoing transition support for transitioning work from the current contract to a Government entity or to another Contractor. In accordance with the Government-approved plan, the Contractor shall assist the Government in implementing a complete transition from this contract to a new support provider. This shall include formal coordination with Government staff and successor staff and management with documented Transition Plan. It shall also include delivery of copies of all artifacts delivered under this contract, as well as existing policies and procedures, and delivery of baseline metrics and statistics.

This Transition Plan shall include, but is not limited to:

1. Coordination with Government representatives.
2. Review, evaluation and transition of current support services.
3. Transition information of historical data to a new Contractor utilizing Rational or VA approved tool as the repository.
4. Transition of Rational/VA approved tool accounts.
5. Transfer of all necessary business and/or technical documentation and ensure they are accessible through Rational or VA approved tool.
6. Orientation phase and program to introduce Government and Contractor personnel, programs, and users to the Contractor's team, tools, methodologies, and business processes.
7. Transfer of GFE and Government Furnished Information, and GFE inventory management assistance.
8. Turn-in of all Government keys, ID/access cards, and security codes.

The Contractor shall also produce a list of all assets associated with the project at the time of acceptance of the Final Certification of Software Quality Assurance of assets. This shall be finalized upon full Government acceptance of the asset because documentation and other assets may change based upon the development contractors' remediation of defects effort during Deployment Support. This includes all software assets, specification of support environments, tools; hardware and software licenses, warranties, and maintenance agreements; documentation, and any other assets that must be maintained throughout the asset lifecycle. The finalized asset list shall be delivered as a Certificate of Transition Completion for all assets, which shall be signed by the Development PM and the Receiving Organization to indicate acceptance.

Deliverables:

- A. Transition Plan
- B. Certificate of Transition Completion

6.0 GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

6.1 ENTERPRISE AND IT FRAMEWORK

6.1.1 VA TECHNICAL REFERENCE MODEL

The Contractor shall comply with the VA OIT Technical Reference Model (VA TRM). Compliance with the VA TRM is achieved by using only technologies and standards that are listed as approved for use in the VA TRM. The Contractor shall provide all necessary information requested by VA to ensure TRM approval is obtained prior to use on VA's network.

6.1.2 ZERO TRUST – VA CRITICAL SECURITY CONTROLS

VA has established minimum mandatory security requirements and requires that any network connected software system or service must meet the VA Critical Security Controls as outlined in the VA Memorandum, "VA Security Controls", <https://www.voa.va.gov/DocumentView.aspx?DocumentID=5010>. VA Critical Security Controls identify the minimum mandatory requirements that must be implemented across all VA enterprise infrastructure, cloud computing environments, information systems, networks, and specialized devices (medical devices/systems, special-purpose systems, and research scientific computing devices) that process, store, and/or transmit VA data. Effective July 1, 2025, the Contractor shall implement these VA Critical Security Controls, within any network connected software system or service prior to being authorized for use in the VA. This functional requirement is not negotiable, and Plan of Action & Milestones (POAM) shall not be accepted in the event these controls cannot be implemented for new systems. Critical Security Controls are intended to increase VA's security posture and provide security and privacy risk visibility into the VA network and is not a new requirement. The Contractor's failure to maintain these VA Critical Controls after implementation shall result in VA discontinuing the use of the system.

6.1.3 FEDERAL IDENTITY, CREDENTIAL, AND ACCESS MANAGEMENT (FICAM)

The Contractor shall ensure Commercial Off-The-Shelf (COTS) product(s), software configuration and customization, and/or new software are Personal Identity Verification (PIV) card-enabled by accepting HSPD-12 PIV credentials using [VA Enterprise Architecture \(EA\)](#), and VA Identity and Access Management (IAM) approved [Enterprise Technology Guidelines \(ETG\)](#). The Contractor shall ensure all Contractor delivered applications and systems comply with the VA Identity, Credential, and Access Management policies and guidelines set forth in Executive Order 14028, VA Handbook 6510 VA Identity and Access Management, VA Handbook 0735 Homeland Security Presidential Directive 12 (HSPD-12) Program, CISA Binding Operational Directive 23-01, and align with the Federal Identity, Credential, and Access Management Roadmap and Implementation Guidance v2.0.

The Contractor shall ensure all Contractor delivered applications and systems provide user authentication services compliant with the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) Special Publication (SP) 800-63-4, VA Handbook 6500, and VA IAM enterprise requirements for direct, assertion-based authentication, and/or trust based authentication, as determined by the ETGs. Direct authentication at a minimum must include Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) based authentication supportive of PIV card and/or Common Access Card (CAC), as determined by the business need.

The Contractor shall ensure all Contractor delivered applications and systems conform to the specific Identity and Access Management PIV requirements set forth in the Office of

Management and Budget (OMB) Memoranda [M-05-24](#), [M-19-17](#), [M-22-09](#), and NIST Federal Information Processing Standard (FIPS) 201-3. Contractor delivered applications and systems shall be on the FIPS 201 Approved Product List (APL). If the Contractor delivered application and system is not on the APL, the Contractor shall be responsible for taking the application and system through the FIPS 201 Evaluation Program.

The Contractor shall ensure all Contractor delivered applications and systems support:

- Automated provisioning and are able to use enterprise provisioning service.
- Interfacing with VA's Master Person Index (MPI) to provision identity attributes, if the solution relies on VA user identities. MPI is the authoritative source for VA user identity data.
- The VA defined unique identity (Secure Identifier [SEC ID] / Integrated Control Number [ICN]).
- Multiple authenticators for a given identity and authenticators at every Authenticator Assurance Level (AAL) appropriate for the solution.
- Identity proofing for each Identity Assurance Level (IAL) appropriate for the solution.
- Federation for each Federation Assurance Level (FAL) appropriate for the solution, if applicable.
- Two-factor authentication (2FA) through an applicable Technology Guideline as outlined in VA ETG.
- A Security Assertion Markup Language (SAML) implementation if the solution relies on assertion-based authentication. Additional assertion implementations, besides the required SAML assertion, may be provided as long as they are compliant with NIST SP 800-63-4 guidelines.
- Authentication/account binding based on trusted Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP) headers if the solution relies on Trust based authentication.
- Role Based Access Control.
- Auditing and reporting capabilities.
- Compliance with VIEWS 00155984, PIV Logical Access Policy Clarification <https://www.voa.va.gov/DocumentView.aspx?DocumentID=4896>.

The required Assurance Levels for this specific effort are Identity Assurance Level 3, Authenticator Assurance Level 3, and Federation Assurance Level 3.

6.1.4 INTERNET PROTOCOL VERSION 6 (IPv6)

The Contractor solution shall support IPv6-Only based upon the memo issued by the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) on November 19, 2020 (<https://www.whitehouse.gov/wp-content/uploads/2020/11/M-21-07.pdf>). Which defines IPv6-only as the state of an operational system or service when IPv4 protocol functions (addressing, packet forwarding) are not in use. The NIST USGv6 profile defines technical requirements for a product to be capable of operating in IPv6-Only environments. IPv6-Only technology, in accordance with the USGv6 Program (<https://www.nist.gov/programs-projects/usgv6-program/usgv6-revision-1>), NIST Special Publication (SP) 500-267B Revision 1 "USGv6 Profile" (<https://doi.org/10.6028/NIST.SP.500-267Br1>), and NIST SP 800-119 "Guidelines for the Secure Deployment of IPv6" (<https://doi.org/10.6028/NIST.SP.800-119>), compliance shall be included in all IT infrastructures, application designs, application development, operational systems and sub-systems, and their integration. In addition to the above requirements, all devices, applications, and systems shall support all applicable functionality on native IPv6-Only as well as dual stack

(IPv6 / IPv4) connectivity without additional memory or other resources being provided by the Government, so that they can function in a mixed environment. All public/external facing servers and services (e.g., web, email, DNS, ISP services, etc.) support native IPv6-Only and dual stack (IPv6 / IPv4) users and all internal infrastructure and applications shall support using native IPv6-Only and dual stack (IPv6 / IPv4) for all functionality and operations.

6.1.5 TRUSTED INTERNET CONNECTION (TIC)

The Contractor solution shall meet the requirements outlined in Office of Management and Budget Memorandum M-19-26, “Update to the Trusted Internet Connections (TIC) Initiative” (<https://www.whitehouse.gov/wp-content/uploads/2019/09/M-19-26.pdf>), VA Directive 6513 “Secure External Connections”, and shall comply with the TIC 3.0 Core Guidance Documents, including all Volumes and TIC Use Cases, found at the Cybersecurity & Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) (<https://www.cisa.gov/publication/tic-30-core-guidance-documents>).

6.1.6 STANDARD COMPUTER CONFIGURATION

The Contractor IT end user solution that is developed for use on standard VA computers shall be compatible with and be supported on the standard VA operating system, Windows 11, Edge (Chromium based), and 365 Apps for enterprise. Applications delivered to VA and intended to be deployed to Windows 11 workstations shall be delivered as a signed. Msi package with switches for silent and unattended installation and updates shall be delivered in signed .msp file formats for easy deployment using Microsoft Endpoint Configuration Manager (CM) VA’s current desktop application deployment tool. Signing of the software code shall be through a contractor provided certificate that is trusted by VA using a code signing authority such as Verizon/Cybertrust or Symantec/VeriSign. The Contractor shall also ensure and certify that their solution functions as expected when used from a standard VA computer, with non-admin, standard user rights that have been configured using the Defense Information Systems Agency (DISA) Secure Technical Implementation Guide (STIG) specific to the particular client operating system being used.

6.1.7 VETERAN FOCUSED INTEGRATION PROCESS (VIP) AND PRODUCT LINE MANAGEMENT (PLM)

The Contractor shall support VA efforts IAW the Veteran-Focused Integration Process (VIP) Guide and Product Line Management (PLM) Playbook. The major focus of VIP is on Enterprise Oversight, Governance, reporting, and establishing practices that focus on outcomes and continuously delivering sustainable IT capabilities to benefit the Veteran. PLM is a framework that focuses on delivering functional products that provide the highest priority work to customers while delivering simplified, reliable, and practical solutions to the business, medical staff, and our Veterans. The VIP Guide is a companion guide to the PLM Transformation Playbook and can be found at: <https://www.voa.va.gov/DocumentView.aspx?DocumentID=4371> and the PLM Transformation Playbook can be found at <https://www.voa.va.gov/DocumentView.aspx?DocumentID=4946>. VIP and PLM are the authoritative processes that IT projects must follow to ensure development and delivery of IT products.

The VIP Guide provides guidance for transitioning from project-centric to product-centric delivery. The VIP guide applies to all OIT Office of Management and Budget (OMB) reportable products that are required to collect and report costs, schedules, risks, and other valuable information in VA PARS (whether products are procured or developed by VA) and any VA Information Technology project effort in Software Product Management (SPM) and

Infrastructure Operations (IO), or their successors, that touch the VA network regardless of IT organizational alignment (whether it spends government funding from VA's Congressional IT Appropriation or any other appropriation).

The PLM Transformation Playbook details how OIT leadership expects Product Lines (PLs) to implement PLM, DevOps, and Lean-Agile principles, methods, practices, and techniques through levels of maturity. The PLM Transformation Playbook applies to all Information Technology (IT) products aligned to PLs in the Software Product Management, Infrastructure Operations and Product Engineering organizations within the OIT organization.

Others outside the referenced groups or organizations may use the VIP Guide and PLM Transformation Playbook for situational awareness as needed.

6.1.8 PROCESS ASSET LIBRARY (PAL)

The Contractor shall perform their duties consistent with the processes defined in the OIT Process Asset Library (PAL). The PAL includes a spectrum of OIT functions and activities, such as project management, operations, service delivery, communications, acquisition, and resource management. PAL serves as an authoritative and informative repository of searchable processes, activities or tasks, roles, artifacts, tools and applicable standards and guides to assist the OIT workforce, Government and Contractor personnel. OIT utilizes PAL processes to ensure compliance with policies and regulations and to meet VA quality standards. The PAL includes the contractor onboarding process consistent with Section 6.2.2 and can be found at [process_CONB_ext.docx \(live.com\)](#). The main PAL can be accessed at www.va.gov/process.

6.1.9 AUTHORITATIVE DATA SOURCES

The VA Enterprise Architecture Repository (VEAR) is one component within the overall EA that establishes the common framework for data taxonomy for describing the data architecture used to develop, operate, and maintain enterprise applications. The Contractor shall comply with the department's Authoritative Data Source (ADS) requirement that VA systems, services, and processes throughout the enterprise shall access VA data solely through official VA ADSs where applicable, see below. The Information Classes which compose each ADS are located in the VEAR, in the Data & Information domain. The Contractor shall ensure that all delivered applications and system solutions support:

- Interfacing with VA's Master Person Index (MPI) (formerly the Master Veteran Index (MVI)) to provision identity attributes, if the solution relies on VA user identities. MPI is the authoritative source for VA user identity data.
- Interfacing with Capital Asset Inventory (CAI) to conduct real property record management actions, if the solution relies on real property records data. CAI is the authoritative source for VA real property record management data.
- Interfacing with electronic Contract Management System (eCMS) for access to contract, contract line item, purchase requisition, offering vendor, and solicitation information above the micro-purchase threshold, if the solution relies on procurement data. ECMS is the authoritative source for VA procurement actions data.
- Interfacing with HRSmart Human Resources Information System to conduct personnel action processing, on-boarding, benefits management, and compensation management, if the solution relies on personnel data. HRSmart is the authoritative source for VA personnel information data.

- Interfacing with VA Profile to access personal contact information, if the solution relies on VA Veteran personal contact information data. VA Profile is the authoritative source for VA Veteran Personal Contact Data.
- Interfacing with VA/Department of Defense (DoD) Identity Repository (VADIR) for determining eligibility for VA benefits under Title 38, if the solution relies on qualifying active-duty military service data. VADIR is the authoritative source for qualifying active-duty military service in VA.
- Interfacing with VA Systems Inventory (VASI) to access VA systems information, if the solution relies on VA system information. VASI is the authoritative source for VA Information Technology systems.
- Interfacing with Enterprise Mission Assurance Support Service (eMASS) to access the historical ATO status of all VA Information Systems prior to migrating to ServiceNow Continuous Authorization and Monitoring (SNowCAM) until it is determined the migration is completed and eMASS is sunset. eMASS contains the historical ATO status of all VA Information Systems prior to September 30, 2025, with all status provided through SNowCAM once migration is completed.

6.1.10 SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER (SSN) REDUCTION

The Contractor solution shall support the Social Security Number (SSN) Fraud Prevention Act (FPA) of 2017 which prohibits the inclusion of SSNs on any document sent by mail. The Contractor support shall also be performed in accordance with Section 240 of the Consolidated Appropriations Act (CAA) 2018, enacted March 23, 2018, which mandates VA to discontinue using SSNs to identify individuals in all VA information systems as the Primary Identifier. The Contractor shall ensure that any new IT solution discontinues the use of SSN as the Primary Identifier to replace the SSN with the ICN in all VA information systems for all individuals. The Contractor shall ensure that all Contractor delivered applications and systems integrate with the VA MPI for identity traits to include the use of the ICN as the Primary Identifier. The Contractor solution may only use a Social Security Number to identify an individual in an information system if and only if the use of such number is required to obtain information VA requires from an information system that is not under the jurisdiction of VA.

6.1.11 GENERATIVE ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE REQUIREMENTS

If Artificial Intelligence (AI) is part of the Contractor system/solution, the Contractor shall be in compliance with E.O. 13960 and 14319, OMB Memorandums M-25-21, M-25-22, and M-26-04, and VA Directive and Handbook 6500 to support VA in trustworthy, secure, responsible, accountable, Truth Seeking, and Ideologically Neutral AI innovation.

The Contractor shall protect VA Sensitive data from unauthorized disclosure or use, and from being used to train or improve the functionality of the vendor's commercial AI offerings without express permission from VA. Current guidance and approved AI tools are available here: <https://department.va.gov/ai/guidance-for-generative-ai-use-at-va/>. The entire definition of VA Sensitive Data can be found at 38 U.S.C. § 5727 (23).

The Contractor shall deliver the services, technical data, configurations, models, weights, documentation or other information, including source code, developed during contract performance. The Contractor, in collaboration with VA, must evaluate the output of any AI tool for accuracy prior to using the output in VA efforts. All data, including models, weights, algorithms, and outputs generated using either Government-furnished data or data first developed under this contract shall be the property of the Government with unlimited rights as defined by

FAR 52.227-14. The Contractor shall also deliver any custom-developed code developed with AI methodologies in accordance with the SHARE IT Act, if applicable. VA shall also retain unlimited rights to any improvements to that data, including the continued design, development, testing, and operation of AI systems and/or systems utilizing AI.

The Contractor shall ensure that all AI Systems, including Large Language Models (LLM), whether standalone LLMs or integrated into broader software platforms, procured under this effort and/or used in performance of this contract complies with the Unbiased AI Principles as defined in Executive Order 14319 and OMB Memorandum M-26-04, e.g. Truth Seeking and Ideologically Neutral, as applicable to the intended use of the system.

The Contractor shall ensure that AI System/LLM generated outputs are truthful in responding to user prompts seeking factual information or analysis, prioritize historical accuracy, scientific inquiry, and objectivity, as well as acknowledge uncertainty where reliable information is incomplete or contradictory and do not fabricate, hallucinate, or present unverifiable information as fact.

The Contractor shall ensure that LLMs and AI outputs are neutral, nonpartisan tools that do not manipulate responses in favor of ideological dogmas such as Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI). The Contractor shall ensure that the LLMs, including the AI System, are not intentionally encoded with partisan or ideological judgments within an AI System's/LLM's outputs unless those judgments are prompted by or otherwise readily accessible to the end user.

Compliance with the AI requirements of this contract, including adherence to the Unbiased AI Principles, Truth-Seeking and Ideological Neutrality requirements, disclosure obligations, monitoring and reporting requirements, and corrective action responsibilities, is a material condition of eligibility for payment and continued performance. In accordance with OMB Memorandum M-26-04, failure to comply with these requirements, or refusal to take timely and appropriate corrective action to remedy identified noncompliance, may constitute a material breach of contract and may result in remedies consistent with the terms of the contract and applicable law including but not limited to withholding of payment, termination for cause/default, or other appropriate contractual remedies, as determined by the Contracting Officer.

All AI for delivery and/or use in performance of the contract shall adhere to the *VA Trustworthy AI Framework*, available at <https://department.va.gov/ai/trustworthy/>. Once the Contractor has obtained CO authorization to use specific AI in contract performance, the Contractor shall provide the COR a signed Statement of Attestation prior to AI implementation as identified in the Artificial Intelligence in VA Contracts clause, to include its associated list of AI being used in contract performance.

Deliverable:

A. Statement of Attestation

6.1.11.1 AI System/LLM Development and Operation Documentation Requirements

To enable Government continued assessment of compliance with Trustworthy AI requirements and both Unbiased AI Principles, Truth-seeking and Ideological Neutrality, in accordance with OMB M-26-04, the Contractor shall provide AI System/LLM Development and Operation Documentation Package to include, at a minimum:

1. **Acceptable Use Policy**

The Contractor shall provide an Acceptable Use Policy document governing its AI operation that characterizes and differentiates appropriate and inappropriate use of their product offering

2. **Model Cards, System Cards and/or Data Cards**

The Contractor shall provide documentation describing essential information about the model, system, and or data as it relates to the AI/LLM product offering. The documentation shall address summaries of training process, identified risks and mitigations, and model evaluation scores on LLM benchmarks at a minimum, where appropriate

3. **End User Resources**

The Contractor shall provide documentation to include product tutorials, developer guides, and/or other tools to assist VA in ensuring proper use of the AI/LLM to maximize utility

4. **Mechanism for End User Feedback**

The Contractor shall provide documentation describing the mechanism employed to provide feedback to the Quoters on outputs identified that violate the Unbiased AI Principles. This may be satisfied by a general inbox, specific Point of Contact, or similar feedback mechanism.

5. **Pre-Training and Post-Training Activities of the AI System/LLM**

The Contractor shall provide documentation of Pre-Training and Post Training Activity that provides details on:

- a. Actions taken that impact the factuality and grounding of AI System/LLM outputs
- b. System-level prompts that provide natural language instructions to the model specifying guidelines on responding to user-generated queries, to include how a model responds when reliable information is incomplete, contradictory, or subject to individual interpretation
- c. The type of outputs restricted via content moderation and safety filters
- d. The use of red teaming as a means of continuously assessing the model to protect against incidents of bias in generated output.
- e. Training or development, if any, that occurred outside the United States, to include the type of activity and the country in which it occurred.
- f. Any modifications or configurations undertaken to comply with any regulation from a government other than the U.S. Federal Government.

6. **Model Evaluation Results and Methodologies**

The Contractor shall provide documentation describing the Evaluation Results of bias evaluations conducted by the Vendor to include the methodology for performing such tests (e.g., testing prompt pairs for politically oriented topics).

The documentation shall also include Benchmark scoring results measuring the model's bias, helpfulness, honesty, or accuracy when provided with ambiguous versus straightforward questions. (Including any benchmarks comparing performance across multiple languages, where applicable).

7. **Description of Enterprise-Level Controls**

The Contractor shall provide documentation describing the Enterprise Governance tools and controls, such as:

- a. Customizable system instructions that are additive to a base model's system prompts or content generation filters.
- b. Product features that require a model to cite sources of its outputs or otherwise provide visibility into the provenance of the model's outputs.

- c. AI System/LLM model evaluation tools that enable comparisons either between a model's outputs, or across various models.

8. Third Party Modification Disclosure

The Contractor shall disclose of any additional controls to modify an AI Model's/LLM's output applied by the Contractor if the Contractor is not a direct developer of the LLM (e.g., classifiers, system prompts, fine-tuning, content moderation and filters, etc.)

Deliverable:

- A. AI System/LLM Development and Operation Documentation Package

6.1.11.2 Monitoring, Reporting, and Corrective Action

The Contractor shall develop and implement a Compliance Monitoring and Reporting Plan supporting ongoing monitoring processes to evaluate AI outputs for compliance with Trustworthy AI and Unbiased AI principles. This plan shall include the mechanism for authorized users to provide end user feedback to report suspected violations of Truth-Seeking or Ideological Neutrality requirements.

The Contractor shall notify the COR within 10 business days of identifying any material deviation from these principles and shall submit a written Corrective Action Plan describing mitigation steps, responsible parties, and timelines. Any material deviation, corrective action taken, and results shall be detailed in the Monthly Progress Reports.

Deliverables:

- A. Compliance Monitoring and Reporting Plan
- B. Corrective Action Plan

6.1.11.3 AI Model Updates and Change Disclosures

The Contractor, in an AI Model/LLM Change Disclosure, shall notify the Government throughout the PoP in advance of any material changes to AI models, including new AI enhancements, features and/or components, controls, retraining, classifiers, system prompts, fine-tuning, content moderation, filters, version replacement, or architectural changes, that could reasonably affect compliance with Trustworthy AI or Unbiased AI principles. Updated documentation shall be provided to VA for VA approval prior to implementation of such changes.

Deliverable:

- A. AI Model/LLM Change Disclosure

6.1.12 SOURCE CODE HARMONIZATION AND REUSE IN INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY (SHARE IT Act)

The Contractor shall comply with the Source Code Harmonization and Reuse in Information Technology (SHARE IT) Act, P.L. 118-187, when developing and delivering custom code first produced for the VA in the performance of this Contract/Order. The Contractor shall deliver to the Government all data first produced under this Contract/Order with unlimited rights as defined by FAR 52.227-14, to include without limitation, all custom-developed code and other key technical components of the code (including documentation, data models, schemas, metadata, architecture designs, configuration scripts, and artifacts required to develop, build, test, and deploy the code). Custom-developed code includes source code, or segregable portions of source code and all documentation created in support thereof to include source code written for a

software project, product, module, plugin, script, middleware, or application programming interface.

6.2 SECURITY AND PRIVACY REQUIREMENTS

It has been determined that protected health information may be disclosed or accessed, and a signed Business Associate Agreement (BAA) shall be required. The Contractor shall adhere to the requirements set forth within the BAA, referenced in Section D of the contract, and shall comply with VA Directive 6066.

6.2.1 POSITION/TASK RISK DESIGNATION LEVEL(S)

In accordance with VA Handbook 0710, Personnel Vetting Program, the position sensitivity and the level of background investigation commensurate with the required level of access for the following tasks within the PWS are:

Position Sensitivity and Background Investigation Requirements by Task TBD

Task Number	Tier1 / Low Risk	Tier 2 / Moderate Risk	Tier 4 / High Risk
5.1	☐	☒	☐
5.2	☐	☒	☐
5.3	☐	☒	☐
5.4	☐	☒	☐
5.5	☐	☒	☐
5.6	☐	☒	☐
5.7	☐	☒	☐
5.8	☐	☒	☐
5.9	☐	☒	☐
5.10	☐	☒	☐
5.11	☐	☒	☐
5.12	☐	☒	☐
5.13	☐	☒	☐

The Tasks identified above and the resulting Position Sensitivity and Background Investigation requirements identify, in effect, the Background Investigation requirements for Contractor individuals, based upon the tasks the particular Contractor individual shall be working. The submitted Contractor Staff Roster must indicate the required Background Investigation Level for each Contractor individual based upon the tasks the Contractor individual shall be working, in accordance with their submitted proposal.

6.2.2 CONTRACTOR PERSONNEL SECURITY REQUIREMENTS

Contractor Responsibilities:

- a. The Contractor shall prescreen all personnel requiring access to the computer systems to ensure they maintain the appropriate Background Investigation, and are able to read, write, speak, and understand the English language.
 - b. Within 3 business days after award, the Contractor shall provide a roster of Contractor and Subcontractor employees to the COR to begin their background investigations in accordance with the PAL template artifact. The Contractor Staff Roster shall contain the Contractor's Full Name, Date of Birth, Place of Birth, individual background investigation level requirement (based upon Section 6.2.1 Tasks), as well as the following information IAW VAAR 852.204-72 Personnel Vetting and Credentialing:
 - i. Name of VA facility where Contractor/subcontractor employee works, if applicable.
 - ii. Date background check submitted for Contractor/subcontractor employee.
 - iii. Date PIV/identification card issued to Contractor/subcontractor employee.
 - iv. Contractor/subcontractor employee's PIV/identification card number, as applicable.
 - v. Date Contractor/subcontractor employee no longer has need for PIV/Identification card.
 - vi. Date Contractor notified VA that PIV/Identification card is no longer required.
- Date Contractor returned PIV/identification card to VA.
- c. The Contractor shall submit associated full Social Security Numbers either within the Contractor Staff Roster or under separate cover to the COR. The Contractor Staff Roster shall be updated and provided to VA within five working days after the end of each calendar quarter, and within one day of any changes in employee status, training certification completion status, Background Investigation level status, additions/removal of employees, etc. throughout the Period of Performance. The Contractor Staff Roster shall remain a historical document indicating all past information and the Contractor shall indicate in the Comment field, employees no longer supporting this contract. The preferred method to send the Contractor Staff Roster or Social Security Number is by encrypted e-mail. If unable to send encrypted e-mail, other methods which comply with FIPS 140-2 (or its successor) are to encrypt the file, use a secure fax, or use a traceable mail service. (Note that by September 22, 2026, all FIPS 140-2 certificate validations shall be placed on the Historical List. See FIPS Transition Effort Timeline for more details: <https://csrc.nist.gov/projects/fips-140-3-transition-effort#schedule>)
 - d. The Contractor should coordinate with the location of the nearest VA fingerprinting office through the COR. Only electronic fingerprints are authorized. The Contractor shall bring their completed Personnel Security Adjudication Center (PSAC) Fingerprint request form with them (see paragraph e.4. below) when getting fingerprints taken.
 - e. The Contractor shall ensure the following required forms are submitted to the COR within five days after contract award:
 - i. Optional Form 306
 - ii. Self-Certification of Continuous Service
 - iii. VA Form 0710
 - iv. Completed PSAC Fingerprint Request Form
 - f. The Contractor personnel shall submit all required information related to their background investigations (completion of the investigation documents (SF85, SF85P, or SF 86) utilizing Defense Counterintelligence and Security Agency (DCSA) National Background Investigation Services (NBIS) Electronic Application (eAPP) (formerly e-QIP) after receiving an email notification from the PSAC.

- g. The Contractor employee shall certify and release the eAPP document, print, and sign the signature pages, and send them encrypted to the COR for electronic submission to the PSAC. These documents shall be submitted to the COR within 3 business days of receipt of the eAPP notification email. (Note: DCSA is moving towards a “click to sign” process. If click to sign is used, the Contractor employee should notify the COR within 3 business days that documents were signed via eAPP).
- h. The Contractor shall be responsible for the actions of all personnel provided to work for VA under this contract. In the event that damages arise from work performed by Contractor provided personnel, under the auspices of this contract, the Contractor shall be responsible for all resources necessary to remedy the incident.
- i. A Contractor may be granted unescorted access to VA facilities and/or access to VA Information Technology resources (network and/or protected data) with a favorably adjudicated Special Agreement Check (SAC), completed training delineated in VA Handbook 6500.6 (Appendix C, Section 4), signed “Contractor Rules of Behavior”, and with a valid, operational Personal Identity Verification (PIV) credential for PIV-only logical access to VA’s network. A PIV card credential can be issued once your SAC has been favorably adjudicated and your background investigation has been scheduled by DCSA. However, the Contractor shall be responsible for the actions of the Contractor personnel they provide to perform work for VA. The investigative history for Contractor personnel working under this contract must be maintained in the database of DCSA.
- j. The Contractor, when notified of an unfavorably adjudicated background investigation on a Contractor employee as determined by the Government, shall withdraw the employee from consideration in working under the contract.
- k. Failure to comply with the Contractor personnel security investigative requirements may result in loss of physical and/or logical access to VA facilities and systems by Contractor and Subcontractor employees and/or termination of the contract for default.
- l. PIV Credential Holders must follow all HSPD-Twelve (12) policies and procedures as well as use and protect their assigned identity credentials in accordance with VA policies and procedures, displaying their badges at all times, and returning the identity credentials upon termination of their relationship with VA.

Deliverable:

- A. Contractor Staff Roster

6.3 METHOD AND DISTRIBUTION OF DELIVERABLES

The Contractor shall deliver documentation in electronic format, unless otherwise directed in Section B of the solicitation/contract. Acceptable electronic media include Microsoft 365 suite, MS Word, MS Excel, MS PowerPoint, MS Project, MS Access, MS Visio, AutoCAD, and Adobe Postscript Data Format (PDF).

6.4 PERFORMANCE METRICS

The table below defines the Performance Standards and Acceptable Levels of Performance associated with this effort.

Performance Objective	Performance Standard	Acceptable Levels of Performance
A. Technical / Quality of Product or Service	1. Demonstrates understanding of requirements 2. Efficient and effective in meeting requirements 3. Meets technical needs and mission requirements 4. Provides quality services/products 5. Incorporates “ease of use” Human Centered Design principles in any software developed.	Satisfactory or higher
B. Project Milestones and Schedule	1. Established milestones and project dates are met 2. Products completed, reviewed, delivered in accordance with the established schedule 3. Notifies customer in advance of potential problems	Satisfactory or higher
C. Cost & Staffing	1. Currency of expertise and staffing levels appropriate to perform tasks required 2. Personnel possess necessary knowledge, skills, and abilities to perform tasks	Satisfactory or higher
D. Management	1. Integration and coordination of all activities to execute effort	Satisfactory or higher

The COR shall utilize a Quality Assurance Surveillance Plan (QASP) throughout the life of the contract to ensure that the Contractor is performing the services required by this PWS in an acceptable level of performance. The Government reserves the right to alter or change the surveillance methods in the QASP at its own discretion. A Performance Based Service Assessment shall be used by the COR in accordance with the QASP to assess Contractor performance.

6.5 FACILITY/RESOURCE PROVISIONS

The Government shall provide office space, telephone service and access system when authorized contract staff work at a Government location as required in order to accomplish the Tasks associated with this PWS. All procedural guides, reference materials, and program documentation for the project and other Government applications shall also be provided on the as-needed basis.

The Contractor shall request other Government documentation deemed pertinent to the work accomplishment directly from the Government officials with whom the Contractor has contact. The Contractor shall consider the COR as the final source for needed Government documentation when the Contractor fails to secure the documents by other means. The Contractor is expected to use common knowledge and resourcefulness in securing all other reference materials, standard industry publications, and related materials that are pertinent to the work.

VA may provide remote access to VA specific systems/network in accordance with VA Handbook 6500, which requires the use of a VA approved method to connect external equipment/systems to VA's network. Citrix Access Gateway (CAG) and now the Azure Virtual Desktop (AVD) (as VA is currently transitioning from CAG to the AVD), are the current and only VA approved methods for remote access users when using or manipulating VA information for official VA Business. VA permits CAG remote access through approved Personally Owned Equipment (POE) and Other Equipment (OE) provided the equipment meets all applicable 6500 Handbook requirements for POE/OE. All of the security controls required for Government furnished equipment (GFE) must be utilized in approved POE or OE. The Contractor shall provide proof to the COR for review and approval that their POE or OE meets the VA Handbook 6500 requirements and VA Handbook 6500.6 Appendix C, herein incorporated as Addendum B, before use. CAG authorized users shall not be permitted to copy, print, or save any VA information accessed via CAG at any time. VA prohibits remote access to VA's network from non-North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) countries. The exception to this is countries where VA has approved operations established (e.g. Philippines and South Korea). Exceptions are determined by the COR in coordination with the Information System Security Officer (ISSO) and Privacy Officer (PO).

This remote access may provide access to VA specific software such as VistA, ClearQuest, PAL, Primavera, and Remedy, including appropriate seat management and user licenses, depending upon the level of access granted. The Contractor shall utilize government-provided software development and test accounts, documents, and requirements repositories, etc. as required for the development, storage, maintenance, and delivery of products within the scope of this effort. All VA sensitive information shall be protected at all times in accordance with VA Handbook 6500, local security field office System Security Plans (SSP's) and ATOs for all systems/LAN's accessed while performing the tasks detailed in this PWS. The Contractor shall ensure all work is performed in countries deemed not to pose a significant security risk. For detailed Security and Privacy Requirements (additional requirements of the contract consolidated into an addendum for easy reference) refer to ADDENDUM A – ADDITIONAL VA REQUIREMENTS, CONSOLIDATED and ADDENDUM B - VA INFORMATION AND INFORMATION SYSTEM SECURITY/PRIVACY LANGUAGE.

6.6 GOVERNMENT FURNISHED PROPERTY

The Government has multiple remote access solutions available to include CAG, AVD, Site-to-Site Virtual Private Network (VPN), and RESCUE VPN.

The Government's issuance of Government Furnished Equipment (GFE) is limited to Contractor personnel requiring direct access to the network to: development environments; install, configure and run TRM approved software and tools (e.g., Oracle, Fortify, Eclipse, SoapUI, WebLogic,

LoadRunner); upload/download/ manipulate code, run scripts, and apply patches; configure and change system settings; check logs, troubleshoot/debug, and test/QA.

When necessary, the Government shall refurnish desktops or laptops, for use by the Contractor to access VA networks, systems, or applications to meet the requirements of this PWS. The overarching goal is to determine the most cost-effective approach to providing needed access to the VA environment coupled with the need to ensure proper Change Management principles are followed. Contractor personnel shall adhere to all VA system access requirements for on-site and remote users in accordance with VA standards, local security regulations, policies, and rules of behavior. GFE shall be approved by the COR and Program Manager on a case-by-case basis prior to issuance.

Based upon the Government assessment of remote access solutions and requirements of this effort, the Government estimates the following GFE shall be required by this effort:

1. **Standard Laptops or Performance Laptops**

The Government shall not provide IT accessories including but not limited to Mobile Wi-Fi hotspots/wireless access points, additional or specialized keyboards or mice, laptop bags, extra charging cables, extra Personal Identity Verification card readers, peripheral devices, or additional Random Access Memory (RAM). The Contractor is responsible for providing these types of IT accessories in support of this effort as necessary and any VA installation required for these IT accessories shall be coordinated with the COR.

For migration to the VAEC, the Government shall furnish Cloud capacity in and connectivity to the VAEC environments, VA Enterprise Cloud Operational Tools (VAECOT) comprised of a suite of COTS cloud management tools as identified in the VAEC Technical Reference Guide, and Enterprise Development Environment (EDE) and Tools as identified in the VAEC Technical Reference Guide.

Additionally, the Contractor shall provide a status of all reportable GFE as part of the **Monthly** Status Report as required by PWS paragraph 5.1. For purposes of this report, reportable GFE includes equipment that is furnished by the Government as tangible “personal” property which the Contractor takes possession of, physically leaves a Government facility, and needs to be returned the end of Contractor performance. The following information shall be provided for each piece of GFE:

- Name of Contractor employee assigned to the GFE
- Type of Equipment (Make and Model)
- Tracking Number/Serial Number
- VA Bar Code
- Location
- Value
- Total Value of Equipment
- Anticipated Transfer Date to Government
- Anticipated Transfer Location

ADDENDUM A – ADDITIONAL VA REQUIREMENTS, CONSOLIDATED**A1.0 Cyber and Information Security Requirements for VA IT Services**

The Contractor shall ensure adequate LAN/Internet, data, information, and system security in accordance with VA standard operating procedures and standard PWS language, conditions, laws, and regulations. The Contractor's firewall and web server shall meet or exceed VA minimum requirements for security. All VA data shall be protected behind an approved firewall. Any security violations or attempted violations shall be reported to the VA Program Manager and VA Information Security Officer as soon as possible. The Contractor shall follow all applicable VA policies and procedures governing information security, especially those that pertain to assessment and authorization and continuous monitoring.

Contractor supplied equipment, PCs of all types, equipment with hard drives, etc. for contract services must meet all security requirements that apply to Government Furnished Equipment (GFE) and Government Owned Equipment (GOE). Security Requirements include: a) VA Approved Encryption Software must be installed on all laptops or mobile devices before being placed into operation, b) Bluetooth equipped devices are prohibited within VA; Bluetooth must be permanently disabled or removed from the device, unless the connection uses FIPS 140-2 (or its successor) validated encryption, c) VA approved anti-virus and firewall software, d) Equipment must meet all VA sanitization requirements and procedures before disposal. The Contractor shall notify the COR/CO within one hour of disclosure or successful exploits of any vulnerability which can compromise the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of the information systems.

Each documented initiative under this contract incorporates VA Handbook 6500.6, "Contract Security," March 12, 2010 (Appendix C updated April 22, 2024) by reference as though fully set forth therein. The VA Handbook 6500.6, "Contract Security" shall also be included in every related agreement, contract, or order. The VA Handbook 6500.6, Appendix C, is included in this document as Addendum B.

Training requirements: The Contractor shall complete all mandatory training courses on the current VA training site, the VA Talent Management System (TMS) 2.0, and shall be tracked therein. The TMS 2.0 may be accessed at <https://www.tms.va.gov/SecureAuth35/>. If you do not have a TMS 2.0 profile, go to <https://www.tms.va.gov/SecureAuth35/> and click on the "Create New User" link on the TMS 2.0 to gain access.

Contractor employees shall complete a VA Systems Access Agreement if they are provided access privileges as an authorized user of the computer system of VA.

A2.0 VA Enterprise Architecture Compliance

The applications, supplies, and services furnished under this contract must comply with VA Enterprise Architecture (EA), available at <http://www.ea.oit.va.gov/index.asp> in force at the time of issuance of this contract, including the Program Management Plan and VA's rules, standards, and guidelines in the Technical Reference Model/Standards Profile (TRMSP). VA reserves the right to assess contract deliverables for EA compliance prior to acceptance.

A2.1. VA Internet and Intranet Standards

The Contractor shall adhere to and comply with VA Directive 6102 and VA's Web Governance if the Contractor's work includes building and maintaining VA's digital presence. This pertains, but is not limited to: websites, social media, creating announcements; collecting information; databases to be accessed, graphics and links to external sites.

Internet/Intranet Services Directive 6102 is posted at (copy and paste the following URL to browser): https://www.va.gov/vapubs/viewPublication.asp?Pub_ID=1056&FType=2

VA Web Governance website can be found at [Home - VA Web Governance](#).

A3.0 Notice of the Federal Accessibility Law Affecting All Information and Communication Technology (ICT) Procurements (Section 508)

On January 18, 2017, the Access Board issued a final rule that updated accessibility requirements covered by Section 508 and refreshed guidelines for telecommunications equipment subject to Section 255 of the Communications Act. The final rule went into effect on January 18, 2018. The revisions and updates to the Section 508-based standards and Section 255-based guidelines are intended to ensure that information and communication technology (ICT) covered by the respective statutes is accessible to and usable by individuals with disabilities.

A3.1. Section 508 – Information and Communication Technology (ICT) Standards

The Section 508 standards established by the Access Board are incorporated into, and made part of all VA orders, solicitations and purchase orders developed to procure ICT. These standards are found in their entirety at: [Revised 508 Standards and 255 Guidelines \(access-board.gov\)](#). A single PDF file version of the Revised Section 508 Standards and 255 Guidelines shall be supplied upon request or can be obtained from the Access Board website. Federal agencies must comply with the Rehabilitation Act of 1973, as amended.

The Contractor shall comply with “508 Chapter 2: Scoping Requirements” for all electronic ICT and content delivered under this contract. Specifically, as appropriate for the technology and its functionality, the Contractor shall comply with the technical standards marked here:

- ☒ E205 Electronic Content – (Accessibility Standard -WCAG 2.0 Level A and AA Guidelines)
- ☒ E204 Functional Performance Criteria
- ☒ E206 Hardware Requirements
- ☒ E207 Software Requirements
- ☒ E208 Support Documentation and Services Requirements

A3.2. Compatibility with Assistive Technology

The standards do not require installation of specific accessibility-related software or attachment of an assistive technology device. Section 508 requires that ICT be compatible with such software and devices so that ICT can be accessible to and usable by individuals using assistive technology, including but not limited to screen readers, screen magnifiers, and speech recognition software.

A3.3. Acceptance and Acceptance Testing

Deliverables resulting from this solicitation shall be accepted based in part on satisfaction of Section 508 Chapter 2: Scoping requirements standards identified above.

The Government reserves the right to test for Section 508 Compliance before delivery. The Contractor shall be able to demonstrate Section 508 Compliance upon delivery.

A4.0 Physical Security & Safety Requirements:

The Contractor and their personnel shall follow all VA policies, standard operating procedures, applicable laws and regulations while on VA property. Violations of VA regulations and policies may result in citation and disciplinary measures for persons violating the law.

- The Contractor and their personnel shall wear visible identification at all times while they are on the premises.
- VA does not provide parking spaces at the work site; the Contractor must obtain parking at the work site if needed. It is the responsibility of the Contractor to park in the appropriate designated parking areas. VA shall not invalidate or make reimbursement for parking violations of the Contractor under any conditions.
- Smoking is prohibited inside/outside any building other than the designated smoking areas.
- Possession of weapons is prohibited.
- The Contractor shall obtain all necessary licenses and/or permits required to perform the work, with the exception of software licenses that need to be procured from a Contractor or vendor in accordance with the requirements document. The Contractor shall take all reasonable precautions necessary to protect persons and property from injury or damage during the performance of this contract.

A5.0 Confidentiality and Non-Disclosure

The Contractor shall follow all VA rules and regulations regarding information security to prevent disclosure of sensitive information to unauthorized individuals or organizations.

The Contractor may have access to Protected Health Information (PHI) and Electronic Protected Health Information (ePHI) that is subject to protection under the regulations issued by the Department of Health and Human Services, as mandated by the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA); 45 CFR Parts 160 and 164, Subparts A and E, the Standards for Privacy of Individually Identifiable Health Information (“Privacy Rule”); and 45 CFR Parts 160 and 164, Subparts A and C, the Security Standard (“Security Rule”). Pursuant to the Privacy and Security Rules, the Contractor must agree in writing to certain mandatory provisions regarding the use and disclosure of PHI and ePHI.

- The Contractor shall have access to some privileged and confidential materials of VA. These printed and electronic documents are for internal use only, are not to be copied or released without permission, and remain the sole property of VA. Some of these materials are protected by the Privacy Act of 1974 (revised by PL 93-5791) and Title 38. Unauthorized disclosure of Privacy Act or Title 38 covered materials is a criminal offense.
- The VA CO shall be the sole authorized official to release in writing, any data, draft deliverables, final deliverables, or any other written or printed materials pertaining to this contract. The Contractor shall release no information. Any request for information relating to this contract presented to the Contractor shall be submitted to the VA CO for response.
- Contractor personnel recognize that in the performance of this effort, Contractor personnel may receive or have access to sensitive information, including information

provided on a proprietary basis by carriers, equipment manufacturers and other private or public entities. Contractor personnel agree to safeguard such information and use the information exclusively in the performance of this contract. Contractor shall follow all VA rules and regulations regarding information security to prevent disclosure of sensitive information to unauthorized individuals or organizations as enumerated in this section and elsewhere in this Contract and its subparts and appendices.

- Contractor shall limit access to the minimum number of personnel necessary for contract performance for all information considered sensitive or proprietary in nature. If the Contractor is uncertain of the sensitivity of any information obtained during the performance this contract, the Contractor has a responsibility to ask the VA CO.
- Contractor shall train all of their employees involved in the performance of this contract on their roles and responsibilities for proper handling and nondisclosure of sensitive VA or proprietary information. Contractor personnel shall not engage in any other action, venture or employment wherein sensitive information shall be used for the profit of any party other than those furnishing the information. The sensitive information transferred, generated, transmitted, or stored herein is for VA benefit and ownership alone.
- Contractor shall maintain physical security at all facilities housing the activities performed under this contract, including any Contractor facilities according to VA-approved guidelines and directives. The Contractor shall ensure that security procedures are defined and enforced to ensure all personnel who are provided access to patient data must comply with published procedures to protect the privacy and confidentiality of such information as required by VA.
- Contractor must adhere to the following:
 - a. The use of “thumb drives” or any other medium for transport of information is expressly prohibited.
 - b. Controlled access to system and security software and documentation.
 - c. Recording, monitoring, and control of passwords and privileges.
 - d. All terminated personnel are denied physical and electronic access to all data, program listings, data processing equipment and systems.
 - e. VA, as well as any Contractor (or Subcontractor) systems used to support development, provide the capability to cancel immediately all access privileges and authorizations upon employee termination.
 - f. Contractor PM and VA PM are informed within twenty-four (24) hours of any employee termination.
 - g. Acquisition sensitive information shall be marked "Acquisition Sensitive" and shall be handled as "For Official Use Only (FOUO)".
 - h. Contractor does not require access to classified data.
- Regulatory standard of conduct governs all personnel directly and indirectly involved in procurements. All personnel engaged in procurement and related activities shall conduct business in a manner above reproach and, except as authorized by statute or regulation, with complete impartiality and with preferential treatment for none. The general rule is to strictly avoid any conflict of interest or even the appearance of a conflict of interest in VA/Contractor relationships.
- VA Form 0752 shall be completed by all Contractor employees working on this contract and shall be provided to the CO before any work is performed. In the case

that Contractor personnel are replaced in the future, their replacements shall complete VA Form 0752 prior to beginning work.

A6.0 Information Technology Using Sustainable Products

The Contractor shall comply with Sections 524 and Sections 525 of the Energy Independence and Security Act of 2007; Section 104 of the Energy Policy Act of 2005; Executive Order 14148, “Initial Rescissions of Harmful Executive Orders and Actions,” dated January 20, 2025; Executive Order 13221, “Energy-Efficient Standby Power Devices,” dated August 2, 2001; and the Revolutionary Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Overhaul (RFO) to provide ENERGY STAR® certified and Federal Energy Management Program (FEMP) Designated Low Standby Power information technology products, see <https://www.energy.gov/femp/search-energy-efficient-products>. See <http://www.energystar.gov> for complete product specifications and updated lists of Energy Star certified products. FEMP low standby power product listing can be found at <https://www.energy.gov/femp/low-standby-power-product-list>.

The Contractor shall provide products that meet the definition of sustainable products if the products are delivered to the Government; furnished by the Contractor for use by the Government, incorporated into the construction of a public building or public work, or acquired by the Contractor for use in performing services under a Government contract where the cost of the products is a direct cost to a Government contract (versus costs which are normally applied to a contractor's general and administrative expenses or indirect costs).

Specifically, the Contractor shall provide sustainable products under this contract in accordance with FAR 52.223-23 (NOV 2025). The applicable products with their associated certification, designation, and/or ecolabel (e.g. Energy Star, FEMP, Low Standby Power) are identified within the product specifications in this PWS. The Contractor shall self-certify that its proposed products meet the certification(s) / designation(s) specified.

**ADDENDUM B – VA INFORMATION AND INFORMATION SYSTEM SECURITY/
PRIVACY LANGUAGE**

NOTE: In the event of a conflict, VAAR Security Clauses take precedence over the language in this Addendum B.

APPLICABLE SECTIONS TAILORED FROM: VA NOTICE 24-12, APRIL 22, 2024, UPDATE TO VA HANDBOOK 6500.6, CONTRACT SECURITY, APPENDIX C VA INFORMATION AND INFORMATION SYSTEM SECURITY/PRIVACY LANGUAGE, FOR INCLUSION INTO CONTRACTS, AS APPROPRIATE

B1. GENERAL

This entire section applies to all acquisitions requiring any Information Security and Privacy language. Contractors, contractor personnel, Subcontractors and subcontractor personnel shall be subject to the same federal laws, regulations, standards, VA directives and handbooks, as VA personnel regarding information and information system security and privacy.

B.2 VA INFORMATION CUSTODIAL LANGUAGE

- The Government shall receive unlimited rights to data/intellectual property first produced and delivered in the performance of this contract or order (hereinafter “contract”) unless expressly stated otherwise in this contract. This includes all rights to source code and all documentation created in support thereof. The primary clause used to define Government and Contractor data rights is FAR 52.227-14 Rights in Data – General.
- Information made available to the Contractor by VA for the performance or administration of this contract shall be used only for the purposes specified in the service agreement, SOW, PWS, PD, and/or contract. The Contractor shall not use VA information in any other manner without prior written approval from a VA CO. The primary clause used to define Government and Contractor data rights is FAR 52.227-14 Rights in Data – General.
- VA information shall not be co-mingled with any other data on the Contractor’s information systems or media storage systems. The Contractor shall ensure compliance with Federal and VA requirements related to data protection, data encryption, physical data segregation, logical data segregation, classification requirements and media sanitization.
- VA reserves the right to conduct scheduled or unscheduled audits, assessments, or investigations of Contractor Information Technology (IT) resources to ensure information security is compliant with Federal and VA requirements. The Contractor shall provide all necessary access to records (including electronic and documentary materials related to the contracts and subcontracts) and support (including access to Contractor and Subcontractor staff associated with the contract) to VA, VA's Office Inspector General (OIG), and/or GAO staff during periodic control assessments, audits, or investigations.
- The Contractor may only use VA information within the terms of the contract and applicable Federal law, regulations, and VA policies. If new Federal information security

laws, regulations or VA policies become applicable after execution of the contract, the parties agree to negotiate contract modification and adjustment necessary to implement the new laws, regulations, and/or policies.

- The Contractor shall not make copies of VA information except as specifically authorized and necessary to perform the terms of the contract. If copies are made for restoration purposes, after the restoration is complete, the copies shall be destroyed in accordance with VA Directive 6500, VA Cybersecurity Program and VA Information Security Knowledge Service.
- If a Veterans Health Administration (VHA) contract is terminated for default or cause with a business associate, the related local Business Associate Agreement (BAA) shall also be terminated and actions taken in accordance with VHA Directive 1605.05, Business Associate Agreements. If there is an executed national BAA associated with the contract, VA shall determine what actions are appropriate and notify the contractor.
- The Contractor shall store and transmit VA sensitive information in an encrypted form, using VA-approved encryption tools which are, at a minimum, Federal Information Processing Standards (FIPS) 140-2, Security Requirements for Cryptographic Modules (or its successor) validated and in conformance with VA Information Security Knowledge Service requirements. The Contractor shall transmit VA sensitive information using VA approved Transport Layer Security (TLS) configured with FIPS based cipher suites in conformance with National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-52, Guidelines for the Selection, Configuration and Use of Transport Layer Security (TLS) Implementations.
- The Contractor's firewall and web services security controls, as applicable, shall meet or exceed VA's minimum requirements.
- Except for uses and disclosures of VA information authorized by this contract for performance of the contract, the Contractor may use and disclose VA information only in two situations: (i) in response to a qualifying order of a court of competent jurisdiction after notification to VA CO (ii) with written approval from the VA CO. The Contractor shall refer all requests for, demands for production of or inquiries about, VA information and information systems to the VA CO for response.
- Notwithstanding the provision above, the Contractor shall not release VA records protected by Title 38 U.S.C. § 5705, Confidentiality of medical quality-assurance records and/or Title 38 U.S.C. § 7332, Confidentiality of certain medical records pertaining to drug addiction, sickle cell anemia, alcoholism or alcohol abuse or infection with Human Immunodeficiency Virus (HIV). If the Contractor is in receipt of a court order or other requests for the above-mentioned information, the Contractor shall immediately refer such court order or other requests to the VA CO for response.
- Information made available to the Contractor by VA for the performance or administration of this contract or information developed by the Contractor in performance or administration of the contract shall be protected and secured in

accordance with VA Directive 6500 and Identity and Access Management (IAM) Security processes specified in the VA Information Security Knowledge Service.

- Any data destruction done on behalf of VA by a Contractor shall be done in accordance with National Archives and Records Administration (NARA) requirements as outlined in VA Directive 6300, Records and Information Management, VA Handbook 6300.1, Records Management Procedures, and applicable VA Records Control Schedules.
- The Contractor shall provide its plan for destruction of all VA data in its possession according to VA Directive 6500 and NIST 800-88, Guidelines for Media Sanitization prior to termination or completion of this contract. If directed by the COR/CO, the Contractor shall return all Federal Records to VA for disposition.
- Any media, such as paper, magnetic tape, magnetic disks, solid state devices or optical discs that are used to store, process, or access VA information that cannot be destroyed shall be returned to VA. The Contractor shall hold the appropriate material until otherwise directed by the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) or CO. Items shall be returned securely via VA-approved methods. VA sensitive information must be transmitted utilizing VA-approved encryption tools which are validated under FIPS 140-2 (or its successor) and NIST 800-52. If mailed, the Contractor shall send via a trackable method (USPS, UPS, FedEx, etc.) and immediately provide the COR/CO with the tracking information. Self-certification by the Contractor that the data destruction requirements above have been met shall be sent to the COR/CO within 30 business days of termination of the contract.
- All electronic storage media (hard drives, optical disks, CDs, back-up tapes, etc.) used to store, process or access VA information shall not be returned to the Contractor at the end of lease, loan, or trade-in. Exceptions to this paragraph shall only be granted with the written approval of VA CO.

B.3 ACCESS TO VA INFORMATION AND VA INFORMATION SYSTEMS

- A Contractor/Subcontractor shall request logical (technical) or physical access to VA information and VA information systems for their employees and subcontractors only to the extent necessary to perform the services specified in the solicitation or contract. This includes indirect entities, both affiliate of Contractor/Subcontractor and agent of Contractor/Subcontractor.
- Contractors and subcontractors shall sign the VA Information Security Rule of Behavior (ROB) before access is provided to VA information and information systems (see Section 4, Training, below). The ROB contains the minimum user compliance requirements and does not supersede any policies of VA facilities or other agency components which provide higher levels of protection to VA's information or information systems. Users who require privileged access shall complete the VA elevated privilege access request processes before privileged access is granted.
- All Contractors and Subcontractors working with VA information are subject to the same security investigative and clearance requirements as those of VA appointees or

employees who have access to the same types of information. The level and process of background security investigations for contractors shall be in accordance with VA Directive and Handbook 0710, Personnel Vetting Program. The Office of Human Resources and Administration/Operations, Security and Preparedness (HRA/OSP) is responsible for these policies and procedures. Contract personnel who require access to classified information or information systems shall have an appropriate security clearance. Verification of a Security Clearance shall be processed through the Special Security Officer located in HRA/OSP. Contractors shall conform to all requirements stated in the National Industrial Security Program Operating Manual (NISPOM).

- All Contractors and subcontractors shall comply with conditions specified in VAAR 852.204-71(d); Contractor operations required to be in United States. All Contractors and Subcontractors working with VA information must be permanently located within a jurisdiction subject to the law of the United States or its Territories to the maximum extent feasible. If services are proposed to be performed abroad the Contractor must state where all non-U.S. services are provided. The Contractor shall deliver to VA a detailed plan specifically addressing communications, personnel control, data protection and potential legal issues. The plan shall be approved by the COR/CO in writing prior to access being granted.
- The Contractor shall notify the COR/CO in writing immediately (no later than 24 hours) after personnel separation or occurrence of other causes. Causes may include the following:
 - (1) Contractor/Subcontractor personnel no longer has a need for access to VA information or VA information systems.
 - (2) Contractor/Subcontractor personnel are terminated, suspended, or otherwise has their work on a VA project discontinued for any reason.
 - (3) Contractor believes their own personnel or Subcontractor personnel may pose a threat to their company's working environment or to any company-owned property. This includes Contractor-owned assets, buildings, confidential data, customers, employees, networks, systems, trade secrets and/or VA data.
 - (4) Any previously undisclosed changes to Contractor/Subcontractor background history are brought to light, including but not limited to changes to background investigation or employee record.
 - (5) Contractor/Subcontractor personnel have their authorization to work in the United States revoked.
 - (6) Agreement by which Contractor provides products and services to VA has either been fulfilled or terminated, such that VA can cut off electronic and/or physical access for Contractor personnel.
- In such cases of contract fulfillment, termination, or other causes; the Contractor shall take the necessary measures to immediately revoke access to VA network, property, information, and information systems (logical and physical) by Contractor/Subcontractor personnel. These measures include (but are not limited to): removing and then securing

Personal Identity Verification (PIV) badges and PIV – Interoperable (PIV-I) access badges, VA-issued photo badges, credentials for VA facilities and devices, VA-issued laptops, and authentication tokens. Contractors shall notify the appropriate VA COR/CO immediately to initiate access removal.

- Contractors/Subcontractors who no longer require VA accesses shall return VA-issued property to VA. This property includes (but is not limited to): documents, electronic equipment, keys, and parking passes. PIV and PIV-I access badges shall be returned to the nearest VA PIV Badge Issuance Office. Once they have had access to VA information, information systems, networks and VA property in their possessions removed, Contractors shall notify the appropriate VA COR/CO.

B.4 TRAINING

- All contractors and subcontractors requiring access to VA information and VA information systems shall successfully complete the following before being granted access to VA information and its systems:
 - (1) VA Privacy and Information Security Awareness and Rules of Behavior course (Talent Management System (TMS) #10176) initially and annually thereafter.
 - (2) Sign and acknowledge (electronically through TMS #10176) understanding of and responsibilities for compliance with the Organizational Rules of Behavior, relating to access to VA information and information systems initially and annually thereafter; and
 - (3) Successfully complete any additional cyber security or privacy training, as required for VA personnel with equivalent information system or information access [to be defined by the VA program official and provided to the VA CO for inclusion in the solicitation document – i.e., any role-based information security training].
- The Contractor shall provide to the COR/CO a copy of the training certificates and certification of signing the Organizational Rules of Behavior for each applicable employee within five (5) days of the initiation of the contract and annually thereafter, as required.
- Failure to complete the mandatory annual training is grounds for suspension or termination of all physical or electronic access privileges and removal from work on the contract until such time as the required training is complete.

B.5 SECURITY INCIDENT INVESTIGATION

- The Contractor, Subcontractor, their employees, or business associates shall immediately (within one hour) report suspected security / privacy incidents to the VA OIT's Enterprise Service Desk (ESD) by calling (855) 673-4357 (TTY: 711). The ESD is OIT's 24/7/365 single point of contact for IT-related issues. After reporting to the ESD, the Contractor, Subcontractor, their employees, or business associates shall, within one hour, provide the COR/CO the incident number received from the ESD.

- To the extent known by the Contractor/Subcontractor, the Contractor/Subcontractor's notice to VA shall identify the information involved and the circumstances surrounding the incident, including the following:
 - (1) The date and time (or approximation of) the Security Incident occurred.
 - (2) The names of individuals involved (when applicable).
 - (3) The physical and logical (if applicable) location of the incident.
 - (4) Why the Security Incident took place (i.e., catalyst for the failure).
 - (5) The amount of data belonging to VA believed to have been compromised.
 - (6) The remediation measures the Contractor is taking to ensure no future incidents of a similar nature.
- After the Contractor has provided the initial detailed incident summary to VA, they shall continue to provide written updates on any new and relevant circumstances or facts they discover. The Contractor, Subcontractor, and their employees shall fully cooperate with VA or third-party entity performing an independent risk analysis on behalf of VA. Failure to cooperate may be deemed a material breach and grounds for contract termination.
- VA IT Contractors shall follow VA Handbook 6500, Risk Management Framework for VA Information Systems VA Information Security Program, and VA Information Security Knowledge Service guidance for implementing an Incident Response Plan or integrating with an existing VA implementation.
- In instances of theft or break-in or other criminal activity, the Contractor/Subcontractor must concurrently report the incident to the appropriate law enforcement entity (or entities) of jurisdiction, including the VA OIG, and the VA Office of Security and Law Enforcement. The Contractor, its employees, and its Subcontractors and their employees shall cooperate with VA and any law enforcement authority responsible for the investigation and prosecution of any possible criminal law violation(s) associated with any incident. The Contractor/Subcontractor shall cooperate with VA in any civil litigation to recover VA information, obtain monetary or other compensation from a third party for damages arising from any incident, or obtain injunctive relief against any third party arising from, or related to, the incident.
- The Contractor shall comply with VA Handbook 6500.2, Management of Breaches Involving Sensitive Personal Information, which establishes the breach management policies and assigns responsibilities for the oversight, management and reporting procedures associated with managing of breaches.
- With respect to unsecured Protected Health Information (PHI), the Contractor is deemed to have discovered a data breach when the Contractor knew or should have known of breach of such information. When a business associate is part of VHA contract,

notification to the covered entity (VHA) shall be made in accordance with the executed BAA.

- If the Contractor or any of its agents fails to protect VA sensitive personal information or otherwise engages in conduct which results in a data breach involving any VA sensitive personal information the Contractor/Subcontractor processes or maintains under the contract; the Contractor shall pay liquidated damages to the VA as set forth in clause [852.211-76, Liquidated Damages—Reimbursement for Data Breach Costs](#).

B.6 INFORMATION SYSTEM DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT

- Information systems designed or developed on behalf of VA at non-VA facilities shall comply with all applicable Federal law, regulations, and VA policies. This includes standards for the protection of electronic Protected Health Information (PHI), outlined in 45 C.F.R. Part 164, Subpart C and information and system security categorization level designations in accordance with FIPS 199, Standards for Security Categorization of Federal Information and Information Systems and FIPS 200, Minimum Security Requirements for Federal Information Systems. Baseline security controls shall be implemented commensurate with the FIPS 199 system security categorization (reference VA Handbook 6500 and VA Trusted Internet Connections (TIC) Architecture).
- Contracted new developments require creation, testing, evaluation, and authorization in compliance with VA Assessment and Authorization (A&A) processes in VA Handbook 6500 and VA Information Security Knowledge Service to obtain an Authority to Operate (ATO). VA Directive 6517, Risk Management Framework for Cloud Computing Services, provides the security and privacy requirements for cloud environments.
- VA IT Contractors, Subcontractors and third-party service providers shall address and/or integrate applicable VA Handbook 6500, VA Handbook 6517, Risk Management Framework for Cloud Computing Services and Information Security Knowledge Service specifications in delivered IT systems/solutions, products and/or services. If systems/solutions, products and/or services do not directly match VA security requirements, the Contractor shall work through the COR/CO to identify the VA organization responsible for governance or resolution. Contractors shall comply with FAR 39.1, specifically the prohibitions referenced.
- The Contractor (including producers and resellers) shall comply with Office of Management and Budget (OMB) M-26-05 when using third-party software on VA information systems or otherwise affecting the VA information. This includes new software purchases and software renewals for software developed or modified by major version change. The term “software” includes firmware, operating systems, applications and application services (e.g., cloud-based software), as well as products containing software. The Contractor shall provide a self-attestation that secure software development practices are utilized as outlined by Executive Order (EO) 14028 and NIST Guidance. Cloud solutions must meet VA security requirements through NIST SP 800-53 Rev 5, VA Directive 6500, and VA Handbook 6500.6.
- The Contractor shall ensure all delivered applications, systems and information systems are compliant with Homeland Security Presidential Directive (HSPD) 12 and VA Identity

and Access management (IAM) enterprise identity management requirements as set forth in OMB M-19-17, M-05-24, FIPS 201-3, Personal Identity Verification (PIV) of Federal Employees and Contractors (or its successor), M-21-31 and supporting NIST guidance. This applies to Commercial Off-The-Shelf (COTS) product(s) that the Contractor did not develop, all software configurations and all customizations.

- The Contractor shall ensure all Contractor delivered applications and systems provide user authentication services compliant with VA Handbook 6500, VA Information Security Knowledge Service, IAM enterprise requirements and NIST 800-63, Digital Identity Guidelines, for direct, assertion-based authentication and/or trust-based authentication, as determined by the design and integration patterns. Direct authentication at a minimum must include Public Key Infrastructure (PKI) based authentication supportive of PIV and/or Common Access Card (CAC), as determined by the business need and compliance with VA Information Security Knowledge Service specifications.
- The Contractor shall use VA authorized technical security baseline configurations and certify to the COR that applications are fully functional and operate correctly as intended on systems in compliance with VA baselines prior to acceptance or connection into an authorized VA computing environment. If the Defense Information Systems Agency (DISA) has created a Security Technical Implementation Guide (STIG) for the technology, the Contractor may configure to comply with that STIG. If VA determines a new or updated VA configuration baseline needs to be created, the Contractor shall provide required technical support to develop the configuration settings. FAR 39.1 requires the population of operating systems and applications includes all listed on the NIST National Checklist Program Checklist Repository,
- The standard installation, operation, maintenance, updating and patching of software shall not alter the configuration settings from VA approved baseline configuration. Software developed for VA must be compatible with VA enterprise installer services and install to the default “program files” directory with silently install and uninstall. The Contractor shall perform testing of all updates and patching prior to implementation on VA systems.
- Applications designed for normal end users shall run in the standard user context without elevated system administration privileges.
- The Contractor-delivered solutions shall reside on VA approved operating systems. Exceptions to this shall only be granted with the written approval of the COR/CO.
- The Contractor shall design, develop, and implement security and privacy controls in accordance with the provisions of VA security system development life cycle outlined in NIST 800-37, Risk Management Framework for Information Systems and Organizations: A System Life Cycle Approach for Security and Privacy, VA Directive and Handbook 6500, and VA Handbook 6517.
- The Contractor shall comply with the Privacy Act of 1974 (the Act), FAR 52.224-2 Privacy Act, and VA rules and regulations issued under the Act in the design,

development, or operation of any system of records on individuals to accomplish a VA function.

- The Contractor shall ensure the security of all procured or developed information systems, systems, major applications, minor applications, enclaves and platform information technologies, including their subcomponents (hereinafter referred to as “Information Systems”) throughout the life of this contract and any extension, warranty, or maintenance periods. This includes security configurations, workarounds, patches, hotfixes, upgrades, replacements and any physical components which may be necessary to remediate all security vulnerabilities published or known to the Contractor anywhere in the information systems (including systems, operating systems, products, hardware, software, applications and firmware). The Contractor shall ensure security fixes do not negatively impact the Information Systems.
- When the Contractor is responsible for operations or maintenance of the systems, the Contractor shall apply the security fixes within the timeframe specified by the associated controls on the VA Information Security Knowledge Service. When security fixes involve installing third party patches (such as Microsoft OS patches or Adobe Acrobat), the Contractor shall provide written notice to the VA COR/CO that the patch has been validated as to not affecting the Systems within 10 business days.

B.7 INFORMATION SYSTEM HOSTING, OPERATION, MAINTENANCE OR USE

- The Contractor shall comply with all Federal laws, regulations, and VA policies for Information systems (cloud and non-cloud) that are hosted, operated, maintained, or used on behalf of VA at non-VA facilities. Security controls for collecting, processing, transmitting, and storing of VA sensitive information, must be in place. The controls shall be tested by VA or a VA sanctioned 3PAO and approved by VA prior to hosting, operation, maintenance or use of the information system or systems by or on behalf of VA. This includes conducting compliance risk assessments, security architecture analysis, routine vulnerability scanning, system patching, change management procedures and the completion of an acceptable contingency plan for each system. The Contractor’s security control procedures shall be the same as procedures used to secure VA-operated information systems.
- Outsourcing (Contractor facility, equipment, or staff) of systems or network operations, telecommunications services or other managed services require Assessment and Authorization (A&A) of the Contractor’s systems in accordance with VA Handbook 6500 as specified in VA Information Security Knowledge Service. Major changes to the A&A package may require reviewing and updating all the documentation associated with the change. The Contractor’s cloud computing systems shall comply with NIST SP 800-53 Rev 5, VA Directive 6500, VA Handbook 6500.6 and VA Directive 6517 requirements.
- The Contractor shall return all electronic storage media (hard drives, optical disks, CDs, back-up tapes, etc.) on non-VA leased or non-VA owned IT equipment used to store, process or access VA information to VA in accordance with A&A package requirements. This applies when the contract is terminated or completed and prior to disposal of media. The Contractor shall provide its plan for destruction of all VA data in its possession according to VA Information Security Knowledge Service requirements and NIST 800-

88. The Contractor shall send a self-certification that the data destruction requirements above have been met to the COR/CO within 30 business days of termination of the contract.

- All external internet connections to VA network involving VA information must be in accordance with VA Trusted Internet Connection (TIC) Reference Architecture and VA Directive and Handbook 6513, Secure External Connections and reviewed and approved by VA prior to implementation. Government-owned Contractor-operated systems, third party or business partner networks require a Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) and Interconnection Security Agreements (ISA).
- Contractor procedures shall be subject to periodic, announced, or unannounced assessments by VA officials, the OIG or a 3PAO. The physical security aspects associated with Contractor activities are also subject to such assessments. The Contractor shall report, in writing, any deficiencies noted during the above assessment to the VA COR/CO. The Contractor shall use VA's defined processes to document planned remedial actions that address identified deficiencies in information security policies, procedures, and practices. The Contractor shall correct security deficiencies within the timeframes specified in the VA Information Security Knowledge Service.
- All major information system changes which occur in the production environment shall be reviewed by the VA to determine the impact on privacy and security of the system. Based on the review results, updates to the ATO documentation and parameters may be required to remain in compliance with VA Handbook 6500 and VA Information Security Knowledge Service requirements.
- The Contractor shall conduct an annual privacy and security self-assessment on all information systems and outsourced services as required. Copies of the assessment shall be provided to the COR/CO. The VA/Government reserves the right to conduct assessment using government personnel or a third party if deemed necessary. The Contractor shall correct or mitigate any weaknesses discovered during the assessment.
- VA prohibits the installation and use of personally owned or Contractor-owned equipment or software on VA information systems. If non-VA owned equipment must be used to fulfill the requirements of a contract, it must be stated in the service agreement, SOW, PWS, PD or contract. All security controls required for government furnished equipment must be utilized in VA approved Other Equipment (OE). Configuration changes to the Contractor OE, must be funded by the owner of the equipment. All remote systems must use a VA-approved antivirus software and a personal (host-based or enclave based) firewall with a VA-approved configuration. The Contractor shall ensure software on OE is kept current with all critical updates and patches. Owners of approved OE are responsible for providing and maintaining the anti-virus software and the firewall on the non-VA owned OE. Approved Contractor OE shall be subject to technical inspection at any time.
- The Contractor shall notify the COR/CO within one hour of disclosure or successful exploits of any vulnerability which can compromise the confidentiality, integrity, or availability of the information systems. The system or effected component(s) need(s) to be isolated from the network. A forensic analysis needs to be conducted jointly with VA.

Such issues shall be remediated as quickly as practicable, but in no event longer than the timeframe specified by VA Information Security Knowledge Service. If sensitive personal information is compromised reference VA Handbook 6500.2 and Section 5, Security Incident Investigation.

- For cases wherein the Contractor discovers material defects or vulnerabilities impacting products and services they provide to VA, the Contractor shall develop and implement policies and procedures for disclosure to VA, as well as remediation. The Contractor shall, within 30 business days of discovery, document a summary of these vulnerabilities or defects. The documentation shall include a description of the potential impact of each vulnerability and material defect, compensating security controls, mitigations, recommended corrective actions, root cause analysis and/or workarounds (i.e., monitoring). Should there exist any backdoors in the products or services they provide to VA (referring to methods for bypassing computer authentication), the Contractor shall provide the VA CO/CO written assurance they have permanently remediated these backdoors.
- All other vulnerabilities, including those discovered through routine scans or other assessments, shall be remediated based on risk, in accordance with the remediation timelines specified by the VA Information Security Knowledge Service and/or the applicable timeframe mandated by Cybersecurity & Infrastructure Security Agency (CISA) Binding Operational Directive (BOD) 22-01 and BOD 19-02 for Internet-accessible systems. Exceptions to this paragraph shall only be granted with the approval of the COR/CO.

B.8 SECURITY AND PRIVACY CONTROLS COMPLIANCE TESTING, ASSESSMENT AND AUDITING

- Should VA request it, the Contractor shall provide a copy of their (corporation's, sole proprietorship's, partnership's, limited liability company (LLC), or other business structure entity's) policies, procedures, evidence and independent report summaries related to specified cybersecurity frameworks (International Organization for Standardization (ISO), NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), etc.). VA or its third-party/partner designee (if applicable) are further entitled to perform their own audits and security/penetration tests of the Contractor's IT or systems and controls, to ascertain whether the Contractor is complying with the information security, network or system requirements mandated in the agreement between VA and the Contractor.
- Any audits or tests of the Contractor or third-party designees/partner VA elects to carry out shall commence within 30 business days of VA notification. Such audits, tests and assessments may include the following: (a): security/penetration tests which both sides agree shall not unduly impact Contractor operations; (b): interviews with pertinent stakeholders and practitioners; (c): document review; and (d): technical inspections of networks and systems the Contractor uses to destroy, maintain, receive, retain, or use VA information.
- As part of these audits, tests and assessments, the Contractor shall provide all information requested by VA. This information includes, but is not limited to, the following:

equipment lists, network or infrastructure diagrams, relevant policy documents, system logs or details on information systems accessing, transporting, or processing VA data.

- The Contractor and at its own expense, shall comply with any recommendations resulting from VA audits, inspections and tests. VA further retains the right to view any related security reports the Contractor has generated as part of its own security assessment. The Contractor shall also notify VA of the existence of any such security reports or other related assessments, upon completion and validation.
- VA appointed auditors or other government agency partners may be granted access to such documentation on a need-to-know basis and coordinated through the COR/CO. The Contractor shall comply with recommendations which result from these regulatory assessments on the part of VA regulators and associated government agency partners.

B.9 PRODUCT INTEGRITY, AUTHENTICITY, PROVENANCE, ANTI-COUNTERFEIT AND ANTI-TAMPERING

- The Contractor shall comply with Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) Title 15 Part 7, “Securing the Information and Communications Technology and Services (ICTS) Supply Chain”, which prohibits ICTS Transactions from foreign adversaries. ICTS Transactions are defined as any acquisition, importation, transfer, installation, dealing in or use of any information and communications technology or service, including ongoing activities, such as managed services, data transmission, software updates, repairs or the platforming or data hosting of applications for consumer download.
- When contracting terms require the Contractor to procure equipment, the Contractor shall purchase or acquire the equipment from an Original Equipment Manufacturer (OEM) or an authorized reseller of the OEM. The Contractor shall attest that equipment procured from an OEM or authorized reseller or distributor is authentic. If procurement is unavailable from an OEM or authorized reseller, the Contractor shall submit in writing, details of the circumstances prohibiting this from happening and procure a product waiver from the VA COR/CO.
- All Contractors shall establish, implement, and provide documentation for risk management practices for supply chain delivery of hardware, software (to include patches) and firmware provided under this agreement. Documentation shall include chain of custody practices, inventory management program, information protection practices, integrity management program for sub-supplier provided components, and replacement parts requests. The Contractor shall make spare parts available. All Contractor(s) shall specify how digital delivery for procured products, including patches, shall be validated and monitored to ensure consistent delivery. The Contractor shall apply encryption technology to protect procured products throughout the delivery process.
- If a Contractor provides software or patches to VA, the Contractor shall publish or provide a hash conforming to the FIPS Security Requirements for Cryptographic Modules (FIPS 140-2 or successor).

- The Contractor shall provide a software bill of materials (SBOM) for procured (to include licensed products) and consist of a list of components and associated metadata which make up the product. SBOMs must be generated in one of the data formats defined in the National Telecommunications and Information Administration (NTIA) report “The Minimum Elements for a Software Bill of Materials (SBOM).”
- Contractors shall use or arrange for the use of trusted channels to ship procured products, such as U.S. registered mail and/or tamper-evident packaging for physical deliveries.
- Throughout the delivery process, the Contractor shall demonstrate a capability for detecting unauthorized access (tampering).
- The Contractor shall demonstrate chain-of-custody documentation for procured products and require tamper-evident packaging for the delivery of this hardware.

B.10 VIRUSES, FIRMWARE, AND MALWARE

- The Contractor shall execute due diligence to ensure all provided software and patches, including third-party patches, are free of viruses and/or malware before releasing them to or installing them on VA information systems.
- The Contractor warrants it has no knowledge of and did not insert, any malicious virus and/or malware code into any software or patches provided to VA which could potentially harm or disrupt VA information systems. The Contractor shall use due diligence, if supplying third-party software or patches, to ensure the third-party has not inserted any malicious code and/or virus which could damage or disrupt VA information systems.
- The Contractor shall provide or arrange for the provision of technical justification as to why any “false positive” hit has taken place to ensure their code’s supply chain has not been compromised. Justification may be required, but is not limited to, when install files, scripts, firmware, or other Contractor-delivered software solutions (including third-party install files, scripts, firmware, or other software) are flagged as malicious, infected, or suspicious by an anti-virus vendor.
- The Contractor shall not upload (intentionally or negligently) any virus, worm, malware or any harmful or malicious content, component and/or corrupted data/source code (hereinafter “virus or other malware”) onto VA computer and information systems and/or networks. If introduced (and this clause is violated), upon written request from the VA CO, the Contractor shall:
 - (1) Take all necessary action to correct the incident, to include any and all assistance to VA to eliminate the virus or other malware throughout VA’s information networks, computer systems and information systems; and
 - (2) Use commercially reasonable efforts to restore operational efficiency and remediate damages due to data loss or data integrity damage, if the virus or other malware causes a loss of operational efficiency, data loss, or damage to data integrity.

B.11 CRYPTOGRAPHIC REQUIREMENT

- The Contractor shall document how the cryptographic system supporting the Contractor's products and/or services protect the confidentiality, data integrity, authentication and non-repudiation of devices and data flows in the underlying system.
- The Contractor shall use only approved cryptographic methods as defined in FIPS 140-2 (or its successor) and NIST 800-52 standards when enabling encryption on its products.
- The Contractor shall provide or arrange for the provision of an automated remote key-establishment method which protects the confidentiality and integrity of the cryptographic keys.
- The Contractor shall ensure emergency re-keying of all devices can be remotely performed within 30 business days.
- The Contractor shall provide or arrange for the provision of a method for updating cryptographic primitives or algorithms.

B.12 PATCHING GOVERNANCE

- The Contractor shall provide documentation detailing the patch management, vulnerability management, mitigation and update processes (to include third-party) prior to the connection of electronic devices, assets or equipment to VA's assets. This documentation shall include information regarding the following:
 - (1) The resources and technical capabilities to sustain the program or process (e.g., how the integrity of a patch is validated by VA); and.
 - (2) The approach and capability to remediate newly reported zero-day vulnerabilities for Contractor products.
- The Contractor shall verify and provide documentation all procured products (including third-party applications, hardware, software, operating systems, and firmware) have appropriate updates and patches installed prior to delivery to VA.
- The Contractor shall provide or arrange the provision of appropriate software and firmware updates to remediate newly discovered vulnerabilities or weaknesses for their products and services within 30 days of discovery. Updates to remediate critical or emergent vulnerabilities shall be provided within seven business days of discovery. If updates cannot be made available by Contractor within these time periods, the Contractor shall submit mitigations, methods of exploit detection and/or workarounds to the COR/CO prior to the above deadlines.
- The Contractor shall provide or arrange for the provision of appropriate hardware, software and/or firmware updates, when those products, including open-source software, are provided to the VA, to remediate newly discovered vulnerabilities or weaknesses.

Remediations of products or services provided to the VA's system environment must be provided within 30 business days of availability from the original supplier and/or patching source. Updates to remediate critical vulnerabilities applicable to the Contractor's use of the third-party product in its system environment shall be provided within seven business days of availability from the original supplier and/or patching source. If applicable third-party updates cannot be integrated, tested and made available by Contractor within these time periods, mitigations and/or workarounds shall be provided to the COR/CO before the above deadlines.

B.13 SPECIALIZED DEVICES/SYSTEMS (MEDICAL DEVICES, SPECIAL PURPOSE SYSTEMS, RESEARCH SCIENTIFIC COMPUTING)

- Contractor supplies/delivered Medical Devices, Special Purpose Systems-Operational Technology (SPS-OT) and Research Scientific Computing Devices shall comply with all applicable Federal law, regulations, and VA policies. New developments require creation, testing, evaluation, and authorization in compliance with processes specified on the Specialized Device Cybersecurity Department Enterprise Risk Management (SDCD-ERM) Portal, VA Directive 6550, Pre-Procurement Assessment and Implementation of Medical Devices/Systems, VA Handbook 6500, and the VA Information Security Knowledge Service. Deviations from Federal law, regulations, and VA Policy are identified and documented as part of VA Directive 6550 and/or the VA Enterprise Risk Analysis (ERA) processes for Specialized Devices/Systems processes.
- All Contractors and third-party service providers shall address and/or integrate applicable VA Handbook 6500 and Information Security Knowledge Service specifications in delivered IT systems/solutions, products and/or services. If systems/solutions, products and/or services do not directly match VA security requirements, the Contractor shall work through the COR/CO for governance or resolution.
- The Contractor shall certify to the COR/CO that devices/systems that have completed the VA Enterprise Risk Analysis (ERA) process for Specialized Devices/Systems are fully functional and operate correctly as intended. Devices/systems must follow the VA ERA authorized configuration prior to acquisition and connection to the VA computing environment. If VA determines a new VA ERA needs to be created, the Contractor shall provide required technical support to develop the configuration settings. Major changes to a previously approved device/system shall require a new ERA.
- The Contractor shall comply with all practices documented by the Food Drug and Administration (FDA) Premarket Submission for Management of Cybersecurity in Medical Devices and Postmarket Management of Cybersecurity in Medical Devices.
- The Contractor shall design devices capable of accepting all applicable security patches with or without the support of the Contractor personnel. If patching can only be completed by the Contractor, the Contractor shall commit the resources needed to patch all applicable devices at all VA locations. If unique patching instructions or packaging is needed, the Contractor shall provide the necessary information in conjunction with the validation/testing of the patch. The Contractor shall apply security patches within 30 business days of the patch release and have a formal tracking process for any security patches not implemented to include explanation when a device cannot be patched.

- The Contractor shall provide devices able to install and maintain VA-approved antivirus capabilities with the capability to quarantine files and be updated as needed in response to incidents. Alternatively, a VA-approved whitelisting application may be used when the Contractor cannot install an anti-virus / anti-malware application.
- The Contractor shall verify and document all software embedded within the device does not contain any known viruses or malware before delivery to or installation at a VA location.
- Devices and other equipment or systems containing media (hard drives, optical disks, solid state, and storage via chips/firmware) with VA sensitive information shall be returned to the Contractor with media removed. When the contract requires return of equipment, the options available to the Contractor are the following:
 - (1) The Contractor shall accept the system without the drive, firmware and solid state.
 - (2) VA's initial device purchase includes a spare drive or other replacement media which must be installed in place of the original drive at time of turn-in; or
 - (3) Due to the highly specialized and sometimes proprietary hardware and software associated with the device, if it is not possible for VA to retain the hard drive, firmware, and solid state, then:
 - (a) The equipment Contractor shall have an existing BAA if the device being traded in has sensitive information stored on it and hard drive(s) from the system are being returned physically intact.
 - (b) Any fixed hard drive, Complementary Metal-Oxide-Semiconductor (CMOS), Programmable Read-Only Memory (PROM), solid state and firmware on the device must be non-destructively sanitized to the greatest extent possible without negatively impacting system operation. Selective clearing down to patient data folder level is recommended using VA approved and validated overwriting technologies/methods/tools. Applicable media sanitization specifications need to be pre-approved and described in the solicitation, contract, or order.

B.14 DATA CENTER PROVISIONS

- The Contractor shall ensure the VA network is accessed in accordance with VA Directive 6500 and IAM security processes specified in the VA Information Security Knowledge Service.
- The Contractor shall ensure network infrastructure and data availability in accordance with VA information system business continuity procedures specified in the VA Information Security Knowledge Service.
- The Contractor shall ensure any connections to the internet or other external networks for information systems occur through managed interfaces utilizing VA approved boundary

protection devices (e.g., internet proxies, gateways, routers, firewalls, guards or encrypted tunnels).

- The Contractor shall encrypt all traffic across the segment of the Wide Area Network (WAN) it manages and no unencrypted Out of Band (OOB) Internet Protocol (IP) traffic shall traverse the network.
- The Contractor shall ensure tunnel endpoints are routable addresses at each VA operating site.
- The Contractor shall secure access from Local Area Networks (LANs) at co-located sites in accordance with VA TIC Reference Architecture, VA Directive and Handbook 6513, and MOU/ISA process specified in the VA Information Security Knowledge Service.

SECTION C - CONTRACT CLAUSES

C.1 FEDERAL SUPPLY SCHEDULE (FSS) REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) INTRODUCTORY LANGUAGE

The terms and conditions of the contractor's FSS contract (including any contract modifications) apply to all Blanket Purchase Agreements (BPA) and task or delivery orders issued under the contract as a result of this RFP. When a lower price has been established, or when the delivery terms, FOB terms, or ordering requirements have been modified by the BPA or task/delivery order, those modified terms will apply to all purchases made pursuant to it and take precedence over the FSS contract. Any unique terms and conditions of a BPA or order issued under the contract that are not a part of the applicable FSS contract will govern. In the event of an inconsistency between the terms and conditions of a BPA or task/delivery order and the Contractor's FSS terms, other than those identified above, the terms of the FSS contract will take precedence.

All clauses and provisions from the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) and General Services Administration Regulation (GSAR) from the applicable FSC Group of the Multiple Award Schedule and Federal Supply Schedule Program, and the specific GSA Schedule contract referenced on the SF1449 in Block 2, are hereby incorporated by reference.

The full text of any FAR and GSA clauses which are incorporated by reference may be obtained at the following URLs:

FAR: <https://www.acquisition.gov/far-overhaul>

GSA: <http://www.acquisition.gov/GSAM/gsam.html>

C.2 52.252-2 CLAUSES INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE (FEB 1998)

This contract incorporates one or more clauses by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. Also, the full text of a clause may be accessed electronically at this/these address(es):

<https://www.acquisition.gov/far-overhaul>

<https://www.va.gov/oal/library/vaar/>

(End of Clause)

<u>FAR Number</u>	<u>Title</u>	<u>Date</u>
52.203-16	PREVENTING PERSONAL CONFLICTS OF INTEREST	JUN 2020
52.203-17	CONTRACTOR EMPLOYEE WHISTLEBLOWER RIGHTS	NOV 2023
52.204-14	SERVICE CONTRACT REPORTING REQUIREMENTS	OCT 2016
52.212-4 (ALT 1)	CONTRACT TERMS AND CONDITIONS-COMMERCIAL ITEMS	OCT 2025 (DEV)
52.227-1	AUTHORIZATION AND CONSENT	JUN 2020
52.227-2	NOTICE AND ASSISTANCE REGARDING PATENT AND COPYRIGHT INFRINGEMENT	JUN 2020
52.227-14	RIGHTS IN DATA GENERAL	MAY 2014
52.227-16	ADDITIONAL DATA REQUIREMENTS	JUN 1987

52.232-23	ASSIGNMENT OF CLAIMS	MAY 2014
52.232-29	TERMS OF FINANCING OF PURCHASES OF COMMERCIAL PRODUCTS AND COMMERCIAL SERVICES	NOV 2021
52.232.33	PAYMENT BY EFT= SYSTEM FOR AWARD MANAGEMENT	OCT 2018
52.232-39	UNENFORCEABILITY OF UNAUTHORIZED OBLIGATIONS	JUN 2013
52.233-3	PROTEST AFTER AWARD	NOV 2025 (DEV)
52.245-1	GOVERNMENT PROPERTY	SEP 2021
852.201-70	CONTRACTING OFFICERS REPRESENTATIVE	DEC 2022
852.203-70	COMMERCIAL ADVERTISING	MAY 2018
852.204-70	PERSONAL IDENTITY VERIFICATION OF CONTRACT PERSONNEL	MAY 2020
852.219-70	VA SMALL BUSINESS SUBCONTRACTING PLAN MINIMUM REQUIREMENTS	JAN 2023 (DEV)
852.222-71	COMPLIANCE WITH EXECUTIVE ORDER 13899	APR 2025
852.232-72	ELECTRONIC SUBMISSION OF PAYMENT REQUESTS	NOV 2018
852.237-75	KEY PERSONNEL	OCT 2019
852.239-70	SECURITY REQUIREMENTS FOR INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY RESOURCES	FEB 2023
852.239-71	INFORMATION SYSTEM SECURITY PLAN AND ACCREDITATION	FEB 2023
852.239-72	INFORMATION SYSTEM DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT	FEB 2023
852.239-74	SECURITY CONTROLS COMPLIANCE TESTING	FEB 2023
852.239-76	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY ACCESSIBILITY	FEB 2023

C.3 52.217-7 OPTION FOR INCREASED QUANTITY—SEPARATELY PRICED LINE ITEM (MAR 1989)

The Government may require the delivery of the numbered line item, CLINs 6001, 7001 and 8001, identified in the Schedule as an option item, in the quantity and at the price stated in the Schedule. The Contracting Officer may exercise the option by written notice to the Contractor. Delivery of added items shall continue at the same rate that like items are called for under the contract, unless the parties otherwise agree.

(End of Clause)

C.4 52.217-8 OPTION TO EXTEND SERVICES (NOV 1999)

The Government may require continued performance of any services within the limits and at the rates specified in the contract. These rates may be adjusted only as a result of revisions to prevailing labor rates provided by the Secretary of Labor. The option provision may be exercised more than once, but the total extension of performance hereunder shall not exceed 6-months. The Contracting Officer may exercise the option by written notice to the Contractor at any time within the lifecycle of the task order.

(End of clause)

C.5 52.217-9 OPTION TO EXTEND THE TERM OF THE CONTRACT (MAR 2000)

(a) The Government may extend the term of this contract by written notice to the Contractor; provided that the Government gives the Contractor a preliminary written notice of its intent to extend before the contract expires. The preliminary notice does not commit the Government to an extension.

(b) If the Government exercises this option, the extended contract shall be considered to include this option clause.

(c) The total duration of this contract, including the exercise of any options under this clause, shall not exceed 60 months.

(End of Clause)

C.6 VAAR 852.204-71 INFORMATION AND INFORMATION SYSTEMS SECURITY (FEB 2023)

(a) *Definitions.* As used in this clause—*Business Associate* means an entity, including an individual (other than a member of the workforce of a covered entity), company, organization or another covered entity, as defined by the Health Insurance Portability and Accountability Act of 1996 (HIPAA) Privacy Rule, that performs or assists in the performance of a function or activity on behalf of the Veterans Health Administration (VHA) that involves the creating, receiving, maintaining, transmitting of, or having access to, protected health information (PHI). The term also includes a subcontractor of a business associate that creates, receives, maintains, or transmits PHI on behalf of the business associate.

Business Associate Agreement (BAA) means the agreement, as dictated by the Privacy Rule, between VHA and a business associate, which must be entered into in addition to the underlying contract for services and before any release of PHI can be made to the business associate, in order for the business associate to perform certain functions or activities on behalf of VHA.

Information system means a discrete set of information resources organized for the collection, processing, maintenance, use, sharing, dissemination, or disposition of information whether automated or manual.

Information technology (see FAR 2.101) also means Information and Communication Technology (ICT).

Information technology-related contracts means those contracts which include services (including support services), and related resources for information technology as defined in 802.101.

Privacy officer means the VA official with responsibility for implementing and oversight of privacy related policies and practices that impact a given VA acquisition.

Sensitive personal information means, with respect to an individual, any information about the individual maintained by VA, including but not limited to the following:

- (1) Education, financial transactions, medical history, and criminal or employment history.
- (2) Information that can be used to distinguish or trace the individual's identity, including but not limited to name, social security number, date and place of birth, mother's maiden name, or biometric records.

Security plan means a formal document that provides an overview of the security requirements for an information system or an information security program and describes the security controls in place or planned for meeting those requirements.

VA Information Security Rules of Behavior for Organizational Users (VA National Rules of Behavior) means a set of VA rules that describes the responsibilities and expected behavior of users of VA information or information systems.

VA sensitive information means all VA data, on any storage media or in any form or format, which requires protection due to the risk of harm that could result from inadvertent or deliberate disclosure, alteration, or destruction of the information and includes sensitive personal information. The term includes information where improper use or disclosure could adversely affect the ability of VA to accomplish its mission, proprietary information, records about individuals requiring protection under various confidentiality provisions such as the Privacy Act and the HIPAA Privacy Rule, and information that can be withheld under the Freedom of Information Act. Examples of VA sensitive information include the following: individually-identifiable medical, benefits, and personnel information; financial, budgetary, research, quality assurance, confidential commercial, critical infrastructure, investigatory, and law enforcement information; information that is confidential and privileged in litigation such as information protected by the deliberative process privilege, attorney work-product privilege, and the attorney-client privilege; and other information which, if released, could result in violation of law or harm or unfairness to any individual or group, or could adversely affect the national interest or the conduct of Federal programs.

(b) *General.* Contractors, subcontractors, their employees, third-parties, and business associates with access to VA information, information systems, or information technology (IT) or providing and accessing IT-related goods and services, shall adhere to VA Directive 6500, VA Cybersecurity Program, and the directives and handbooks in the VA 6500 series related to VA information (including VA sensitive information and sensitive personal information and information systems security and privacy), as well as those set forth in the contract specifications, statement of work, or performance work statement. These include, but are not limited to, VA Handbook 6500.6, Contract Security; and VA Directive and Handbook 0710, *Personnel Security and Suitability Program*, which establishes VA's procedures, responsibilities, and processes for complying with current Federal law, Executive Orders, policies, regulations, standards and guidance for protecting VA information, information systems (*see* 802.101, Definitions) security and privacy, and adhering to personnel security requirements when accessing VA information or information systems.

(c) *Access to VA information and VA information systems.*

(1) Contractors are limited in their request for logical or physical access to VA information or VA information systems for their employees, subcontractors, third parties and business associates to the extent necessary to perform the services or provide the goods as specified in the contracts, agreements, task, delivery or purchase orders.

(2) All Contractors, subcontractors, third parties, and business associates working with VA information are subject to the same investigative requirements as those of VA appointees or employees who have access to the same types of information. The level and process of background security investigations for contractors to access VA information and VA information systems shall be in accordance with VA Directive and Handbook 0710, *Personnel Security and Suitability Program*.

(3) Contractors, subcontractors, third parties, and business associates who require access to national security programs must have a valid security clearance.

(4) HIPAA Business Associate Agreement requirement. Contractors shall enter into a Business Associate Agreement (BAA) with VHA, VA's Covered Entity, when contract requirements and access to protected health information is required and when requested by the Contracting Officer, or the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) (*see* VAAR 824.103–70). Under the HIPAA Privacy and Security Rules, a Covered Entity (VHA) must have a satisfactory assurance that its PHI will be safeguarded from misuse. To do so, a Covered Entity enters into a BAA with a contractor (now the business associate), which obligates the business associate to only use the Covered Entity's PHI for the purposes for which it was engaged,

provide the same protections and safeguards as is required from the Covered Entity, and agree to the same disclosure restrictions to PHI that is required of the Covered Entity in situations where a contractor—

(i) Creates, receives, maintains, or transmits VHA PHI or that will store, generate, access, exchange, process, or utilize such PHI in order to perform certain health care operations activities or functions on behalf of the Covered Entity; or

(ii) Provides one or more of the services specified in the Privacy Rule to or for the Covered Entity.

(A) *Contractors or entities required to execute BAAs for contracts and other agreements become VHA business associates.* BAAs are issued by VHA or may be issued by other VA programs in support of VHA. The HIPAA Privacy Rule requires VHA to execute compliant BAAs with persons or entities that create, receive, maintain, or transmit VHA PHI or that will store, generate, access, exchange, process, or utilize such PHI in order to perform certain activities, functions or services to, for, or on behalf of VHA. There may be other VA components or staff offices which also provide certain services and support to VHA and must receive PHI in order to do so. If these components award contracts or enter into other agreements, purchase/delivery orders, modifications and issue governmentwide purchase card transactions to help in the delivery of these services to VHA, they will also fall within the requirement to obtain a satisfactory assurance from these contractors by executing a BAA.

(B) *BAA requirement flow down to subcontractors.* A prime Contractor required to execute a BAA shall also obtain a satisfactory assurance, in the form of a BAA, that any of its subcontractors who will also create, receive, maintain, or transmit VHA PHI or that will store, generate, access, exchange, process, or utilize such PHI will comply with HIPAA requirements to the same degree as the Contractor. Contractors employing a subcontractor who creates, receives, maintains, or transmits VHA PHI or that will store, generate, access, exchange, process, or utilize such VHA PHI under a contract or agreement is required to execute a BAA with each of its subcontractors which also obligates the subcontractor (*i.e.*, also a business associate) to provide the same protections and safeguards and agree to the same disclosure restrictions to VHA's PHI that is required of the Covered Entity and the prime Contractor.

(d) *Contractor operations required to be in United States.* Custom software development and outsourced operations must be located in the U.S. to the maximum extent practicable. If such services are proposed to be performed outside the continental United States, and are not otherwise disallowed by other Federal law, regulations or policy, or other VA policy or other mandates as stated in the contract, specifications, statement of work or performance work statement (including applicable Business Associate Agreements), the Contractor/subcontractor must state in its proposal where all non-U.S. services are provided. At a minimum, the Contractor/ subcontractor must include a detailed Information Technology Security Plan, for review and approval by the Contracting Officer, specifically to address mitigation of the resulting problems of communication, control, and data protection.

(e) *Contractor/subcontractor employee reassignment and termination notification.* Contractors and subcontractors shall provide written notification to the Contracting Officer and Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) immediately, and not later than four (4) hours, when an employee working on a VA information system or with access to VA information is reassigned or leaves the Contractor or subcontractor's employment on the cognizant VA contract. The Contracting Officer and COR must also be notified immediately by the Contractor or subcontractor prior to an unfriendly termination.

(f) *VA information custodial requirements.*

(1) *Release, publication, and use of data.* Information made available to a Contractor or subcontractor by VA for the performance or administration of a contract or information

developed by the Contractor/subcontractor in performance or administration of a contract shall be used only for the stated contract purpose and shall not be used in any other way without VA's prior written approval. This clause expressly limits the Contractor's/ subcontractor's rights to use data as described in Rights in Data—General, FAR 52.227–14(d).

(2) *Media sanitization.* VA information shall not be co-mingled with any other data on the Contractors/subcontractor's information systems or media storage systems in order to ensure federal and VA requirements related to data protection, information segregation, classification requirements, and media sanitization can be met (*see* VA Directive 6500, VA Cybersecurity Program). VA reserves the right to conduct scheduled or unscheduled on-site inspections, assessments, or audits of Contractor and subcontractor IT resources, information systems and assets to ensure data security and privacy controls, separation of data and job duties, and destruction/media sanitization procedures are in compliance with Federal and VA requirements. The Contractor and subcontractor will provide all necessary access and support to VA and/or GAO staff during periodic control assessments or audits.

(3) *Data retention, destruction, and contractor self-certification.* The Contractor and its subcontractors are responsible for collecting and destroying any VA data provided, created, or stored under the terms of this contract, to a point where VA data or materials are no longer readable or reconstructable to any degree, in accordance with VA Directive 6371, Destruction of Temporary Paper Records, or subsequent issue. Prior to termination or completion of this contract, the Contractor/subcontractor must provide its plan for destruction of all VA data in its possession according to VA Handbook 6500, and VA Cybersecurity Program, including compliance with National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800–88, Guidelines for Media Sanitization, for the purposes of media sanitization on all IT equipment. The Contractor must certify in writing to the Contracting Officer within 30 days of termination of the contract that the data destruction requirements in this paragraph have been met.

(4) *Return of VA data and information.* When information, data, documentary material, records and/or equipment is no longer required, it shall be returned to the VA (as stipulated by the Contracting Officer or the COR) or the Contractor/subcontractor must hold it until otherwise directed. Items returned will be hand carried, securely mailed, emailed, or securely electronically transmitted to the Contracting Officer or to the address as provided in the contract or by the assigned COR, and/or accompanying BAA. Depending on the method of return, Contractor/subcontractor must store, transport, or transmit VA sensitive information, when permitted by the contract using VA-approved encryption tools that are, at a minimum, validated under Federal Information Processing Standards (FIPS) 140–3 (or its successor). If mailed, Contractor/subcontractor must send via a trackable method (USPS, UPS, Federal Express, etc.) and immediately provide the Contracting Officer with the tracking information. No information, data, documentary material, records or equipment will be destroyed unless done in accordance with the terms of this contract and the VHA Records Control Schedule 10–1.

(5) *Use of VA data and information.* The Contractor/subcontractor must receive, gather, store, back up, maintain, use, disclose and dispose of VA information only in compliance with the terms of the contract and applicable Federal and VA information confidentiality and security laws, regulations and policies. If Federal or VA information confidentiality and security laws, regulations and policies become applicable to the VA information or information systems after execution of the contract, or if the National NIST issues or updates applicable FIPS or Special Publications (SP) after execution of this contract, the parties agree to negotiate in good faith to implement the information confidentiality and security laws, regulations and policies for this contract as a result of any updates, if required.

(6) *Copying VA data or information.* The Contractor/subcontractor shall not make copies of VA information except as authorized and necessary to perform the terms of the contract or to

preserve electronic information stored on Contractor/ subcontractor electronic storage media for restoration in case any electronic equipment or data used by the Contractor/subcontractor needs to be restored to an operating state. If copies are made for restoration purposes, after the restoration is complete, the copies must be appropriately destroyed.

(7) *Violation of information custodial requirements.* If VA determines that the Contractor has violated any of VA's information confidentiality, privacy, or security provisions, it shall be sufficient grounds for VA to withhold payment to the Contractor or third-party or terminate the contract for default in accordance with FAR part 49 or terminate for cause in accordance with FAR 12.403.

(8) *Encryption.* The Contractor/ subcontractor must store, transport, or transmit VA sensitive information, when permitted by the contract, using cryptography, and VA-approved encryption tools that are, at a minimum, validated under FIPS 140-3 (or its successor).

(9) *Firewall and web services security controls.* The Contractor/subcontractor's firewall and web services security controls, if applicable, shall meet or exceed VA's minimum requirements. VA Configuration Guidelines are available upon request.

(10) *Disclosure of VA data and information.* Except for uses and disclosures of VA information authorized in a cognizant contract for performance of the contract, the Contractor/subcontractor may use and disclose VA information only in two other situations:

(i) subject to paragraph (f)(10) of this section, in response to a court order from a court of competent jurisdiction, or

(ii) with VA's prior written approval. The Contractor/ subcontractor must refer all requests for, demands for production of, or inquiries about, VA information and information systems to the Contracting Officer for response. If the Contractor/subcontractor is in receipt of a court order or other request or believes it has a legal requirement to disclose VA information, that Contractor/ subcontractor shall immediately refer such court order or other request to the Contracting Officer for response. If the Contractor or subcontractor discloses information on behalf of VHA, the Contractor and/or subcontractor must maintain an accounting of disclosures. Accounting of Disclosures documentation maintained by the Contractor/subcontractor will include the name of the individual to whom the information pertains, the date of each disclosure, the nature or description of the information disclosed, a brief statement of the purpose of each disclosure or, in lieu of such statement, a copy of a written request for a disclosure, and the name and address of the person or agency to whom the disclosure was made. The Contractor/ subcontractor will provide its Accounting of Disclosures upon request and within 15 calendar days to the assigned COR and Privacy Officer. Accounting of disclosures should be provided electronically via encrypted email to the COR and designated VA facility Privacy Officer as provided in the contract, BAA, or by the Contracting Officer. If providing the Accounting of Disclosures electronically cannot be done securely, the Contractor/subcontractor will provide copies via trackable methods (UPS, USPS, Federal Express, etc.) immediately, providing the designated COR and Privacy Officer with the tracking information.

(11) *Compliance with privacy statutes and applicable regulations.* The Contractor/ subcontractor shall not disclose VA information protected by any of VA's privacy statutes or applicable regulations including but not limited to: the Privacy Act of 1974, 38 U.S.C. 5701, confidential nature of claims, 38 U.S.C. 5705, confidentiality of medical quality assurance records and/or 38 U.S.C. 7332, confidentiality of certain health records pertaining to drug addiction, sickle cell anemia, alcoholism or alcohol abuse, or infection with human immunodeficiency virus or the HIPAA Privacy Rule. If the Contractor/subcontractor is in receipt of a court order or other requests for VA information or has questions if it can disclose information protected under the abovementioned confidentiality statutes because it is required by

law, that Contractor/subcontractor shall immediately refer such court order or other request to the Contracting Officer for response.

(g) *Report of known or suspected security/ privacy incident.* The Contractor, subcontractor, third-party affiliate or business associate, and its employees shall notify VA immediately via the Contracting Officer and the COR or within one (1) hour of an incident which is an occurrence (including the discovery or disclosure of successful exploits of system vulnerability) that

(A) actually, or imminently jeopardizes, without lawful authority, the integrity, confidentiality, or the availability of its data and operations, or of its information or information system(s); or

(B) constitutes a violation or imminent threat of violation of law, security policies, security procedures, or acceptable use policies. The initial notification may first be made verbally but must be followed up in writing within one (1) hour. See VA Data Breach Response Service at https://www.oprm.va.gov/dbrs/about_dbrs.aspx. Report all actual or suspected security/privacy incidents and report the information to the Contracting Officer and the COR as identified in the contract or as directed in the contract, within one hour of discovery or suspicion.

(1) Such issues shall be remediated as quickly as is practical, but in no event longer than 5 days. The Contractor shall notify the Contracting Officer in writing.

(2) When the security fixes involve installing third party patched (e.g., Microsoft OS patches or Adobe Acrobat), the Contractor will provide written notice to VA that the patch has been validated as not affecting the systems within 10 working days. When the Contractor is responsible for operations or maintenance of the systems, they shall apply the security fixes within 5-days.

(3) All other vulnerabilities shall be remediated in a timely manner based on risk, but within 60 days of discovery or disclosure. Contractors shall notify the Contracting Officer, and COR within 2 business days after remediation of the identified vulnerability. Exceptions to this paragraph (e.g., for the convenience of VA) must be requested by the Contractor through the COR and shall only be granted with approval of the Contracting Officer and the VA Assistant Secretary for Office of Information and Technology. These exceptions will be tracked by the Contractor in concert with the Government in accordance with VA Directive 6500.6 and related VA Handbooks.

(h) *Security and privacy incident investigation.*

(1) The term “privacy incident” means the unauthorized disclosure or use of VA information protected under a confidentiality statute or regulation.

(2) The term “security incident” means an occurrence that

(A) actually, or imminently jeopardizes, without lawful authority, the integrity, confidentiality, or availability of information systems; or

(B) constitutes a violation or imminent threat of violation of law, security policies, security procedures, or acceptable policies. The Contractor/subcontractor shall immediately notify the Contracting Officer and COR for the contract of any known or suspected security or privacy incident, or any other unauthorized disclosure of sensitive information, including that contained in system(s) to which the Contractor/subcontractor has access.

(3) To the extent known by the Contractor/ subcontractor, the Contractor/subcontractor’s notice to VA shall identify the information involved, the circumstances surrounding the incident (including to whom, how, when, and where the VA information or assets were placed at risk or compromised), and any other information that the Contractor/subcontractor considers relevant.

(4) With respect to unsecured PHI, the Business Associate is deemed to have discovered a security incident as defined above when the Business Associate either knew, or by exercising reasonable diligence should have been known to an employee of the Business Associate. Upon discovery, the Business Associate must notify VHA of the security incident immediately within one hour of discovery or suspicion as agreed to in the BAA.

(5) In instances of theft or break-in or other criminal activity, the Contractor/subcontractor must concurrently report the incident to the appropriate law enforcement entity (or entities) of jurisdiction, including the VA OIG and the VA Office of Security and Law Enforcement. The Contractor, its employees, and its subcontractors and their employees shall cooperate with VA and any law enforcement authority responsible for the investigation and prosecution of any possible criminal law violation(s) associated with any incident. The Contractor/subcontractor shall cooperate with VA in any civil litigation to recover VA information, obtain monetary or other compensation from a third party for damages arising from any incident, or obtain injunctive relief against any third party arising from, or related to, the incident.

(i) *Data breach notification requirements.*

(1) This contract may require access to sensitive personal information. If so, the Contractor is liable to VA for liquidated damages in the event of a data breach involving any VA sensitive personal information the Contractor/Subcontractor processes or maintains under the contract as set forth in clause 852.211-76, Liquidated Damages—Reimbursement for Data Breach Costs.

(2) The Contractor/subcontractor shall provide notice to VA of a privacy or security incident as set forth in the Security and Privacy Incident Investigation section of this clause. The term 'data breach' means the loss, theft, or other unauthorized access, or any access other than that incidental to the scope of employment, to data containing sensitive personal information, in electronic or printed form, that results in the potential compromise of the confidentiality or integrity of the data. The Contractor shall fully cooperate with VA or third-party entity performing an independent risk analysis on behalf of VA. Failure to cooperate may be deemed a material breach and grounds for contract termination.

(3) The Contractor/subcontractor shall fully cooperate with VA or any Government agency conducting an analysis regarding any notice of a data breach or potential data breach or security incident which may require the Contractor to provide information to the Government or third-party performing a risk analysis for VA, and shall address all relevant information concerning the data breach, including the following:

- (i) Nature of the event (loss, theft, unauthorized access).
- (ii) Description of the event, including—
 - (A) Date of occurrence;
 - (B) Date of incident detection;
 - (C) Data elements involved, including any PII, such as full name, social security number, date of birth, home address, account number, disability code.
 - (D) Number of individuals affected or potentially affected.
 - (E) Names of individuals or groups affected or potentially affected.
 - (F) Ease of logical data access to the lost, stolen or improperly accessed data in light of the degree of protection for the data, *e.g.*, unencrypted, plain text.
 - (G) Amount of time the data has been out of VA control.
 - (H) The likelihood that the sensitive personal information will or has been compromised (made accessible to and usable by unauthorized persons).
 - (I) Known misuses of data containing sensitive personal information, if any.
 - (J) Assessment of the potential harm to the affected individuals.
 - (K) Data breach analysis as outlined in 6500.2 Handbook, Management of Breaches Involving Sensitive Personal Information, as appropriate.
 - (L) Whether credit protection services may assist record subjects in avoiding or mitigating the results of identity theft based on the sensitive personal information that may have been compromised.
 - (M) Steps taken in response to mitigate or prevent a repetition of the incident.
- (j) *Training.*

(1) All Contractor employees and subcontractor employees requiring access to VA information or VA information systems shall complete the following before being granted access to VA information and its systems:

(i) On an annual basis, successfully complete the VA Privacy and Information Security Awareness and VA Information Security Rules of Behavior training.

(ii) On an annual basis, sign and acknowledge (either manually or electronically) understanding of and responsibilities for compliance with the VA Information Security Rules of Behavior for Organizational Users, relating to access to VA information and information systems.

(iii) Successfully complete any additional cyber security or privacy training, as required for VA personnel with equivalent information system access.

(2) The Contractor shall provide to the Contracting Officer and/or the COR a copy of the training certificates and affirmation that VA Information Security Rules of Behavior for Organizational Users signed by each applicable employee have been completed and submitted within five (5) days of the initiation of the contract and annually thereafter, as required.

(3) Failure to complete the mandatory annual training and acknowledgement of the VA Information Security Rules of Behavior, within the timeframe required, is grounds for suspension or termination of all physical or electronic access privileges and removal from work on the contract until such time as the training and documents are complete.

(k) *Subcontract flow down.* The Contractor shall include the substance of this clause, including this paragraph (k), in subcontracts, third-party agreements, and BAAs, of any amount and in which subcontractor employees, third-party servicers/employees, and business associates will perform functions where they will have access to VA information (including VA sensitive information, *i.e.*, sensitive personal information and protected health information), information systems, information technology (IT) or providing and accessing information technology-related contract services, support services, and related resources (see VAAR 802.101 definition of information technology-related contracts).

(End of Clause)

C.7 VAAR 852.211-76 LIQUIDATED DAMAGES-REIMBURSEMENT FOR DATA BREACH COSTS ALTERNATE I (FEB 2023)

(a) *Definition.* As used in this clause, “contract” means any contract, agreement, order or other instrument and encompasses the definition set forth in FAR 2.101.

(b) *Non-disclosure requirements.* As a condition of performance under a contract, order, agreement, or other instrument that requires access to sensitive personal information as defined in VAAR 802.101, the following is expressly required -

(1) The Contractor, subcontractor, their employees or business associates shall not, directly or through an affiliate or employee of the Contractor, subcontractor, or business associate, disclose sensitive personal information to any other person unless the disclosure is lawful and is expressly permitted under the contract; and

(2) The Contractor, subcontractor, their employees or business associates shall immediately notify the Contracting Officer and the Contracting Officer's Representative (COR) of any security incident that occurs involving sensitive personal information.

(c) *Liquidated damages.* If the Contractor or any of its agents fails to protect VA sensitive personal information or otherwise engages in conduct which results in a data breach, the Contractor shall, in place of actual damages, pay to the Government liquidated damages of \$37.50 per affected individual in order to cover costs related to the notification, data breach analysis and credit monitoring. In the event the Contractor provides payment of actual damages in an amount determined to be adequate by the Contracting Officer, the Contracting Officer may forgo collection of liquidated damages.

(d) *Purpose of liquidated damages.* Based on the results from VA's determination that there was a data breach caused by Contractor's or any of its agents' failure to protect or otherwise engaging in conduct to cause a data breach of VA sensitive personal information, and as directed by the Contracting Officer, the Contractor shall be responsible for paying to the VA liquidated damages in the amount of \$37.50 per affected individual to cover the cost of the following:

- (1) Notification related costs.
- (2) Credit monitoring reports.
- (3) Data breach analysis and impact.
- (4) Fraud alerts.
- (5) Identity theft insurance.

(e) Relationship to termination clause, if applicable. If the Government terminates this contract in whole or in part under the Termination for cause paragraph, FAR 52.212-4(m), Contract Terms and Conditions - Commercial Products and Commercial Services, the Contractor is liable for damages accruing until the Government reasonably obtains delivery or performance of similar supplies or services. These damages are in addition to costs of repurchase as may be required under the Termination clause.

(End of clause)

C.8 VAAR 852.239-76 INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY ACCESSIBILITY (FEB 2023)

(a) All information and communication technology (ICT) (formerly referred to as electronic and information technology (EIT)) supplies, information, documentation and services support developed, acquired, maintained or delivered under this contract or order must comply with the "Architectural and Transportation Barriers Compliance Board Electronic and Information Technology (EIT) Accessibility Standards" (*see* 36 CFR part 1194). Information about [Section 508](http://www.section508.va.gov/) is available at <http://www.section508.va.gov/>.

(b) The Section 508 accessibility standards applicable to this contract or order are identified in the specification, statement of work, or performance work statement. If it is determined by the Government that ICT supplies and services provided by the Contractor do not conform to the described accessibility standards in the contract, remediation of the supplies or services to the level of conformance specified in the contract will be the responsibility of the Contractor at its own expense.

(c) The Section 508 accessibility standards applicable to this contract are: The Section 508 standards established by the Architectural and Transportation Barriers Compliance Board (Access Board) will be incorporated into and made part of the solicitation and subsequent contract awards. The Contractor must comply with the technical standards at 40 U. S. C. 11312 and Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Circular A-130 in performing this contract.

(d) In the event of a modification(s) to this contract or order, which adds new EIT supplies or services or revises the type of, or specifications for, supplies or services, the Contracting Officer may require that the Contractor submit a completed VA Section 508 Checklist and any other additional information necessary to assist the Government in determining that the ICT supplies or services conform to Section 508 accessibility standards. If it is determined by the Government that ICT supplies and services provided by the Contractor do not conform to the described accessibility standards in the contract, remediation of the supplies or services to the level of conformance specified in the contract will be the responsibility of the Contractor at its own expense.

(e) If this is an Indefinite-Delivery type contract, a Blanket Purchase Agreement or a Basic Ordering Agreement, the task/delivery order requests that include ICT supplies or services will define the specifications and accessibility standards for the order. In those cases, the Contractor may be required to provide a completed VA Section 508 Checklist and any other additional information necessary to assist the Government in determining that the ICT supplies or services conform to Section 508 accessibility standards. If it is determined by the Government that ICT supplies and services provided by the Contractor do not conform to the described accessibility standards in the provided documentation, remediation of the supplies or services to the level of conformance specified in the contract will be the responsibility of the Contractor at its own expense.

(End of clause)

C.9 52.203-16 – Preventing Personal Conflicts of Interest (JUN 2020)

(a) *Definitions.* As used in this clause—

Acquisition function closely associated with inherently governmental functions means supporting or providing advice or recommendations with regard to the following activities of a Federal agency:

- (1) Planning acquisitions.
- (2) Determining what supplies or services are to be acquired by the Government, including developing statements of work.
- (3) Developing or approving any contractual documents, to include documents defining requirements, incentive plans, and evaluation criteria.
- (4) Evaluating contract proposals.
- (5) Awarding Government contracts.
- (6) Administering contracts (including ordering changes or giving technical direction in contract performance or contract quantities, evaluating contractor performance, and accepting or rejecting contractor products or services).
- (7) Terminating contracts.
- (8) Determining whether contract costs are reasonable, allocable, and allowable.

Covered employee means an individual who performs an acquisition function closely associated with inherently governmental functions and is—

- (1) An employee of the contractor; or

(2) A subcontractor that is a self-employed individual treated as a covered employee of the contractor because there is no employer to whom such an individual could submit the required disclosures.

Non-public information means any Government or third-party information that-

(1) Is exempt from disclosure under the Freedom of Information Act ([5 U.S. C.552](#)) or otherwise protected from disclosure by statute, Executive order, or regulation; or

(2) Has not been disseminated to the general public and the Government has not yet determined whether the information can or will be made available to the public.

Personal conflict of interest means a situation in which a covered employee has a financial interest, personal activity, or relationship that could impair the employee's ability to act impartially and in the best interest of the Government when performing under the contract. (A de minimis interest that would not "impair the employee's ability to act impartially and in the best interest of the Government" is not covered under this definition.)

(1) Among the sources of personal conflicts of interest are-

(i) Financial interests of the covered employee, of close family members, or of other members of the covered employee's household;

(ii) Other employment or financial relationships (including seeking or negotiating for prospective employment or business); and

(iii) Gifts, including travel.

(2) For example, financial interests referred to in paragraph (1) of this definition may arise from-

(i) Compensation, including wages, salaries, commissions, professional fees, or fees for business referrals;

(ii) Consulting relationships (including commercial and professional consulting and service arrangements, scientific and technical advisory board memberships, or serving as an expert witness in litigation);

(iii) Services provided in exchange for honorariums or travel expense reimbursements;

(iv) Research funding or other forms of research support;

(v) Investment in the form of stock or bond ownership or partnership interest (excluding diversified mutual fund investments);

(vi) Real estate investments;

(vii) Patents, copyrights, and other intellectual property interests; or

(viii) Business ownership and investment interests.

(b) *Requirements*. The Contractor shall—

(1) Have procedures in place to screen covered employees for potential personal conflicts of interest, by-

(i) Obtaining and maintaining from each covered employee, when the employee is initially assigned to the task under the contract, a disclosure of interests that might be affected by the task to which the employee has been assigned, as follows:

(A) Financial interests of the covered employee, of close family members, or of other members of the covered employee's household.

(B) Other employment or financial relationships of the covered employee (including seeking or negotiating for prospective employment or business).

(C) Gifts, including travel; and

(ii) Requiring each covered employee to update the disclosure statement whenever the employee's personal or financial circumstances change in such a way that a new personal conflict of interest might occur because of the task the covered employee is performing.

(2) For each covered employee—

(i) Prevent personal conflicts of interest, including not assigning or allowing a covered employee to perform any task under the contract for which the Contractor has identified a personal conflict of interest for the employee that the Contractor or employee cannot satisfactorily prevent or mitigate in consultation with the contracting agency;

(ii) Prohibit use of non-public information accessed through performance of a Government contract for personal gain; and

(iii) Obtain a signed non-disclosure agreement to prohibit disclosure of non-public information accessed through performance of a Government contract.

(3) Inform covered employees of their obligation-

(i) To disclose and prevent personal conflicts of interest;

(ii) Not to use non-public information accessed through performance of a Government contract for personal gain; and

(iii) To avoid even the appearance of personal conflicts of interest;

(4) Maintain effective oversight to verify compliance with personal conflict-of-interest safeguards;

(5) Take appropriate disciplinary action in the case of covered employees who fail to comply with policies established pursuant to this clause; and

(6) Report to the Contracting Officer any personal conflict-of-interest violation by a covered employee as soon as it is identified. This report shall include a description of the violation and the proposed actions to be taken by the Contractor in response to the violation. Provide follow-up reports of corrective actions taken, as necessary. Personal conflict-of-interest violations include-

(i) Failure by a covered employee to disclose a personal conflict of interest;

(ii) Use by a covered employee of non-public information accessed through performance of a Government contract for personal gain; and

(iii) Failure of a covered employee to comply with the terms of a non-disclosure agreement.

(c) Mitigation or waiver.

(1) In exceptional circumstances, if the Contractor cannot satisfactorily prevent a personal conflict of interest as required by paragraph (b)(2)(i) of this clause, the Contractor may submit a request through the Contracting Officer to the Head of the Contracting Activity for-

(i) Agreement to a plan to mitigate the personal conflict of interest; or

(ii) A waiver of the requirement.

(2) The Contractor shall include in the request any proposed mitigation of the personal conflict of interest.

(3) The Contractor shall-

(i) Comply, and require compliance by the covered employee, with any conditions imposed by the Government as necessary to mitigate the personal conflict of interest; or

(ii) Remove the Contractor employee or subcontractor employee from performance of the contract or terminate the applicable subcontract.

(d) *Subcontracts*. The Contractor shall include the substance of this clause, including this paragraph (d), in subcontracts—

(1) That exceed the simplified acquisition threshold, as defined in Federal Acquisition Regulation [2.101](#) on the date of subcontract award; and

(3) In which subcontractor employees will perform acquisition functions closely associated with inherently governmental functions (*i.e.*, instead of performance only by a self-employed individual).

(End of clause)

C.10 Artificial Intelligence in VA Contracts

For purposes of this clause, AI is defined as set forth by VA and Section 238(g) of the National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2019 to include:

1. Any artificial system that performs tasks under varying and unpredictable circumstances without significant human oversight, or that can learn from experience and improve performance when exposed to data sets.
2. An artificial system developed in computer software, physical hardware, or other context that solves tasks requiring human-like perception, cognition, planning, learning, communication, or physical action.
3. An artificial system designed to think or act like a human, including cognitive architectures and neural networks.
4. A set of techniques, including machine learning (ML), that is designed to approximate a cognitive task.
5. An artificial system designed to act rationally, including an intelligent software agent or embodied robot that achieves goals using perception, planning, reasoning, learning, communicating, decision making, and acting.

The Contractor shall provide a list of all AI it will be proposing, creating, delivering, and/or using as part of contract performance, for VA approval. The list of AI shall be provided directly to the VA PM, COR, and CO at least annually but also at the following times: upon proposal submission, contract award, the COR's request, and upon the Contractor's proposed use of new AI tools not contemplated at the time of last reporting. AI shall not be used in performance of the contract without the written approval and authorization of the CO. The Contractor shall also report all AI intended for use in contract performance for VA's inclusion in the VA AI Use Case Inventory. The Contractor shall actively engage in AI discovery, assessment, and compliance activities undertaken by VA.

Once the Contractor has obtained CO authorization to use specific AI in contract performance, the Contractor shall provide the COR a signed Statement of Attestation prior to AI implementation. All AI for delivery and/or use in performance of the contract shall adhere to the *VA Trustworthy AI Framework*, available at <https://department.va.gov/ai/trustworthy/>. The Statement of Attestation shall include, but is not limited to, a description of all controls, processes, technologies, and mechanisms utilized to satisfy VA's six (6) AI Principles: Purposeful, Effective and Safe, Secure and Private, Fair and Equitable, Transparent and Explainable, and Accountable and Monitored. The Statement of Attestation shall also certify that the Contractor owns or possesses all legally required rights, copyright, and licenses to use the specified AI. The Statement of Attestation shall clearly state that the use of the AI by VA personnel in performance of the contract:

1. Does not and will not infringe upon any intellectual property rights of any kind.
2. Does not violate any intellectual property rights of any kind.
3. Does not violate any other third-party rights of any kind.

The Statement of Attestation shall also affirm that there have not been any persisting or existing material errors, defects, failures, or interruptions in AI performance of its intended purpose. Additionally, the Statement of Attestation shall include the Contractor's endorsement that the AI has materially performed in accordance with its specifications and intended purpose. Lastly, the Statement of Attestation shall be updated and resubmitted, at a minimum, annually, prior to the exercise of any contract option periods. The Statement of Attestation shall be deemed separate from, and in addition to, the Contractor's reporting requirements relative to the use of AI. The Statement of Attestation is a material term of the contract; accordingly, failure to provide the Statement of Attestation, to include all requirements, may be deemed a breach of contract and thus, cause for termination.

Data Ownership and Use. VA data ("Data") shall include data collected, used, processed, stored, or generated as the result of the use of AI. VA data is and shall remain the sole and exclusive property of VA. Contractor is provided a limited, non-exclusive license to access and use Data solely for performing its obligations under the Contract. The Contractor shall: (a) keep and maintain VA data in strict confidence and as further described in this Contract and applicable law to avoid unauthorized access, use, disclosure, or loss; (b) not use, sell, rent, transfer, distribute, or otherwise disclose or make available VA Data for Contractor's own purposes or for the benefit of anyone other than VA without the CO's prior written consent; and (c) not store, use, and transmit VA Data outside of the United States. This applies to both identified and de-identified data.

The Contractor (or Subcontractor at any tier, including affiliates, third-party affiliates, and any other non-VA entities) shall not sell, monetize, release, share, reuse, transfer, or misuse any VA data, to include any models, training data, testing data, patterns, documentation, implementation artifacts, runtime artifacts, or any other digital artifacts, partially or as a whole, derived from AI or machine learning (ML) without the express written consent and approval from the CO.

The Contractor is prohibited from using non-public VA data, including Veteran data, and outputted results to train publicly or commercially available AI algorithms, fine-tune, or otherwise develop AI or ML models for reuse, transfer, or commercial purposes, without the express written authorization from the CO specifying VA data that may be used along with the acceptable scope of such usage. Contractor agrees that any AI models, weights, or derivative artifacts trained, or fine-tuned, on VA non-public data, if authorized by VA, may not be commercialized or used for the benefit of any third party without prior written approval by the CO and must be conducted within a VA authorized environment that has obtained an Authority to Operate

The Contractor shall indemnify VA and its officers, employees, and agents against liability, including costs, for actual or alleged direct or contributory infringement of, or inducement to infringe, any United States or foreign patent, trademark, or copyright, arising out of VA use of any AI products and/or services under the contract.

The Contractor shall maintain commercially reasonable insurance coverage for claims or losses pertaining to the AI products or services being used in performance of the contract.

The Contractor shall maintain commercially reasonable and industry standard conforming security safeguards and controls, including proper access controls for the AI. The Contractor agrees the VA Contracting Officer has the unilateral right to require deactivation of any AI for any reason and without notice.

Any development and/or creation of AI, including any AI derivatives, during performance of this contract, is subject to applicable Intellectual Property and data rights clauses under the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) including, FAR 52.227-14. The VA retains the unlimited right to reuse, share, and/or redeploy AI code and AI models procured under this contract. License rights in any Commercial Computer Software shall be governed by this contract.

This clause applies to both existing and new uses of AI, both stand-alone AI and AI embedded within other systems or applications, AI developed both by VA or by third parties on behalf of agencies for the fulfilment of specific VA missions, including relevant data inputs used to train AI and outputs used in support of decision making, and VA procurement of AI applications.

This clause does not apply to AI embedded within common commercial products, such as word processors or map navigation systems. The Contractor shall inform the VA Contracting Officer in writing if it believes the AI it intends to use during contract performance is not covered by this clause. The burden to demonstrate the AI is a common commercial product shall rest solely with the Contractor.

Non-compliance with the terms above, or loss of sensitive VA medical records information resulting from AI use (whether accidental or intentional), may result in Contractor liability to VA for any and all rights and remedies provided by law, including but not limited to contract termination, liquidated damages, and referral to VA's Suspension and Debarment Committee.

The Contractor shall include the substance of this clause in all subcontracts, including Subcontractors at any tier, affiliates, third-party affiliates, and any other non-VA entities.

(End Clause)

SECTION D - CONTRACT DOCUMENTS, EXHIBITS, OR ATTACHMENTS

Attachment 1: HELM Products

Attachment 2: HELM Backlog

Attachment 3: HS Agile_Epics Operating HS Agile

For Technical Challenge Only:

Hospital A – J Dirty Data Set.xlsx

Flow_Diagram_Technical_Challenge

SECTION E - SOLICITATION PROVISIONS

E.1 52.252-1 SOLICITATION PROVISIONS INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE (FEB 1998)

This solicitation incorporates one or more solicitation provisions by reference, with the same force and effect as if they were given in full text. Upon request, the Contracting Officer will make their full text available. The Quoter is cautioned that the listed provisions may include blocks that must be completed by the Quoter and submitted with its quotation or offer. In lieu of submitting the full text of those provisions, the Quoter may identify the provision by paragraph identifier and provide the appropriate information with its quotation or offer. Also, the full text of a solicitation provision may be accessed electronically at this/these address(es):

<https://www.acquisition.gov/far-overhaul>
<http://www.va.gov/oal/library/vaar/>

(End of Provision)		
<u>FAR</u> <u>Number</u>	<u>Title</u>	<u>Date</u>
52.217-5	EVALUATION OF OPTIONS	JUL 1990
52.229-11	TAX ON CERTAIN FOREIGN PROCUREMENTS— NOTICE AND REPRESENTATION	JUN 2020
852.209-70	ORGANIZATION CONFLICTS OF INTEREST	OCT 2020
852.223-70	INSTRUCTIONS TO OFFERORS-SUSTAINABLE ACQUISITION PLAN	SEP 2019
852.233-70	PROTEST CONTENT/ALTERNATIVE DISPUTE RESOLUTION	OCT 2018
852.233-71	ALTERNATIVE PROTEST PROCEDURE	
852.239-71	INFORMATION SYSTEM SECURITY PLAN AND ACCREDITATION	FEB 2023
852.239-75	INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATION TECHNOLOGY ACCESSIBILITY NOTICE	FEB 2023
852.252-70	SOLICITATION PROVISIONS OR CLAUSES INCORPORATED BY REFERENCE	JAN 2008
852.273-74	AWARD WITHOUT EXCHANGES	NOV 2021

E.2 52.216-1 TYPE OF CONTRACT (DEV)(NOV 2025)

The Government contemplates award of a hybrid Firm-Fixed-Price Task Order with Time and Materials line item resulting from this solicitation.

(End of Provision)

E.3 52.233-2 SERVICE OF PROTEST (DEV)(NOV 2025)

(a) Protests, as defined in section [33.101](#) of the Federal Acquisition Regulation, that are filed directly with an agency, and copies of any protests that are filed with the Government Accountability Office (GAO), shall be served on the Contracting Officer (addressed as follows) by obtaining written and dated acknowledgment of receipt from:

Electronic address: Jason.king6@va.gov

(b) The copy of any protest shall be received in the office designated above within one day of filing a protest with the GAO.

E.4 VAAR 852.209-70 ORGANIZATIONAL CONFLICTS OF INTEREST (OCT 2020)

(a) It is in the best interest of the Government to avoid situations which might create an organizational conflict of interest or where the Offeror's performance of work under the contract may provide the Contractor with an unfair competitive advantage. The term "organizational conflict of interest" means that because of other activities or relationships with other persons, a person is unable to render impartial assistance or advice to the Government, or the person's objectivity in performing the contract work is or might be otherwise impaired, or the person has an unfair competitive advantage.

(b) The Offeror shall provide a statement with its offer which describes, in a concise manner, all relevant facts concerning any past, present, or currently planned interest (financial, contractual, organizational, or otherwise) or actual or potential organizational conflicts of interest relating to the services to be provided under this solicitation. The Offeror shall also provide statements with its offer containing the same information for any consultants and subcontractors identified in its proposal and which will provide services under the solicitation. The Offeror may also provide relevant facts that show how its organizational and/or management system or other actions would avoid or mitigate any actual or potential organizational conflicts of interest.

(c) Based on this information and any other information solicited or obtained by the Contracting Officer, the Contracting Officer may determine that an organizational conflict of interest exists which would warrant disqualifying the Contractor for award of the contract unless the organizational conflict of interest can be mitigated to the Contracting Officer's satisfaction by negotiating terms and conditions of the contract to that effect. If the conflict of interest cannot be mitigated and if the Contracting Officer finds that it is in the best interest of the United States to award the contract, the Contracting Officer shall request a waiver in accordance with FAR 9.503.

(d) Nondisclosure or misrepresentation of actual or potential organizational conflicts of interest at the time of the offer or arising as a result of a modification to the contract, may result in the termination of the contract at no expense to the Government.

(End of provision)

E.5 ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE EFFORTS

Response Instructions: Offerors shall, if Artificial Intelligence (AI) is part of the Contractor system/solution, provide the below self-certification with their quote/proposal affirming that the identified/proposed AI System/LLM complies with the two Unbiased AI Principles, Truth-seeking and Ideological Neutrality, as required by the Office of Management and Budget (OMB) Memorandum M-26-04, "Increasing Public Trust in Artificial Intelligence Through Unbiased AI Principles", or indicate otherwise that a self-certification is Not Applicable. Additionally, Offerors shall self-certify that the content requested within the AI System/LLM Development and Operation Documentation, as identified in OMB Memorandum M-26-04 as Transparency Documentation, will be provided for its proposed AI System/LLM during the period of performance, meet the required transparency threshold and align with the two Unbiased AI Principles. Failure to include the requisite Offeror's self-certification may render the Offeror's

proposal/quotation unacceptable, and therefore ineligible for award. The Government will rely on the Offeror's self-certification that its proposed AI System/LLM adheres to the Unbiased AI Principles and related requirements. VA reserves the right to request additional information if it determines that doing so is in the Government's best interest.

Certification:

☐ Not Applicable

☐ I hereby certify that the proposed AI System/LLM complies with the required Unbiased AI Principles as identified in OMB Memorandum M-26-04 and can also meet the required AI System/LLM Development and Operation Documentation requirements specified therein. I further certify that I am authorized to execute this certification on behalf of *<insert name of Offeror>*.

Printed Name of Signee: _____

Printed Title of Signee: _____

Signature: _____

Name (and version) of its proposed AI System/LLM: _____

Date: _____

Company Name and Address: _____

E.6 BASIS FOR AWARD

An award will be made based on the best overall (i.e., best value) proposal that is determined to be the most beneficial to the Government, with appropriate consideration given to the five following evaluation Factors: Technical, Past Performance, Price, Veterans Involvement, and Small Business Participation Commitment. The Technical Factor is significantly more important than the Past Performance Factor, which is more important than the Price Factor, which is more important than the Veterans Involvement Factor, which is more important than the Small Business Participation Commitment Factor. The Technical Factor shall be comprised of two Sub-Factors that shall be rolled up into a combined Technical Factor Rating. The Sub-Factors consist of Subfactor A – Technical Challenge/Demonstration and Subfactor B - Written Technical Response. Subfactor A - Demonstration is equal to Subfactor B - Written Technical Response. To receive consideration for award, a rating of "Acceptable" must be achieved for the Technical Factor. Quoters are cautioned that any resulting award may not necessarily be made to the lowest price offered or the most highly rated technical Proposal.

E.7 EVALUATION APPROACH

All proposals shall be subject to evaluation by a team of Government personnel. The Government reserves the right to award without discussions based upon the initial evaluation of proposals. The proposals will be evaluated strictly in accordance with its written content. Proposals which merely restate the requirement or state that the requirement will be met, without providing supporting rationale, are not sufficient. Quoters who fail to meet the minimum requirements of the solicitation will be rated Unacceptable and thus, ineligible for award.

1. TECHNICAL EVALUATION APPROACH

For the Technical Factor and Sub-Factors, the evaluation process will consider the following:

- a. Understanding of the Problem - The proposal will be evaluated to determine the extent to which it demonstrates a clear understanding of all features involved in solving the problems and meeting and/or exceeding the requirements presented in the solicitation and the extent to which uncertainties are identified and resolutions proposed.
- b. Feasibility of Approach - The proposal will be evaluated to determine the extent to which the proposed approach is workable and the end results achievable. The proposal will be evaluated to determine the level of confidence provided the Government with respect to the Quoter's methods and approach in successfully meeting and/or exceeding the requirements in a timely manner

2. PRICE/COST EVALUATION APPROACH

This will be a hybrid FFP/T&M solicitation with T&M line items for travel. The Government will evaluate the price by adding the total of all line item prices, including all options and optional tasks. The Total Evaluated Price will be the sum of the total evaluated FFP and T&M price.

The Government will verify the Quoter's calculation of the total proposed price. The Government will adjust the quoter's proposed Total Evaluated Price only if mathematical errors are identified. The Government will evaluate the price by adding the total of all line item prices, including all options, optional tasks and the Option to Extend Services (RFO 52.217-8) amount.

As part of the Price evaluation, the Government will evaluate its Option to Extend Services under RFO Clause 52.217-8 by adding 50% of the Quoter's proposed price for the last period of services to the Quoter's total proposed price. Quoters are required only to price the base period, option periods and optional tasks. Quoters shall not submit a price for the potential 50 percent extension of services period. The Government may choose to exercise the extension of services at the end of the last period of services utilizing the rates of that performance period.

3. PAST PERFORMANCE EVALUATION APPROACH

The Past Performance evaluation will assess the relative risk associated with a Quoter's likelihood of successful performance based on its demonstrated record of recent and relevant past performance in performing services such as Agile and Software SDLC delivery; DevSecOps engineering; supply chain modernization and sustainment; system and middleware integration; solution and data architecture; data management and migration; testing and Continuous Integration/Continuous Delivery (CI/CD) automation; release and deployment support; cloud migration and hosting; cybersecurity, Zero Trust, privacy, and Risk Management

Framework/Authority to Operate (RMF/ATO) compliance; the use of leading-industry AI capabilities to enhance automation and analytics; and implementation experience with major supply chain systems or large-scale VA initiatives, such as the Financial Management Business Transformation (FMBT) program or the Electronic Health Record (EHR) program. “Quoter” refers to the proposed prime contractor and all proposed major subcontractor(s). A major subcontractor is defined as one whose subcontract is for more than **20%** of the total proposed price. The Government will evaluate the past performance of the prime and each major subcontractor individually, then consider the combined results to derive the overall Past Performance rating.

The Government will conduct a performance risk assessment based on the quality and relevance of the Quoter’s past performance as it relates to the probability of successfully completing the required effort. The Government will review past performance information available in the Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System (CPARS) and reserves the right to consider information obtained from any other source, including customers not identified by the Quoter. Quoters are responsible for clearly establishing the relevance of the past performance submitted. The burden of demonstrating low performance risk rests with the Quoter.

The Government’s assessment will consider elements that include but are not limited to: quality of product or service; adherence to schedule; cost control (for non-FFP efforts); and effectiveness of program management, including subcontractor oversight. The Government may consider favorable or unfavorable trends in performance, magnitude of issues encountered, and the Quoter’s effectiveness in resolving performance challenges.

If a Quoter does not have a record of relevant past performance, or if no past performance information is available, the Quoter will not be rated favorably or unfavorably on Past Performance.

4. VETERANS INVOLVEMENT APPROACH

In accordance with Veterans Affairs Acquisition Regulation (VAAR) 852.215-70, Service Disabled Veteran-Owned and Veteran-Owned Small Business Evaluation Factors, the Government will assign evaluation credit for a Quoter (prime contractor) which is a Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business (SDVOSB) or a VOSB. To receive credit, a quoter must be registered and verified in Veterans Small Business Certification (VETCert) Program (<https://veterans.certify.sba.gov/>) at the time of proposal submission, and at time of award and must meet federal small business size standards for the North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code assigned to this solicitation.

Non-SDVOSB/VOSB Quoters proposing to use SDVOSBs or VOSBs as subcontractors will receive some consideration under this evaluation Factor. Quoters must state in their proposals the names of the SDVOSBs and VOSBs with whom they intend to subcontract and provide a brief description of the proposed subcontracts and the approximate dollar values of the proposed subcontracts. In addition, the proposed subcontractors must be registered and verified in the VETCert Program (<https://veterans.certify.sba.gov/>) and must meet federal small business size standards for the NAICS code assigned to this solicitation at time of both proposal submission and at time of award.

5. SMALL BUSINESS PARTICIPATION COMMITMENT EVALUATION APPROACH

The evaluation approach will consider the following:

a. Commitment to Small Business Participation - The proposal will be evaluated to determine the extent to which the Quoter demonstrates a commitment to meeting or exceeding the following Small Business Goals: SDVOSB: 5% of the total contract value; VOSB: 7% of the total contract value; Small Disadvantaged Business (SDB) (including Section 8(a)): 5% of the total contract value; Women-Owned Small Business: 5% of the total contract value; Historically Underutilized Business Zone (HUB Zone) Small Business: 3% of the total contract value. Any inability to meet the Government's subcontracting goal(s) for this procurement must be supported by an adequate explanation as to why that goal(s) cannot be met. A realism analysis of the proposed goals will not be conducted. The percentages proposed for the goals will be incorporated into any resulting contract in accordance with Section C.15 - Small Business Requirements.

b. The proposal will also be evaluated to determine whether the Quoter has met the overall Small Business Participation Requirement for this procurement, which is 17.5% of the total contract value. The Quoter shall meet the Small Business Participation Requirement in order to be found acceptable under this factor.

E.8 PROPOSAL SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS

1. INTRODUCTION

Consistent with the market research results for this acquisition, the Request for Proposal is provided to the GSA MAS holders under SIN 54151S who responded to the Government's Request for Information and were determined capable of meeting VA's requirements. The Quoter's proposal shall be submitted electronically via email to Contract Specialist Michelle Prinston, michelle.prinston@va.gov and Contracting Officer Jason King, jason.king6@va.gov. The use of hyperlinks or embedded attachments in the proposal is prohibited. Accordingly, any information contained within an embedded attachment and/or hyperlink will neither be accessed nor evaluated.

Any questions/concerns regarding the submission of quotations shall be submitted by **August 21, 2026** by **12:00pm EST** with the subject line "36C10B26R0048 - Supply Chain Management Development Security Operations (SCMDSO) Integration" to: Michelle Prinston, Contract Specialist by email at Michelle.Prinston@va.gov or Jason King, Contracting Officer at Jason.King6@va.gov.

Any amendments to this solicitation will be provided electronically via email.

WARNING: Please do not wait until the last minute to submit your proposal! Late proposals will not be accepted for evaluation. To avoid submission of late proposals, we recommend the transmission of your quotation file 24 hours prior to the required proposal due date and time. Please be advised that timeliness is determined by the date and time the proposal is received by the Government, not when a quoter attempted transmission. Quoters are encouraged to review and ensure that sufficient bandwidth is available on their end of the transmission.

2. PROPOSAL FILES

Quoter's responses shall be submitted in accordance with the following instructions:

- a. **FORMAT.** The submission shall be clearly indexed and logically assembled. Each volume shall be clearly identified and shall begin at the top of a page. All pages of each volume shall be appropriately numbered and identified by the complete company name, date and solicitation number in the header and/or footer. Page limitations are applicable to this procurement. The Table below indicates the maximum page count (when applicable) for each volume of the quotation.

All files will be submitted as either a Microsoft Word (.doc), Microsoft Excel (.XLS) file or an Acrobat (PDF) file or compatible as indicated in the table. Page size shall be no greater than 8 1/2" x 11" with printing on one side, only. The top, bottom, left and right margins shall be a minimum of one inch (1") each. Font size shall be no smaller than 12-point. Arial or Times New Roman fonts are required. Characters shall be set at no less than normal spacing and 100% scale. Tables and illustrations may use a reduced font size not less than 8-point and may be landscape. Line spacing shall be set at no less than single space. Each paragraph shall be separated by at least one blank line. Page numbers, company logos, headers and footers may be within the page margins ONLY and are not bound by the 12-point font requirement. Footnotes to text shall not be used. All proprietary information shall be clearly and properly marked. If the quoter submits annexes, documentation, attachments or the like, not specifically required by this solicitation, such will count against the quoter's page limitations unless otherwise indicated in the specific volume instructions below. Pages in violation of these instructions, either by exceeding the margin, font, printing, or spacing restrictions or by exceeding the total page limit for a particular volume, will not be evaluated. Pages not evaluated due to violation of the margin, font or spacing restrictions will not count against the page limitations. The page count will be determined by counting the pages in the order they come up in the print layout view.

Quoters that fail to comply with the provided submission instructions may be removed from the competition for failure to follow request for quotation instructions and therefore, would not be considered for award.

- b. **Content Requirements.** All information shall be confined to the appropriate file. The quoter shall confine submissions to essential matters, sufficient to define the proposal and provide an adequate basis for evaluation. Quoters are responsible for including sufficient details, in a concise manner, to permit a complete and accurate evaluation of each quotation. The titles and page limits requirements for each file are shown in the Table below:

Quotation Volumes:

Volume Number	Factor	File Name	Page Limitations*
Volume I	Technical - Subfactor A - Challenge	i: Quoter_Tech1a_cleanfile.CSV	File
		ii: Quoter_Tech1a_itemmaster_Excel or CSV	File

	Technical Virtual Presentation	iii: Quoter_Tech1a_summary Docx, PPT, or PDF iv: Quoter_Tech1a_diagrams Docx, PDF, and/or Excel, CSV, PPT	4 pages or less (word/pdf/ppt) no less than 10 pt font Product SV-2, DIV-1, DIV-2 30 Minute Presentation 15 Minute Question Response
	Technical - Subfactor B - Written Technical Response	Prime Quoter_Tech1b.pdf or docx	15 pages
Volume II	Past Performance	Prime Quoter_PastPerformance.pdf or.docx	None
Volume III	Price	Prime Quoter_Price.xls	None
	Price Proposal Supporting Documentation	Prime Quoter_PBACKUP.xls	None
Volume IV	Veterans Involvement	Prime Quoter_VI.pdf or docx.	None
Volume V	Small Business Participation Commitment	Prime Quoter_SPBC.xls	None
Volume VI	Solicitation, Proposal And Award Documents And Certifications/Representations	Prime Quoter_Reps and Certs.pdf or .docx	None
	Small Business Subcontracting Plan	Prime Quoter_SmallBusinessSubK.pdf or	None

A Cover Page, Table of Contents and/or a glossary of abbreviations or acronyms will not be included in the page count of the Technical Volume – Subfactor B. However, be advised that any and all information contained within any Table of Contents and/or glossary of abbreviations or acronyms submitted with the quotation will not be evaluated by the Government.

See also FAR 52.212-1, Instructions to Offerors – Commercial Items.

(i) VOLUME I – TECHNICAL FACTOR

Subfactor A – Technical Challenge

After receipt of Quotes, Quoters will be notified and provided a Microsoft Teams meeting link via email of the specific date/time of their presentation. VA may offer several presentation timeslots that may be accepted on a first-come, first-serve basis. Quoters must utilize the time slots available or selected; failure to do so may result in the Quoter forfeiting its opportunity to present a demonstration.

Please ensure the email address of the Quoter's point of contact for this email notification is clearly identified in your Written Technical response. The presentation shall be conducted virtually by each Quoter. All costs associated with the demonstration shall be borne by the Quoter and will not be reimbursed by the Government. The demonstration period shall not exceed 30 minutes. Quoters are not required to use the entire 30-minute period; however, Quoters may not exceed the allotted time. A question and answer period between Government personnel and the Quoter shall be limited to no more than 15 minutes following the demonstration. The Government intends to ask two questions.

Electronic pre-recordings of the demonstration are not permitted. The Government intends to record each demonstration. Quoters shall demonstrate that its solution meets the requirements described below. The requirements shall be performed by the Quoter in a logical order with VA personnel viewing each step in real-time.

Purpose: The purpose of this technical challenge is to evaluate each Quoter's ability to understand, analyze, and solve complex data quality, integration, and systems-modernization problems within a constrained environment. This exercise simulates, on a small scale, the type of enterprise-level System Development Life Cycle (SDLC) and system integration work required to support the modernization / replacement of legacy medical supply chain systems with integration to clinical, and financial systems across an enterprise.

Expected Outcome: The outcome of this challenge will help determine the Quoters that have the best capability to support future enterprise modernization efforts that require disciplined SDLC practices, data transformation expertise, and scalable integration strategies. This challenge is intentionally designed to assess how each Quoter navigates ambiguity, incomplete information, and cross-system dependencies (conditions similar to the realities of modernizing VA existing legacy systems in a fictitious scenario). The evaluation will focus not only on the technical outputs, but also on each Quoter's methodology, problem-solving approach, data governance practices, architectural thinking, and ability to clearly communicate their logic and assumptions.

Task: Quoters are provided a deliberately imperfect dataset consisting of 5,000 lines of Artificial Intelligence (AI) generated fictional medical supply chain data originating from 10 fictitious hospitals, along with an accompanying data dictionary and a fictitious high-level business process diagram depicting the ordering and receiving lifecycle across three representative fictitious systems: an Electronic Health Record (EHR), an Enterprise Inventory Management System (EIMS), and a Financial Management System (FMS). This is not the data schema nor indicative of specific business processes used in VA systems, and is system agnostic to VA systems in use, though these system types exist in VA. Using this limited information, Quoters

are expected to demonstrate their ability to cleanse, harmonize, and interpret disparate data and their relationships to systems, and clearly articulate and communicate the approach to produce technical challenge deliverables.

1. Quoters Will Receive:

- Hospitals A-J Unnormalized Data and Data Dictionary excel document (Attachment: A-J Dirty Data Sets.xlsx):
 - a) The first tab contains a multi-hospital dataset (10 fictional hospitals) containing intentionally corrupted fields, inconsistent values, missing data, formatting variations, and logical mismatching etc.
 - b) The second tab provides a Data Dictionary with a full list of fields included in the dirty dataset, their definitions, and intended meaning. Vendors must use this dictionary when cleaning and standardizing the data.
- Fictitious Business Flow Diagram PDF Document (Attachment: Flow Diagram Technical Challenge.pdf):
 - a) A simplified high level business workflow showing how a notional supply chain business process flows through three fictitious systems: an EHR, an EIMS, and an FMS.
 - b) Quoters shall use this diagram and data provided to build their Department of Defense Architecture Framework (DODAF) SV-2, DIV-1, DIV-2, architecture products.

2. Quoter Technical Challenge Requirements for submission: Quoters shall ensure that all required artifacts and deliverables are clearly labeled and organized in their proposal submission, following the naming conventions specified in the above matrix for each file type and section.

- i. Clean and normalize all data fields from the 10 Hospitals. Quoters shall correct corrupted fields, standardize inconsistent values, resolve illogical dates, normalize, standardize data fields (such as, but not limited to vendor names), ensure data is complete. (submit Quoter_Tech1a_cleanfile.csv).
- ii. Produce one clean consolidated output file suitable for a national-level item master file for the consumable supplies for use at all 10 hospitals The Quoter may add additional data fields if their approach requires it. (submit Quoter_Tech1a_itemmaster.xls or csv)
- iii. Summarize the approach used. List all business rules applied. Provide any assumptions, decisions, transformation logic, AI Prompts, AI Training, and AI Tools the Quoter used to normalize, clean, and harmonize data. Provide a clear explanation of where “human in the loop” Subject Matter Expertise (SME) input and data governance would be required to standardize and normalize data in any areas the Quoter could not normalize. Provide an explanation of how the vendor would make this scalable up to 200 hospitals for enterprise-wide deployment. (submit Quoter_Tech1a_summary.docx, ppt or pdf)
- iv. Provide architecture diagrams. The Quoter shall produce SV-2 (Systems Resource Flow Description), DIV-1 (Conceptual Data Model), DIV-2 (Logical Data Model) diagrams that reflect the provided business workflow and cleaned dataset as appropriate. (submit Quoter_Tech1a-diagrams.docx, pdf, and/or xls, csv, ppt)

3. 30 Minute Technical Challenge/ Demonstration Virtual Presentation Requirements:

A half-hour virtual presentation to clearly communicate and articulate the Quoter's demonstrated approach to producing the artifacts for the challenge. Present a walkthrough of the architecture diagrams. Provide insight into how the quoter's data normalization approach for the challenge could be made repeatable and scalable with data governance considerations the Quoter finds relevant. Present any other visualization or demonstration the Quoter chooses relating to the technical challenge. Field questions from the Government. Quoters shall provide a detailed approach that addresses the following:

Quoters shall clearly communicate and articulate their demonstrated approach to producing the Technical Challenge artifacts. The demonstration shall address the following required elements as provided in the Technical Challenge:

1. Data Cleansing and Harmonization: Explain and demonstrate the approach used to cleanse and normalize all 10 hospitals' datasets, including correction of corrupted fields, standardization of inconsistent values, resolution of illogical dates, normalization of data fields (i.e., vendor names), and identification/highlighting of changed cells.
2. Consolidated National Level Item Master Output File: Present the consolidated clean master file combining all hospital data into a single consumable item master dataset (excel or csv).
3. Methodology, Assumptions, and Transformation Logic: Provide an overview of the documented methodology, assumptions, business rules, transformation logic, and any AI prompts, AI tools, or training methods used during data preparation. Identify areas where "human in the loop" SME support or data governance actions would be required to achieve enterprise standardization.
4. Scalability Approach: Describe how the proposed data cleansing and harmonization approach could be scaled from 10 hospitals to a full enterprise implementation (e.g., 200 hospitals). Provide insight into how the quoter's data normalization approach for the challenge could be made repeatable and scalable with data governance considerations the Quoter finds relevant.
5. Architecture Diagrams (SV-2, DIV-1, DIV-2): Provide a walk through the submitted architecture artifacts, including:
 - SV-2 – Systems Resource Flow Description
 - DIV-1 – Conceptual Data Model
 - DIV-2 – Logical Data Model
 Demonstrate how these diagrams reflect the provided business workflow (EHR → EIMS → FMS) and the cleaned dataset.
6. Workflow and Traceability Explanation: Demonstrate the logic flow from the fictitious business process diagram to the data elements, transformations, and architecture outputs. Show how the Quoter interpreted relationships among the three representative systems (EHR, EIMS, FMS) based on the provided diagram.
7. Visualizations / Demonstrations (Optional): Quoters may provide any visualizations or demonstrations related to the technical challenge chosen to support clarity of explanation

and justify architectural or transformation decisions.

8. **Question Response:** During the presentation, Quoters will be asked to answer two Government posed questions when such questions are included as part of the demonstration format. All Quoters will be asked the same questions.

The Government will evaluate the Technical Challenge based on understanding of the problem and feasibility of approach, including how effectively the Quoter demonstrates comprehension of the data preparation, workflow interpretation, and architecture requirements. The virtual presentation will also be evaluated for clarity, organization, and professionalism, including the Quoter's ability to articulate technical reasoning, present artifacts in a logical and coherent manner, adhere to the 30 minute limit, and shall be limited to no more than 15 minutes following the demonstration and respond consistently to Government posed questions. The Government will assess whether the Quoter's demonstrated methods, communication, and execution instill confidence in their ability to fulfill the SCMDSO requirements within VA's enterprise supply chain environment.

Subfactor B - Written Proposal:

The Quoter shall provide a written technical response that addresses the following four discriminators to demonstrate a clear, comprehensive, and feasible approach to performing the requirements of the PWS. Each response will be evaluated for clarity, completeness, feasibility, traceability to PWS, and alignment to VA enterprise modernization goals.

1. **Product Line Management Agile Delivery, SDLC Execution, Legacy Sustainment, and Modernization PWS Subparagraph: 5.0, 5.2, 5.5.1:** Describe how your Agile and SDLC approach will ensure successful delivery and sustainment of both legacy and modernized solutions, including how your methods improve cross team coordination, reduce integration risk, accelerate VA's modernization, standardize processes, and maintain continuity of operations throughout the Product Line. Explain how your approach aligns with the PWS requirements for Agile execution, multisystem integration, iterative delivery, and long term sustainment.
2. **Enterprise Middleware Architecture, Interoperability, Data Flow, and Supply Chain Modernization Alignment 5.1, 5.2.1, 5.8.1–5.8.2, and 5.9.1:** Describe the target state middleware architecture proposed to enable unified data flow, interoperability, and integration across VA's Supply Chain Asset and Inventory Management ecosystems. Explain how your approach supports reliable, repeatable data movement across systems with varying levels of maturity, scales to an enterprise environment with high data volumes and nationwide operational complexity and aligns with VA's Supply Chain Modernization initiatives—including enterprise standardization, enhanced data visibility, improved logistics decision making, and modernization of legacy workflows.
3. **Enterprise Wide Implementation, Standardization, Decommissioning Strategy, Cybersecurity, and Privacy. 5.1, 5.2.2, 5.5.1, 5.5.10, 5.6.4, 5.10.3, 5.11, and 5.12 6.1.2 and 6.2:** Describe your approach to developing an enterprise wide implementation strategy for modernizing and standardizing VA supply chain systems and workflows. Explain how your strategy incorporates cybersecurity and privacy requirements, ensures data integrity during modernization activities, and supports continuity of operations and interoperable enterprise deployment. Additionally, describe how your strategy aligns

with VA Supply Chain Modernization initiatives, VA strategic objectives, and enterprise programs such as EHR and FMBT.

4. AI Enabled DevSecOps and Supply Chain Analytics Trend Detection

5.2.1, 5.5.12, 5.5.1, 5.5.8, and 6.1.11–6.1.11.3: Describe your organization's approach for leveraging Artificial Intelligence (AI) / Machine Learning (ML) within your DevSecOps pipeline to meet HELM Product Line Supply Chain Management requirements. Explain how your team will use AI to automate code analysis, testing, security monitoring, data validation, any area of PWS, and how you will apply AI/ML to identify trends, patterns, and anomalies in supply chain data to strengthen decision support, improve quality, and increase delivery performance. Include how your approach supports the Agile and SDLC practices required by the PWS and enables scalable, repeatable delivery across sustainment and modernization teams.

(ii) VOLUME II – PAST PERFORMANCE FACTOR

Quoters shall submit a list of no more than three contracts (including Federal, State, and local government and private) (prime contracts, task/delivery orders, and/or major subcontracts) in performance at any point during the three years immediately preceding to the proposal submission date, which are relevant requirements of this solicitation. Relevant past performance may include any or all of the following areas, in performing services such as Agile and SDLC delivery; DevSecOps engineering; supply chain modernization and sustainment; system and middleware integration; solution and data architecture; data management and migration; testing and Continuous Integration/Continuous Delivery (CI/CD) automation; release and deployment support; cloud migration and hosting; cybersecurity, Zero Trust, privacy, and Risk Management Framework/Authority to Operate (RMF/ATO) compliance; the use of leading-industry AI capabilities to enhance automation and analytics; and implementation experience with major supply chain systems or large-scale VA initiatives, such as the Financial Management Business Transformation (FMBT) program or the Electronic Health Record (EHR) program. Data concerning the prime contractor shall be provided first, followed by each proposed major subcontractor in alphabetical order. A major subcontractor is defined as one performing critical aspects of the requirement and/or whose subcontract represents 20% of the total proposed price. This volume shall be organized into the sections identified in the solicitation instructions.

This volume shall be organized into the following sections:

(1) Section 1 – Contract Descriptions. This section shall include the following information:

- (a) Contractor/Subcontractor place of performance, CAGE Code and Unique Entry ID (UEI) Number. If the work was performed as a subcontractor, also provide the name of the prime contractor and Point of Contact (POC) within the prime contractor organization (name, and current address, e-mail address, and telephone and fax numbers).
- (b) Contracting activity, and current address, Procuring Contracting Officer's name, e-mail address, telephone and fax numbers.
- (c) Technical representative/Contracting Officer's Representative (COR), and current e-mail address, telephone and fax numbers.

(d) Contract administration activity and the Administrative Contracting Officer's name, and current e-mail address, telephone and fax numbers.

(e) Contract Number and, in the case of Indefinite Delivery type contracts, GSA contracts, and Blanket Purchase Agreements, include Delivery Order Numbers also.

(f) Contract Type (specific type such as Fixed Price (FP), Cost Reimbursement (CR), Time & Materials (T&M), etc.) In the case of Indefinite Delivery contracts, indicate specific type (Requirements, Definite Quantity, and Indefinite Quantity) and secondary contract type (FP, CR, T&M, etc.)).

(g) Awarded price/cost.

(h) Final or projected final price/cost.

(i) Original delivery schedule, including dates of start and completion of work.

(j) Final or projected final, delivery schedule, including dates of start and completion of work.

(2) Section 2 - Performance. Quoters shall provide a specific narrative explanation of each contract listed in Section 1 describing the objectives achieved and detailing how the effort is relevant to the requirements of this solicitation. For any contract(s)/task order(s) that did not/do not meet original schedule or technical performance requirements, provide a brief explanation of the reason(s) for the shortcoming(s) and any corrective action(s) taken to avoid recurrence. The Quoters shall list each time the delivery schedule was revised and provide an explanation of why the revision was necessary. The Quoters shall indicate if any of the contracts listed were terminated, the type and reasons for the termination.

(3) Section 3 – Subcontracts. Quoters shall provide an outline of how the effort required by the solicitation will be assigned for performance within the Quoter's corporate entity and among the proposed subcontractors. The information provided for the prime Quoter and each proposed major subcontractor must include the entire company name, company address, CAGE Code, UEI Number and type of work to be performed by citing the applicable Government PWS paragraph number.

(4) Section 4 – New Corporate Entities. New corporate entities may submit data on prior contracts involving its officers and employees. However, in addition to the other requirements in this section, the Quoter shall discuss in detail the role performed by such persons in the prior contracts cited. Information should be included in the files described in the sections above.

(iii) VOLUME III – PRICE FACTOR.

Quoters shall submit the price volume and backup information to include the following:

- A. Completed Price Schedule
- B. Completed Pricing Spreadsheet
- C. Supporting documentation as described below
- D. Assumptions, conditions, and exceptions related to price

- E. A copy of the Quoter's GSA MAS Category 54151S contract, including all proposed Labor, labor category descriptions, skillset/certifications and Handling rates

Price Schedule and Pricing Spreadsheet: Quoters shall complete the provided Price Schedule found in Section B.4 and provide a unit price and extended price for each CLIN. Additionally, Quoter's shall create and submit their respective Pricing Spreadsheet(s) to include any proposed labor mix, labor rates and labor hours.

Supporting documentation: Documentation is required to support the pricing proposed. This shall demonstrate the correlation between the proposed technical solution and the Section B submitted. The supporting documentation shall also include a Basis of Estimate (BOE) which aligns to how the pricing methodology is applied within each iteration.

At a minimum the BOE contents shall include:

- Team composition and Labor Categories for each team
- Size of Agile Teams Micro, Small, Medium, Large
- User Story sizing methodology
- Any discounts applied
- Required certifications/skillsets

Price assumptions, conditions, or exceptions – Submit all (if any) price assumptions, conditions, or exceptions related to any of the terms and conditions of the PWS. If not noted in this section of the Quoter's proposal, it will be assumed that the Quoter proposes no price assumptions, conditions, or exceptions for award, and agrees to comply with all of the terms and conditions set forth in this RFP. It is not the responsibility of the Government to seek out and identify price assumptions, conditions, or exceptions buried within the Quoter's proposal. Quoters are hereby advised that any Quoter-imposed terms and conditions and/or assumptions which deviate from the Government's material terms and conditions established in the Solicitation will render the Quoter's proposal Unacceptable, and thus ineligible for award. The Quoter is advised that in no instance shall its proposed labor rates(s) exceed the Quoter's GSA MAS Category 54151S rate(s). The price proposal shall provide a clear statement of the total price to include calculation based on level of effort proposed.

The Government is requesting price discounts off of the Quoter's GSA MAS Category 54151S ceiling rates/prices. All proposed labor categories and rates shall be clearly mapped back to the Quoter's GSA MAS Category 54151S price list, to be provided with each Quoter's proposal, along with any discounts being applied.

Price Rounding Issue - The Government requires Quoters to propose unit prices and total prices that are two decimal places and requires the unit prices and total prices to be displayed as two decimal places. Ensure that the two-digit unit price multiplied by the item quantity equals the two-digit total item price (there should be no rounding). If an Excel spreadsheet is submitted by the Quoters, the Quoters shall ensure that the actual values in the spreadsheet cells are no more than two decimal places even if values in the spreadsheet cells are formatted to display two decimal places. All Quoters should propose using an estimated award date of September 15, 2026.

(iv) VOLUME IV – VETERANS INVOLVEMENT

- (1) For SDVOSBS/VOSBs: In order to receive credit under this Factor, a Quoter shall submit a statement of compliance that it qualifies as a SDVOSB or VOSB in accordance with VAAR 852.215-70, Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned and Veteran-Owned Small Business Evaluation Factors. Quoters are cautioned that they must be registered and verified in VETCert (<https://www.veterans.certify.sba.gov>) and must meet federal small business size standards for the NAICS code assigned to this solicitation at time of both proposal submission and at time of award.
- (2) For Non-SDVOSBS/VOSBs: To receive some consideration under this Factor, and Quoter must state in its proposal the names of SDVOSB(s) and/or VOSB(s) with whom it intends to subcontract and provide a brief description and approximate dollar values of the proposed subcontracts. Additionally, proposed SDVOSB/VOSB subcontractor must be registered and verified in VETCert (<https://www.veterans.certify.sba.gov>) in order to receive some consideration under the Veteran's Involvement Factor and must meet federal small business size standards for the NAICS code assigned to this solicitation at time of proposal submission and time of award.

(v) Volume V - SMALL BUSINESS PARTICIPATION COMMITMENT

All Quoters are required to submit Small Business Participation Commitment information. Please note the NAICS code found on the cover page of the solicitation: 541511.

Quoters must use and complete the table below in Excel and title it, PrimeQuoter_SBPC.XLS. Please rename this file replacing 'PrimeQuoter' with your company name upon submission.

See sample spreadsheet below:

A	B	C
Business Type	Requirement	Proposed
Small Business	17.5%	
Business Type	Goals	Proposed
SDB (including Section 8(a))	5.0%	
WOSB	5.0%	
HUBZone	3.0%	
VOSB	7.0%	
SDVOSB	5.0%	

Please note that a Prime Quoter or Subcontractor who meets more than one small business type concern, should be included for each of the proposed goals for that business type (i.e. a Quoter who is a WOSB and also an SDVOSB, should have its percentage be included for the business types WOSB, SB, EDWOSB, VOSB and SDVOSB).

Please note that the overall small business requirement of 17.5% includes all small businesses under the NAICS code 541511. The NAICS code assigned to the solicitation does not necessarily apply to each subcontract. In accordance with RFO 52.219-9(e)(7), contractors are required to assign to each subcontract the NAICS code and corresponding size standard that best describes the principal purpose of the subcontract.

The percentages proposed for the goals will be incorporated into any resulting contract. In accordance with Section C under the Small Business Requirements clause.

VOLUME VI - SOLICITATION, OFFER AND AWARD DOCUMENTS AND CERTIFICATIONS/REPRESENTATIONS.

Certifications and Representations - An authorized official of the firm shall sign the SF 1449 and all certifications that require original signature. An Acrobat PDF file shall be created to capture the signatures for submission. This Volume shall contain the following:

- a. Solicitation Section A – Standard Form (SF1449) and Acknowledgement of Amendments, if any.
- b. Small Business Subcontracting Plan. Each Large Business Quoter shall provide a Small Business Subcontracting Plan that contains all of the elements required by RFO 52.219-9. If the large business does not have an approved Master Plan or approved Commercial Plan, then an Individual Subcontracting Plan must be submitted that includes an assurance that small businesses will be given the maximum practicable opportunity to participate in contract performance. The Subcontracting Plan is not a requirement for evaluation but rather, a requirement for award to a Large Business and the Small Business Subcontracting Plan, as negotiated, will be incorporated into any resultant award.
- c. Any proposed terms and conditions and/or assumptions upon which the quotation is predicated.

Quoters are hereby advised that any Quoter-imposed terms and conditions and/or assumptions which deviate from the Government's material terms and conditions established by the Solicitation, may render the quotation Unacceptable, and thus ineligible for award.